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No Half Truths

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News at a glance

At least 3 Nigerians killed in recent weeks in S Africa

ABUJA: Three Nigerian nationals have been killed in recent weeks in South Africa, Nigerian authorities said Tuesday, adding to tensions between the two countries over persistent violence against migrants.

Nigeria's ambassador-designate to South Africa, Femi Fani-Kayode, said the three were killed between Sept. 18 and 21. He identified them as Kenechukwu Christopher Igwemmadu, killed in Bloemfontein; Olaniyi Olaleye Olatunde, in Pretoria, and Christian Hillary Nnaemeka, in Primrose.

Azerbaijani woman gang raped in Lahore; 2 arrested

LAHORE: Pakistan's Punjab police on Tuesday arrested two suspects allegedly involved in the gang rape of a 20-year-old Azerbaijani woman in Lahore and obtained a six-day physical remand of them for interrogation.

According to police officer Zeeshan Raza, police produced the suspects – Syed Mohsin Shah and Syed Ali Zain -- before a magistrate at Cantonment Courts and sought a 14-day physical remand of them for interrogation, collection of evidence and DNA examination.

UN envoy meets Houthi negotiators amid violence

CAIRO: The UN envoy for Yemen said Tuesday he met with Houthi negotiators over the weekend in efforts to avert further escalation in Yemen amid fierce battles on the country's western coast between the Iran-backed Houthis and the Saudi-supported, but fragmented, government forces.

The renewed violence is the latest twist in Yemen's conflict, which began in 2014 when the Iran-backed rebels took over the capital, Sanaa, forcing the country's government to settle into exile in Saudi Arabia.



Rows of undelivered luggage being placed in the arrivals hall at Suvarnabhumi International Airport in Samut Prakan, Thailand on Tuesday AP/PTI

Briefs

Pak detects fifth case of polio of 2026

ISLAMABAD: Another case of polio was detected in Pakistan on Tuesday, taking the number of reported cases this year to five, authorities said.

The case was reported in Bannu district of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province. The affected child is a 17-month-old girl from Khandar Khankhel area of the district.

The Regional Reference Laboratory for Polio Eradication, Islamabad, confirmed the fifth polio case of 2026, an official statement said.

Four of the five cases have been detected in the Bannu region, including three of them in Bannu district.

Burkina Faso opens its 1st gold refinery

DAKAR: Burkina Faso has opened its first gold refinery as its military-led government seeks greater economic sovereignty after severing ties with traditional Western partners.

"From now on, gold from Burkina Faso must not only be extracted in Burkina Faso, it must be processed, controlled, valued and certified in Burkina Faso," President Ibrahim Traore, who has ruled the West African country since a 2022 military coup, said on Monday at the opening of the refinery, known as Raffinor-BF.

Morocco's king appoints 1st woman PM

CASABLANCA: Morocco's King Mohammed VI on Tuesday named Urban Planning Minister Fatima Zahra Mansouri as the country's prime minister, making the 50-year-old attorney the first woman to hold the position in the Muslim kingdom.

Mansouri, who until her nomination also was the mayor of Marrakech, was tasked with forming a new government, the Royal Palace said in a statement. The announcement came four days after results of elections were announced.

Mansouri is expected to build a governing coalition in the coming days.

TRUMP SEEMS STUCK IN US-IRAN CONFLICT

Iran tells US public that Trump's war has failed

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Washington, September 29

Iran's top diplomat said indirect negotiations with the United States aimed at reopening the critical Strait of Hormuz have become "more serious," while the Iranian Revolutionary Guard Corps' chief spokesman Gen. Hossein Mohebbi on Tuesday called on Americans to take to the streets and protest the conflict.

Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi told Iranian media late on Monday that the "current focus is solely on the Strait of Hormuz," the chokepoint of the war.

Araghchi made the comments shortly before departing New York – where he attended last week's gathering of world leaders at the UN General Assembly – and after meeting with Pakistani and Qatari mediators.

Araghchi said that the Qatari intermediaries were expected to soon engage with the US side.

"They are set to raise the matter with the American side once more, after which the final US response will be conveyed to us," Araghchi said. "If there is a response, the Qataris will convey it to us and a decision will be made in Tehran on that basis."



Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian holds up photographs as he delivers remarks during the 81st session of the United Nations General Assembly at United Nations headquarters FILE PHOTO

HIGHLIGHTS

- Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi told Iranian media late on Monday that the 'current focus is solely on the Strait of Hormuz'
- IRGC made an appeal to everyday Americans to push their government to end the US war against Iran

Officials, including from the US, have confirmed to The Associated Press that mediators are working with Iran and the US on trying to broker a deal to end the fighting and open the strait.

The mediation efforts continue even after US President Donald Trump earlier this week spurned an Iranian proposal to reopen the strait in seven days if the US agreed to lift its blockade of Iranian ports, release frozen Iranian assets and waive sanctions on Iranian oil sales, among other conditions.

US forces exit Iraq after two decades

AGENCIES
Baghdad, September 29

US forces are set to pull out from their last bases in Iraq by Wednesday, a departure celebrated as a victory by Iran and its allies who now have deep influence in the country where 4,500 Americans died during more than two decades of war.

Iraqi security experts say the withdrawal – agreed in 2024 under President Joe Biden and carried out by Donald Trump's administration even as it wages war against Iran – could give Tehran and its powerful allies free rein, while also allowing other US enemies to stage a comeback, including Islamic State.

Nepal: Rain-induced disasters kill 27 people in last few days

The disasters in the nation affected 1,082 families

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kathmandu, September 29

At least 27 people have been killed in rain-induced disasters across Nepal since September 24, officials said on Tuesday.

Four people remain missing and eight have been injured in incidents linked to heavy rainfall, including floods and landslides, according to the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA).

Twenty people were killed in landslides, four in floods and three in incidents related to heavy rainfall since September 24, the authority said.



The disasters affected 1,082 families and killed 114 livestock. They also completely destroyed 227 houses and partially damaged 142 others, while floods and landslides damaged 31 bridges.

According to the NDRRMA, 542 rain-induced disaster incidents were reported between September 24 and Sunday.

Israel kills senior Hamas commander in Gaza

The Israeli military reported two strikes in Jabalia

AGENCIES
Cairo/Gaza, September 29

An Israeli airstrike killed the head of Hamas' armed wing in north Gaza on Tuesday, officials on both sides said, with the militant group describing him as a leader of the October 7, 2023, attack that precipitated thewar in the Palestinian enclave, Reuters reported.

> MEDICS SAID THE ISRAELI STRIKE HIT AN APARTMENT BUILDING IN GAZA CITY'S NASR NEIGHBOURHOOD AROUND DAWN

Israel's government said its military had targeted and killed Izz al-Din Al-Beik, who they said was involved in planning attacks and recruiting. Hamas confirmed his death.

Medics said the Israeli strike hit an apartment building in Gaza City's Nasr neighbourhood around dawn. A second person died from wounds after the attack, health officials said.

Later on Tuesday, two separate airstrikes in Jabalia refugee camp, one near a medical clinic and the other at a tent encampment housing displaced families, killed at least three people, medics said. The Israeli military reported two strikes that targeted militants in Jabalia.

Israel, which says Hamas has been rearming and launching attacks in violation of an October ceasefire, has stepped up strikes on the group in recent weeks.

Spanish housing protests spread

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Madrid, September 29

Housing protesters camped out in Madrid's most iconic square awoke from their third night in the open to await details from the Spanishgovernment on what it's doing to tackle a crisis that has brought tens of thousands of people onto the streets in recent days.

The protests and the encampment in Puerto del Sol followed the eviction of María del Carmen Abascal, 87, who was carried out on a stretcher from the apartment where she had lived for seven decades.

'Afghanistan's interim govt should move out of its 'militant mindset'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Islamabad, September 29

Pakistan's Information Minister Attaullah Tarar on Tuesday said that Afghanistan's interim administration should move out of the "militant mindset", amid strained ties between the two countries.

The relations between Pakistan and Afghanistan have deteriorated in recent months, with the two sides accusing each other of supporting militancy.

Pakistan on Monday said its security forces carried out airstrikes on terrorist camps and hideouts in the border region with Afghanistan, killing 28 terrorists, including multiple suicide bombers.

The latest strikes mark a fresh escalation in tensions between the two countries, which have been strained for a while over Islamabad's allegations that militant groups use Afghan territory to launch attacks against Pakistan, an allegation rejected by Afghanistan's Taliban government. "The interim Afghan government needs to move out of its militant mindset into a mindset of a statesman or state," Information Minister Tarar said.

UK: Andy Burnham pledges big shakeup in high-risk political speech



ASSOCIATED PRESS
London, September 29

Prime Minister Andy Burnham pledged Tuesday to give Britain "a new social contract for the 21st century," reform the country's electoral system and reset its relationship with its European neighbours.

But he acknowledged that economic constraints make delivering his sweeping plans a big political risk.

"Small things will not get us through what are difficult times," Burnham said in a tough-love speech to the centre-left Labour Party's annual conference.

He set out a crowd-pleasing vision of more social housing, better education and more affordable care for the elderly. But he warned that money would have to come from welfare and pension spending to deliver the changes.

Anticipating opposition to his plans, Burnham said: "I have given you what you often say is missing from politics: honesty, ideas and a clear direction for the country we all love."

Some of Burnham's announcements in the hour-long speech will spark big political fights. Burnham said he would stake his political legacy on establishing a "national care service" to fix what he called a " broken" social care system.

Student protests fuel political clashes in France

Politicians across the ideological spectrum seek issues that can lure voters

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Paris, September 29

French Prime Minister Sébastien Lecornu clashed with far-left leader Jean-Luc Mélenchon on Monday over the actions of high school students who are blockading classes and pushing for a nationwide spread of their fledgling protest movement for more resources.

The exchanges in posts on social media between Lecornu and Mélenchon, a top presidential contender, reflected the increasingly combative political climate ahead of a crucial presidential election next spring and amid mounting pressure over France's finances.



A student walks past a burning bicycle next to the Baggio High School, in Lille on Tuesday AP/PTI

Politicians across the ideological spectrum are seeking issues that resonate with voters. Complaints from students about deteriorating schools, teacher shortages and heavy class schedules have become the latest cause embraced by some presidential hopefuls.

> COMPLAINTS FROM STUDENTS ABOUT DETERIORATING SCHOOLS, TEACHER SHORTAGES AND HEAVY CLASS SCHEDULES HAVE BECOME THE LATEST CAUSE EMBRACED BY SOME PRESIDENTIAL HOPEFULS

Lecornu, meanwhile, is trying to build enough public and political support to pass a 2027 state budget through a divided parliament, where President Emmanuel Macron's government is besieged by opponents, many of whom are unwilling to accept proposed spending cuts while soaring energy costs and other expenses squeeze households.

Mélenchon, 75, a veteran anti-capitalist firebrand, finished third in the 2022 presidential election and fourth in both 2017 and 2012.

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CAQM TWEAKS GRAP, EXTENDS CURBS TILL SONIPAT P4



NITIN NABIN CHAIRS MEETING OF PARTY'S STATE IN-CHARGES P9

'OTT SAVED US WHEN THEATRES SHUT DURING COVID' P16

ALL FRONTS OPEN AGAINST CEC GYANESH KUMAR

Top Court to hear plea against CEC as entire Oppn unites for his removal

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 29

As the controversy around functioning of the Election Commission of India (ECI) continues to simmer, the Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar is facing the heat from all corners in the wake of disclosures made in a recent report by The Indian Express.

The matter has now reached the doors of the Supreme Court with the top court agreeing to hear next week a Public Interest Litigation (PIL) seeking suspension of CEC Gyanesh Kumar and challenging the manner in which the poll panel led by him took decisions allegedly without the approval of two Election Commissioners.

The matter was mentioned on Tuesday before a bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana.



HIGHLIGHTS

- Matter mentioned before CJI Surya Kant-led bench
- Senior advocate Vikas Singh raised concerns over ECI functioning
- CJI says matter will be listed next week
- PIL questions CEC's alleged individual exercise of powers
- Plea seeks declaration of disputed actions as unauthorised
- Petitioner seeks preservation of ECI records and files
- Plea seeks restraint on Kumar exercising CEC functions

Senior advocate Vikas Singh, who mentioned the matter, told the bench that as per the statutory scheme, decisions of the multi-member Election Commission have to be unanimous or by majority.

CONTINUED ON P8

INDIA BLOC MEET TODAY

Cong demands PM's resignation for 'match-fixing' polls through CEC

AAISHA SABIR/VINAY KUMAR
New Delhi, September 29

The main opposition party Congress on Tuesday intensified its attack on the BJP over the functioning of the Election Commission, demanding the resignation of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

A day ahead of the meeting of opposition INDIA bloc in the Capital, the Congress said the grouping and its leaders will decide on launching a nationwide movement against alleged electoral malpractices as revealed in a recent report of The Indian Express daily.

The Congress also demanded suspension of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, restoration of 13.30 crore names struck off from the electoral rolls and the resignation of PM Modi for "match-fixing" polls.

The opposition party made the demand after a two-and-a-half-hour meeting of the Congress Working Committee (CWC) chaired by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge and attended by the likes of former party chiefs Sonia Gandhi and Rahul Gandhi, and general secretaries Jairam Ramesh, K C Venugopal, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, among others.

CONTINUED ON P8

A 15-minute ride from East to South Delhi, at last

Shah inaugurates Barapullah Phase-III

AIMAN FATIMA AND NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, September 29

After more than a decade of delays, the long-awaited Barapullah Phase-III elevated corridor was opened to the public on Tuesday, creating a signal-free link between Mayur Vihar Phase-I and Sarai Kale Khan and strengthening connectivity towards AIIMS and South Delhi.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah inaugurated the Rs.1,635-crore corridor at an event attended by Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, PWD Minister Parvesh Verma, Union Minister of State for Road Transport and Highways Harsh Malhotra and other leaders. Shah also inaugurated and laid foundation stones for road projects worth more than Rs.1,941 crore in the capital.

The Barapullah Phase-III project

CONTINUED ON P8



Union Home Minister Amit Shah inaugurates Barapullah Elevated Road Phase - 3, in New Delhi PTI



Briefs

US exempts select Indian drugs from 100% tariffs

WASHINGTON, DC: Washington has exempted select speciality medicines and their manufacturing components from import duties, benefiting India and 19 other trade partners as the US prepares to impose a 100 per cent levy on specified patented pharmaceutical products.

CONTINUED ON P8

Two MHA officials booked for seeking bribe

NEW DELHI: The Special Cell of the Delhi Police, acting on information received from the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) and in coordination with central agencies, arrested two government officials in New Delhi on Monday for allegedly demanding illegal gratification to facilitate a pending registration under the

CONTINUED ON P8

Assam Rifles jawan killed in Arunachal

ITANAGAR: An Assam Rifles jawan was killed and four others injured after their patrol came under suspected militant fire near the India-Myanmar border in Arunachal Pradesh's Changlang district on Tuesday, officials said.

The attack took place around 6.30 am near Nampong Nallah in Nampong circle, where personnel of the 21 Assam Rifles were patrolling an area where border fencing work is underway.

CONTINUED ON P8

SC sets aside Sambhal accused's NSA detention, orders UP to pay Rs 10 lakh

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 29



SAYS DETENTION UNDER NSA CAN'T BE BASED ON CONFESSION STATEMENT OF ACCUSED MADE BEFORE POLICE

The Supreme Court on Tuesday quashed the preventive detention of Mulla Afroz under the National Security Act (NSA) in connection with the November 2024 Sambhal violence, holding that a confession allegedly made before police could not, by itself, justify detention, and ordered the Uttar Pradesh government to pay Rs 10 lakh in costs. A bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu said preventive detention is an exceptional measure that must be exercised with utmost caution, particularly when the material relied upon lacks independent support.

The court said a confession made before a police officer is generally not treated as reliable evidence against its maker. "A mere confessional statement of the detenu (without any other substantive grounds or material) cannot be relied on as the sole ground for passing an order of detention," it said.

Afroz was detained after being accused in cases arising from violence during a court-ordered survey of Sambhal's Shahi Jama Masjid on November 24, 2024. Four people were killed and dozens injured in clashes between protesters and security personnel.

The Sambhal district magistrate issued the NSA detention order on October 13, 2025,

CONTINUED ON P8

HOTAN ROUTE MAY OFFER INDIA SHORTER PATH TO EUROPE, US

India explores China route to bypass Pak airspace

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 29

India is exploring a new air corridor through China's Xinjiang region to shorten flights to Europe, the UK and North America as Pakistan's continued closure of its airspace forces Indian carriers to take costly detours, Civil Aviation Minister Ram Mohan Naidu said on Tuesday. The proposed route, being discussed between Indian and Chinese officials for more than a year, would pass near Hotan in southwestern Xinjiang, but no agreement or timeline for opening the corridor has been reached.

Indian airlines have been barred from using Pakistani airspace since April 2025, after the Pahalgam terror attack. Carriers operating westbound flights from Delhi, Mumbai and other parts of northern and western India have since diverted routes over the Arabian Sea towards Muscat. The diversion has added up to two hours of flying time on some sectors, increasing fuel consumption, crew costs and other operational expenses.

"We are looking at other alternatives. Discussion on the Hotan route is going on between the two countries. Our external affairs ministry (MEA) is engaging with their country... let us see how it goes, but we are trying alternatives," Naidu told reporters.

If approved, flights from Delhi and Mumbai could travel towards Leh, enter Chinese airspace near Hotan, continue towards Kyrgyzstan and then join existing routes to western destinations. A person familiar with the matter said Indian carriers were currently using the L639 route to avoid Pakistan, adding about two hours to some flights.

CONTINUED ON P8

J&K'S KATHUA

CISF jawan opens fire, kills four colleagues

AGENCIES
Jammu, September 29

Four Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) personnel, including an assistant commandant, were killed after a colleague allegedly opened fire in Kathua district of Jammu and Kashmir on Tuesday evening, officials said.

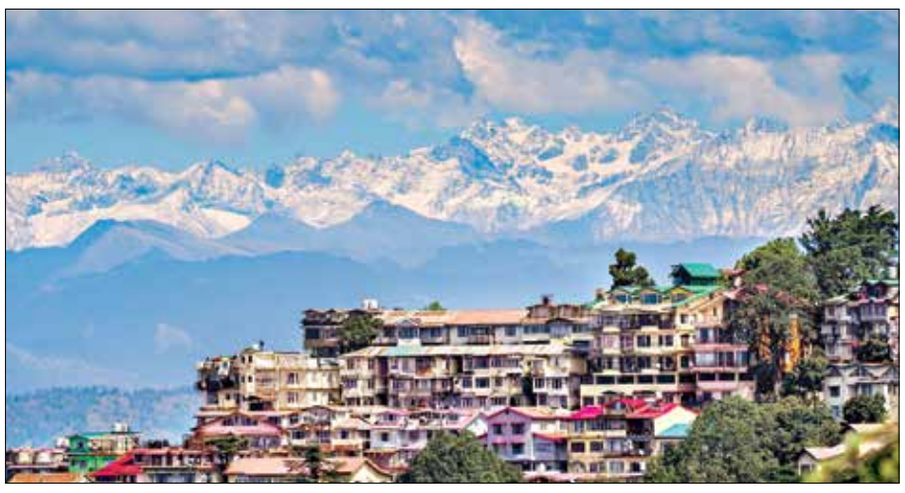
The incident took place at around 7.30 pm at Sewa-III hydroelectric power project located at Mashka village in Basohli, near the border with Himachal Pradesh, the officials said.

According to preliminary information, the accused, Head Constable Abhidesh Kumar, allegedly resorted to firing from his service rifle following an argument with some of his colleagues.

Four CISF personnel sustained critical injuries in the firing and later succumbed to their injuries at nearby

CONTINUED ON P8

WHERE SNOW MEETS THE SKY



Snow-covered Himalayan peaks seen from Shimla on Tuesday PTI

ASIAN GAMES 2026

RELAY TEAM, **NEERU DHANDA** STRIKE **GOLD** AS INDIA ENTERS ASIAD TOP 10



GOLD

SHOOTING
Neeru Dhanda
Won gold in the women's trap individual event

ATHLETICS
Kiran, Prachi Choudhary, M R Poovamma & Vithya Ramraj. Won gold in the women's 4x400m relay

SILVER SHOOTING
Neeru Dhanda, Aashima Ahlawat & Manisha Keer Won Silver In The Women's Trap Team Event

ATHLETICS
BRONZE
Pooja Singh
Won bronze in the women's high jump



Gulveer Singh Won bronze in the men's 5000m

Gurindervir Singh, Sneha Sathyanarayana, Animesh Kujur & Harita Bhadra
Won bronze in the mixed 4x100m relay

Vishal TK, Dharamveer Choudhary, Jay Kumar & T Manu
Won bronze in the men's 4x400m relay

BOXING
Narender Berwal
Won bronze in the men's +90kg category



53 MEDALS

GOLD: 6 | SILVER: 21 | BRONZE: 26

SEEKS UNIFORM 16% MARGIN

'This is carnage': SC questions 10-fold markup on cancer medicines

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 29

The Supreme Court on Tuesday questioned the steep markup on cancer medicines in private hospitals, calling a 10-fold difference between the price paid by retailers and the maximum retail price "carnage" and suggesting a uniform 16 per cent margin on medicines.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta asked the Centre to examine why patients are often required to purchase medicines from pharmacies linked to corporate hospitals. The bench said such practices ultimately place the financial burden on patients and taxpayers.



The court was hearing petitions relating to drug pricing, generic prescriptions and regulation of medical devices under the Drugs (Prices Control) Order, 2013.

Justice Mehta pointed to the example of a cancer medicine supplied to retailers at a price of Rs 2,700 but carrying an MRP of Rs 27,000. "This is carnage. Plain and simple," the bench said. It questioned why such a gap was permitted and asked, "Why not keep a 16 per cent margin on MRP of everything?"

The bench also questioned the practice of hospitals insisting that patients buy medicines from their own chemists or specified pharmacies, warning that patients could face difficulties in receiving treatment if they purchase medicines elsewhere.

"If that patient is taking treatment under a government scheme, who reimburses? The taxpayer does. So why not uniform criteria?" Justice Mehta asked.

CONTINUED ON P8

34 SANCTIONED POSTS SCRAPPED

CISF withdraws security cover from Patanjali Food Park

NARESH BISWANI
Haridwar, September 29

The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) has withdrawn its security cover from Baba Ramdev's Patanjali Food and Herbal Park in Haridwar after more than a decade of guarding the facility.

The CISF had been deployed at the Patanjali campus in June 2015. After the security cover was withdrawn in May this year, the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) directed the force to abolish all 34 sanctioned posts associated with the deployment, an official said.

CONTINUED ON P8

MINIMUM AT 21°C

City's Sept chill hits 18-year low



AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 29

Delhi recorded a minimum temperature of 21 degrees Celsius on Tuesday, 2.3 degrees below normal, marking the lowest minimum temperature recorded in the national capital in September since 2008, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD).

IMD data showed that the lowest minimum temperature recorded in September since 2001 was 20.8 degrees Celsius on September 6, 2008, followed by 21.1 degrees Celsius on September 19, 2024.

However, Delhi had recorded even lower minimum temperatures on September 29 and 30 in 2000, at 20.6 and 20.7 degrees Celsius respectively. These readings are excluded from the IMD's "since 2001" comparison. The city's primary weather station at Safdarjung had also recorded a minimum temperature of 21 degrees Celsius on Sunday, September 27.

Several other weather stations reported temperatures significantly below their respective normal levels. Palam recorded 19.7 degrees Celsius, 3.8 degrees below normal, while Lodi Road registered 20.4 degrees Celsius, 1.6 degrees below normal. The Ridge witnessed a minimum of 16.9 degrees Celsius, six degrees below normal, while Ayanagar recorded 20.6 degrees Celsius, two degrees below normal. The maximum temperature in Delhi is likely to settle around 32 degrees Celsius on Tuesday, with the IMD forecasting partly cloudy skies.

Light rainfall was also recorded at some stations. Up to 8:30 am, Palam received 1 mm of rainfall, while the Ridge and Ayanagar recorded 0.2 mm and 0.7 mm respectively. Safdarjung and Lodi Road recorded only trace rainfall.

Meanwhile, Delhi's air quality remained in the satisfactory category. The city recorded an Air Quality Index (AQI) of 62 at 9 am, according to the Central Pollution Control Board.

CAQM tweaks GRAP, extends curbs till Sonipat

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) in the National Capital Region (NCR) and adjoining areas has modified the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) framework, bringing changes like the extension of restrictions on the plying of BS-III petrol and BS-IV diesel or below-standard LMVs (four-wheelers) to Sonipat in Haryana under GRAP-3. Earlier, these restrictions were limited to only Gurugram, Faridabad, Ghaziabad and Gautam Budh Nagar.

GRAP is a set of emergency measures that kick in to prevent further deterioration of air quality once it reaches a certain threshold. The first stage, GRAP-1, kicks in when the AQI is between 201 and 300; the second stage, GRAP-2, is invoked when the AQI is between 301 and 400; GRAP-3 kicks in between 401 and 500; and GRAP-4 is invoked when the AQI is more than 450. The modifications were approved during the 30th meeting of the full CAQM on Monday, and announced on Tuesday. The last time the CAQM made such alterations in the GRAP framework was in November 2025.



The latest changes also include that under GRAP-1, no inter-city or inter-state buses – other than EV, CNG, BS-VI diesel – from any place in Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan and adjoining states like Punjab, Himachal Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Uttarakhand and Jammu and Kashmir will be permitted to enter Delhi-NCR. Previously, this measure was implemented under GRAP-2.

Moreover, the exemption for BS-IV and below goods vehicles carrying essential commodities under GRAP-3 and GRAP-4 has been removed.

The CAQM has also amended directions 11 to 18, issued in 2021, in the NCR. These directions pertained to construction and demolition activities falling within the territorial jurisdiction of urban bodies or municipal areas of the NCR.

For instance, they established an online monitoring mechanism through a web portal, and mandated registration of construction and demolition projects with plot area equal to or greater than 500 square metres.

Now, directions 11 to 18 have been extended to urban areas, controlled areas, development areas or industrial development areas, industrial areas or zones, and highway corridor zones in the NCR states.

COPS DENY CLAIM

Uttam Nagar: Crowd gathers at PS after witness alleges assault

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

A crowd gathered outside the Uttam Nagar police station after a key witness in the killing of 26-year-old Tarun Butolia during a clash on Holi alleged that he was assaulted by a relative of the accused. Delhi Police on Tuesday, however, termed the assault as "rumours" and said the situation in west Delhi's Uttam Nagar was normal and that no untoward incident had taken place. A PCR call regarding the alleged assault was received late Monday night, following which the SHO and police staff reached the spot and assessed the situation, DCP (Dwarka) Kushal Pal Singh said.

The police officer said a crowd had gathered due to "rumours" circulating in the area but the situation was found to be normal on verification. Additional police personnel have been deployed in the area as a precautionary measure, he said. The crowd had gathered outside Uttam Nagar police station after Tarun's uncle, who has claimed to be a witness in the case, alleged that he was assaulted by a relative of one of the accused, people familiar with the matter said. The witness alleged that he was returning from work when Golu, a relative of an accused, and another person assaulted him and asked him not to testify or pursue the case.

He claimed that he suffered injuries in the alleged assault and was taken for medical examination.

Tarun Butolia was allegedly beaten to death with sticks, bats and rods on March 4 following a dispute during Holi celebrations in the Hastal area. The altercation allegedly began after a coloured water balloon thrown by a minor from Tarun's family landed on a woman from another community and splashed water on her clothes, triggering communal tension in the area. More than 18 people, including two minors, were named in the police chargesheet in connection with the murder case.

The alleged assault claimed by Tarun's uncle comes ahead of a Juvenile Justice Board hearing concerning the age of the main accused in the murder case. The SDM has rejected a 2011 birth certificate that was the basis of his being tried as a juvenile, according to Tarun's family.

JNU students mark Bhagat Singh's birth anniversary

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

Around 1,000 students gathered at Jawaharlal Nehru University to mark the birth anniversary of freedom fighter Bhagat Singh, responding to a call by the JNU Students' Union.

The gathering highlighted Bhagat Singh's legacy of questioning authority, opposing injustice and advocating equality, freedom and social justice. Students also invoked the contributions of fellow revolutionaries Rajguru and Sukhdev during the programme. According to the JNUSU, the event was held against the backdrop of what it described as growing threats to democratic institutions, public education and the rights of marginalised communities.

SHAHBAD DAIRY

Suspected thieves mobbed; one killed

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

A 21-year-old man with nine previous criminal involvements died after he and two others were allegedly thrashed by a group of people on suspicion of attempting to break into a shop in outer north Delhi's Shahbad Dairy area, police said on Tuesday.

The deceased has been identified as Hasan Mangal -- designated 'bad character' by Narela Industrial Area police station.

According to police, information was received around 7 am that a group of suspected thieves had been caught and allegedly beaten by locals in Shahbad Dairy police station area.

A police team reached the spot and found three people injured. They were taken to a hospital, where Mangal was declared brought dead, while the other two are undergoing treatment, officials said.

A relative of Mangal alleged that the infuriated mob continued to assault the three injured even when the victim was seriously injured.

"Someone informed me that my sister's son was assaulted on the road and was lying injured. We were sleeping at that time. When we came outside, we saw a commotion and a large gathering in the lane," the deceased's kin told reporters.

She alleged that when she and other family members approached the mob to find out what had happened, someone in the crowd said, 'You lot are a bunch of thieves.'

"Then they beat us too. He (Mangal) was still breathing, but they kept beating him until he was motionless. Then they left us and told us to go away," the relative told reporters.

Police said the preliminary inquiry suggests around four to five suspicious persons had entered the area with the alleged intention of committing theft and were possibly trying to break open the lock of a shop.

"Hearing the noise, local residents came out and caught the suspected thieves," a police officer said. While some of the suspects managed to flee, three were caught by locals and allegedly thrashed.

Mangal sustained serious injuries and later died, police said.

Five suspects have been apprehended so far in connection with the alleged thrashing, they said.

A crime team inspected the spot and collected evidence, while investigators are examining CCTV footage from the surrounding areas to establish the sequence of events and identify those involved, police said.

Police are also investigating the alleged attempt to break into the shop and the role of the other suspected thieves who fled the spot.

A case is being registered and further legal action will be taken on the basis of evidence collected during the investigation, medical opinion and the post-mortem report, police said.

One dead, two injured as house collapses during renovation

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

A 45-year-old man was killed while two others sustained injuries after the roof of a bakery – located in a building undergoing renovation – collapsed in northeast Delhi's Tahirpur on Tuesday, officials said.

The deceased has been identified as Satish, who operated the bakery at the ground floor of the building in Tahirpur village, they said. The incident took place around 3.30 pm when construction work was underway on the first floor of the building. Satish and two workers – Mahendra and Pappu – were inside the bakery when the roof collapsed, officials said. Subsequently, locals rushed to the spot and pulled the trapped people out of the debris, also informing police and the fire department.

The fire department received information about the incident at 3.52 pm from Gali No 2, opposite Rajeev Gandhi Super Speciality Hospital, following which two fire tenders and an emergency-response team were rushed to the spot. The Delhi Fire Service (DFS) reached the spot and subsequently shifted the injured to Rajeev Gandhi Super Speciality Hospital by PCR and CATS ambulances, officials said. The three rescued persons were identified as Satish (45), Mahendra (51) and Pappu (30). The medical officer on duty declared Satish brought dead, while Mahendra was admitted with injuries and Pappu was admitted in a serious condition, they said.



Hostels, PG safety on DUSU's agenda

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 29

The Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU), led by the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP), submitted a memorandum to Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday seeking measures to strengthen student and women's safety and improve hostel facilities.

DUSU president Yash Dabas, secretary Riya Chhawdi, joint secretary Lakshya Raj Singh and ABVP Delhi State secretary Sarthak Sharma met the Chief Minister and raised concerns over the shortage of hostels, safety standards in paying guest (PG) accommodations and buildings, and security arrangements around the university.

The memorandum sought construction of new hostels, regular safety audits of PG accommodations and buildings, improved lighting at dark spots, adequate Pink Booths and regular monitoring of police patrolling vehicles. The students' body also sought appropriate compensation for families affected by the Satya Niketan incident.

Dabas said adequate and safe hostel facilities were essential for Delhi University students and called for regular safety audits in accordance with prescribed standards.

Chhawdi said negligence on women's safety was unacceptable and sought improved lighting, stronger patrolling arrangements and more Pink Booths in and around the university campus.

Sharma said continuous monitoring and accountability were needed on issues concerning student safety. He urged the government and institutions to take time-bound measures to improve hostel and building safety and ensure adequate security arrangements.

The delegation said coordinated action by the university administration and the Delhi Government was necessary to prevent similar incidents.

Bawana drug trail: Cops seize cash, jewellery, property papers

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, September 29

The Delhi Police's Anti Narcotics Squad of Outer North team has recovered a big haul of property from the residence of an alleged drug trafficker in Bawana.

An anonymous source tipped the Anti Narcotics Squad of the Delhi Police about the criminal. The accused has been identified as Saheb Khan alias Sonu (27) son of Kayum Khan resident of Gordhanpura, Pratapgarh, Rajasthan.

According to the police, the recovery was made on September 28 following information provided by accused Parvati, who was arrested along with her bodyguard, Vikash alias Shanu, during a raid in New Sanoth Colony on September 23. Police suspect that the seized cash, jewellery and property documents represent proceeds generated through drug trafficking in the Bawana and Narela areas.

During the initial raid, police recovered 939 grams of heroin, 615 grams of adulterated powder, 7.93 lakh rupees in cash and a Tata Harrier vehicle.

During interrogation, Parvati allegedly disclosed details of an organised interstate drug trafficking syndicate operating with supplies sourced from Rajasthan.

Acting on her information, police arrested her alleged supplier, Saheb Khan alias Sonu (27), from Pratapgarh, Rajasthan, on September 25.

Police recovered another 265 grams of heroin from his Swift car, which was subsequently seized.

COUSIN, 2 OTHERS, JUVENILE APPREHENDED; 3 ABSCONDING

Cousin tipped off assailants; man stabbed to death during robbery

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

A man who was returning after collecting payments in north Delhi was allegedly intercepted and stabbed to death during an armed robbery after his cousin apparently tipped off the assailants about the cash movement, Delhi Police said on Tuesday.

The victim's cousin, two other accused and a juvenile have been apprehended in connection with the robbery-murder, while three others are absconding, they said.

The deceased, Prabhat, was returning with his nephew Sachin after collecting money from shops in Gandhi Nagar Market on September 24 when four armed men allegedly intercepted their e-rickshaw near the Neeli Chhatri Mandir underpass around 7.20 pm. "The assailants attempted to snatch the polythene bag containing cash. When Prabhat resisted, they attacked him, Sachin and another passenger with knives before fleeing with the cash," a senior police officer said, adding that Prabhat sustained critical stab injuries and was declared dead when taken to a hospital. The officer said a case was registered in this connection at Kashmere Gate police station on September 25.

According to police, more than 500 CCTV cameras were analysed, including around 150 cameras installed in and around the underpass and adjoining routes, along with footage from ANPR (Automatic Number-Plate Recognition) cameras. "Teams noticed a car making a sharp U-turn at high speed near the underpass and moving towards Salimgarh Fort. The vehicle had been captured from a considerable distance and poor visibility initially made identification difficult," the officer said. Further analysis of CCTV and ANPR camera footage, besides technical surveillance, helped police identify the registration number on the car. "However, verification revealed that the vehicle bearing that number was owned by one Bhagat Singh of Noida, and was different from the vehicle captured in the CCTV footage, establishing that the accused had possibly used a fake number plate.

"Teams then traced the movements of another vehicle bearing a Uttar Pradesh registration number. CCTV footage showed it approaching the underpass from the direction of the Yamuna through Loha Pul around two hours before the robbery, with five to six persons inside," she added.

Further CCTV analysis led investigators to identify the vehicle and its registered owner, Deepu Rathore, a resident of Uttar Pradesh's Jhansi. Analysis of Deepu's call records led police to a mobile number that was in contact with both Deepu and the deceased.

"The mobile number was traced to Om Singh of Kanpur -- Prabhat's first cousin. Teams were subsequently sent to Kanpur, Jhansi and Etawah. Om was apprehended from Kanpur, while Deepu and a 16-year-old were apprehended from Jhansi. Another accused, Abhishek, was arrested from Etawah, where he had allegedly been hiding," the police officer said.

Scooter-borne men fire at bus, injure 2 in Gzb

DIPIKAKIROLA
Ghaziabad, September 29

Two scooter-borne men allegedly followed a private bus from Lal Kuan before opening multiple rounds of fire at it on the Delhi-Meerut Expressway late Monday night, injuring the conductor and another passenger. The incident took place near Hi-Tech College in the Masuri area, said officials. The bus, bearing registration number UP15FT0038, was travelling from Usmanpur in Delhi to Usaith in Badaun when the firing took place. According to the driver's account to police, the two men on the scooter had been following the bus since Lal Kuan and allegedly made several attempts to target it.

The attackers eventually opened fire from the conductor's side as the bus was moving towards Meerut. Several rounds were fired, following which panic spread among those travelling in the bus.

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WOMEN'S SAFETY

Delhi maps danger spots, boosts police & plugs CCTV gaps: Sood

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 29

The Delhi government is working on identifying vulnerable locations, strengthening police presence and addressing gaps in surveillance infrastructure as part of measures aimed at improving women's safety in the capital, Minister Ashish Sood said on Tuesday.

Sood said the government was examining "dark spots" not only from the perspective of inadequate street lighting but also poor mobile network connectivity, which can affect people's ability to seek assistance in emergencies.

"Women's safety is a very important issue. From police reforms to identifying dark spots in Delhi. Dark spots not only in terms of light but also in terms of network connectivity of mobiles," he said.

The minister said several measures had been initiated since the Rekha Gupta-led government took charge, including greater deployment of women personnel at police stations.

"On all those dark spots, increased deployment of women in police stations and many such reforms are continuously happening after the arrival of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta's government," Sood said.

He said the government was treating women's safety as a sensitive area requiring attention across multiple departments and systems. "We consider this a sensitive issue," he said.

Sood also raised questions over the previous government's CCTV camera programme, alleging irregularities in the installation of cameras intended to improve women's safety.

"Arvind Kejriwal and his government have also committed a huge scam involving the CCTV cameras that were supposed to be installed for women's safety," he alleged. He said the government was now working to address gaps in the existing surveillance system and other safety-related infrastructure.

"We are fixing all those shortcomings," Sood said.

CLOSER LOOK



» Sood said the government was examining 'dark spots' not only from the perspective of inadequate street lighting but also poor mobile network connectivity, which can affect people's ability to seek assistance in emergencies

» 'Women's safety is a very important issue. From police reforms to identifying dark spots in Delhi. Dark spots not only in terms of light but also in terms of network connectivity of mobiles'

Min: Every unauthorised colony will be developed

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 29

Delhi Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood on Tuesday said the government was accelerating development works in unauthorised colonies across the national capital, while accusing the previous government of attempting to obstruct ongoing projects.

Speaking during a programme related to development projects in unauthorised colonies, Sood said the Urban Development Department was undertaking infrastructure work in areas that had remained in need of civic improvements. "Our Urban Development Department is carrying out development work in unauthorised colonies," Sood said.

Taking a dig at the previous government, the minister alleged that opposition to the ongoing projects was aimed at slowing down development after the current government began delivering projects.

"In contrast, when the previous government sees that we have achieved what they could not, they act like a naraz phupha, creating obstacles and trying to derail progress at every turn," he said. Sood said such attempts would not affect the government's development agenda and asserted that projects were being taken forward across unauthorised colonies.

"Such tactics will no longer work," he said.

The minister said projects involving hundreds of crores of rupees had already been inaugurated in unauthorised colonies and indicated that the government planned to expand development works to other such settlements across Delhi.

DELHI MEET



Prime Minister Narendra Modi during a meeting with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta PTI

Delhi pollution plan adds 30 EV sweepers, real-time PM tracking

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

Delhi's pollution-control strategy is set to move beyond major roads and seasonal measures, with the Cabinet approving 30 electric mechanical sweepers for smaller roads and a real-time system to track sources of PM2.5 and PM10.

At a Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday, the government approved a grant to the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) for procuring 30 EV-based mechanical road sweeping machines (MRSMs). The machines will be deployed across around 609 km of smaller roads, covering 854 roads in 250 wards.

The 10-year cost of the mechanised cleaning initiative has been estimated at Rs 393.73 crore. The MCD will deploy and operate the machines on the ground, with the government saying the use of electric vehicles would ensure that the pollution-control exercise itself remains environmentally friendly. Gupta said, "The government is not looking at pollution merely as a problem that intensifies during winter, but is working continuously and scientifically on pollution sources throughout the year."

The second Cabinet decision involves developing a continuous, real-time source apportionment system for PM2.5 and PM10 in collaboration with IIT Delhi. The system will analyse the contribution of different pollution sources over a 24-hour period, including vehicular emissions, road dust and biomass burning.

As part of the project, the existing super site at Rouse Avenue will be reactivated, while the mobile laboratory will also be revived for targeted studies of pollution hotspots and local sources. The five-year collaboration with IIT Delhi is estimated to cost Rs 19.22 crore and will include a real-time dashboard, analytical reporting and capacity building for Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC) officials.

CIC PUSH: MCD may put dangerous buildings online

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

With dangerous buildings posing a potential risk to residents and passers-by, the Central Information Commission (CIC) has asked the MCD to consider putting a searchable, ward-wise list of such structures in the public domain, along with details of notices and action taken.

In an order concerning an RTI application seeking information on such buildings, the Commission said "such disclosure was directly linked to public safety and could help residents, pedestrians and others take precautions while approaching or passing by such structures."

The CIC invoked its powers under Section 25(5) of the Right to Information Act, 2005, to recommend that the MCD examine the feasibility of putting the information on its official website in an easily accessible format.

The Commission suggested that the proposed database should, wherever permissible under the law, contain the location or address of the building, date of its identification or survey, status of notices issued and details of action taken by the civic body. Information protected from disclosure under statutory exemptions would remain excluded. The order noted that proactive disclosure would advance the objectives of Sections 4(1)(b), 4(2), 4(3) and 4(4) of the RTI Act and reduce the need for citizens to file individual RTI applications to obtain information concerning dangerous structures.

The CIC further recommended that the MCD update the information periodically. It said "details of newly identified dangerous buildings, subsequent action and changes in their status should be incorporated within a reasonable period through an appropriate mechanism."

Dengue, malaria cases surge in Delhi

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 29

Delhi has recorded a sharp rise in dengue and malaria cases this month, with the number of infections nearly tripling since August, according to the latest data from the Municipal Corporation of Delhi. The city has reported 597 dengue cases and 214 malaria cases so far this year, including 286 dengue and 124 malaria cases in September, the MCD's weekly vector-borne disease report showed. The latest figures mark a steep rise from the numbers recorded till the end of August, with September accounting for a substantial share of the year's cases. In the week ending September 26 alone, Delhi reported 85 new dengue and 29 malaria cases.

Slap row: AAP leaders detained during protest

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

AAP Delhi president Saurabh Bharadwaj and MLA Jarnail Singh were detained by Delhi Police on Tuesday while protesting outside the police headquarters here, demanding an FIR against BJP's Parvesh Verma for allegedly slapping a man during a road inspection in west Delhi.

Bharadwaj and Singh, along with the detained AAP workers, were later released. The protest came amid a political row over Sunday's incident in Tilak Nagar, where Verma was inspecting road construction when Singh arrived and questioned the quality of the work. Singh allegedly peeled off portions of a newly-laid road, saying the material was of poor quality and could be scraped away easily.

The incident was being recorded by 22-year-old Sahib Singh, whom Verma allegedly slapped. Bharadwaj, in a post on X, said, "It's not about one Verma slapping one 22-year-old man, its about this new culture of politics. Look around and identify the local goons in your colony, the people who are abusing and intimidating residents.

"Police and the government should ensure justice..," he said.

DDA launches digital map for areas planned under MPD

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) has made the Land Use Plan, under the Master Plan for Delhi (MPD) 2047, available as a GIS-based interactive digital map, enabling users to search, zoom, and pinpoint locations down to plot level, officials said on Tuesday.

"For the first time, citizens can access designated land-use information about their area or property online, without having to visit civic or local body offices or rely on third parties. The GIS-based interactive Land Use Plan of MPD-2047 is available on the official DDA website," DDA said. Citizens and other stakeholders can search for a particular area, location or property and directly view its designated land-use category on the map, it added.

DELHI SIR

Over 4L hearings held on notices issued for discrepancies in forms

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

The Delhi poll body has conducted more than four lakh hearings for voters issued notices over "unmapped with previous SIR" and other "discrepancies" during the ongoing revision of electoral rolls, officials said on Tuesday.

According to the office of the Delhi chief electoral officer (CEO), 4,01,670 such hearings have been conducted so far.

The draft electoral roll published on August 31 had over 97 lakh electors, of whom 33.13 lakh were issued notices over "discrepancies" in their enumeration forms, including cases where their details could not be matched with the electoral roll prepared during the previous SIR in 2002.

The poll body reiterated that the issuance of a notice did not mean that an elector's name would be deleted from the electoral roll, adding that the voters would be allowed to submit documents and respond to the notices.

"No name will be deleted from the draft electoral roll without following due process. The concerned persons will be allowed to present their case and to appeal," the CEO's office said.

It added that disposal of notices would be carried out within the prescribed schedule and the final electoral roll would be published after the completion of the process.

To make the process easier for voters, booth-level officers (BLOs) have now been asked to visit the homes of those issued notices in unmapped and logical discrepancy cases and collect the required documents.

The documents will be uploaded on the ECINET portal and placed before the electoral registration officer (ERO) for a decision, the CEO's office said, adding that such voters would not have to appear for a hearing before the ERO or the assistant ERO's office.

"Only in exceptional circumstances, as decided by the ERO, the hearing will be held preferably online," it said.

Several prominent voters, including former deputy prime minister L K Advani, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, former vice-president Jagdeep Dhankhar, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Election Commissioner S S Sandhu and former Delhi chief minister Arvind Kejriwal, had also received notices.

Officials said the details of most of these voters had been validated through field verification and their names reserved for inclusion in the final electoral roll.

No Eligible Voter to be excluded and No ineligible Person to be included

Special Intensive Revision, Delhi

SIR 2026 DELHI

In case of any person to whom notice has been issued during the ongoing SIR

(There is no longer a need to visit the ERO/AERO office for a hearing.)

BLOs will now visit voters homes to collect the necessary documents. Please provide the BLO with the documents prescribed by the Election Commission of India.

Scan the provided QR code for information regarding the relevant documents.

Revised SIR Schedule

Revision Activities	Revise Schedule
Period for filling claim & objections	31.08.2026 to 30.10.2026
Notice Phase/Disposal of claims & objections	31.08.2026 to 30.11.2026
Final publication	04.12.2026

Fill Appropriate Form:

FORM-6
Application for inclusion of Name in Electoral Roll for new voter.
Eligible voters whose name does not reflect in the electoral roll Please fill Form-6 (Along with the Declaration Form)

Form 7: Objection for Proposed Inclusion/Deletion of Name in Existing Electoral Roll.

Form 8: For Correction to particulars entered in Electoral Roll

Fill out and submit the form:
1. At the ERO / AERO office
2. With the BLO
3. At designated locations

To fill out the above forms online, visit the Citizen Service Portal:
voters.eci.gov.in Or Use the ECINet Mobile App

Special camps will be organized at all educational institutions (colleges, universities) in Delhi for new and young voters aged 18 and above on September 30, and October 7 and 8, 2026, from 9:00 AM to 3:00 PM.
BLO will be available to assist you.

Special camps will be organized at all polling stations in Delhi on October 4 and 11, 2026, from 10:00 AM to 5:00 PM.
BLO will be available to assist you.

Note: Fill out Forms 6, 7, and 8 by 30/10/2026, to ensure the electoral roll is accurate and up-to-date.

For matters related to claims and objections or to check your name in the electoral roll, visit: voters.eci.gov.in or www.ceodelhi.gov.in

voters.eci.gov.in

ECINet app

Chief Electoral Officer, Delhi
Old St. Stephen's College Building, Kashmere Gate, Delhi – 110006
Websites: www.ceodelhi.gov.in, voters.eci.gov.in

Voter Helpline No. 1950

Follow: /ceodelhioffice

DIP/Shabdarth/Display/0100/26-27

EDITORIAL

A Crisis Beyond Rainfall

India's reservoirs are sending a warning that should not be dismissed as another seasonal fluctuation. Storage across the country's major monitored reservoirs has fallen to around 70 per cent of capacity, with levels reported to be at their lowest for this point of the year in a decade. A weak monsoon has inevitably contributed to the decline, but the numbers expose a deeper vulnerability. Despite decades of investment in dams, canals and irrigation networks, India remains heavily dependent on favourable rainfall to replenish reservoirs, sustain agriculture and secure drinking water. When rainfall disappoints, pressure quickly spreads from farms to cities, power generation and industry. The challenge, therefore, is not simply managing a bad monsoon. It is reducing the economy's vulnerability to increasingly unpredictable rainfall.

Climate change makes the old approach even less sustainable. Rainfall is becoming more erratic, with prolonged dry periods increasingly interrupted by intense downpours that often produce floods rather than replenish groundwater effectively. India must consequently focus as much on managing water as on creating additional storage. Groundwater, which supports millions of farms and households, cannot remain the automatic fallback whenever reservoirs decline. Aquifer recharge, restoration of wetlands and local water bodies, rainwater harvesting and reuse of treated wastewater need to move from scattered initiatives to mainstream policy. Agriculture requires particular attention. Incentives that encourage water-intensive crops in water-stressed regions have created a mismatch between cropping patterns and ecological capacity. Expanding micro-irrigation and encouraging crops suited to local rainfall conditions can reduce pressure without compromising agricultural productivity. Cities must also stop treating distant reservoirs and groundwater as limitless sources while lakes disappear beneath construction and enormous quantities of rainwater escape through drains.

The rapidly expanding data-centre industry adds another dimension to this challenge. India needs data centres to support cloud computing, artificial intelligence and its growing digital economy, but large facilities can consume substantial quantities of water for cooling. Their concentration in already water-stressed urban and industrial regions could intensify competition among households, agriculture and businesses, particularly during dry years. This is not an argument against digital infrastructure. It is an argument for planning it intelligently. Water availability should influence where new facilities are located, while operators should be encouraged to use recycled water, closed-loop systems and cooling technologies that minimise dependence on freshwater. India cannot build its digital future by quietly increasing pressure on one of its most constrained natural resources.

The falling reservoir levels should ultimately be viewed as a governance test rather than merely a meteorological problem. India cannot determine how much rain the monsoon delivers, but it can determine how efficiently that water is captured, allocated, recycled and conserved. Water policy remains fragmented across agriculture, cities, groundwater, industry and river management even though all compete within the same hydrological system. Climate uncertainty makes such fragmentation increasingly costly. A strong monsoon can temporarily conceal poor water management; a weak one exposes it immediately. India's long-term water security will therefore depend not on hoping every monsoon delivers enough rain, but on building an economy capable of functioning responsibly when it does not.

LETTER

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Two-state path

India's reiteration of support for a two-state solution is significant as the Israel-Palestine conflict continues. A durable settlement requires sustained diplomacy, protection of civilians and meaningful negotiations. India should continue supporting peaceful dialogue while providing humanitarian assistance and encouraging both sides to pursue a viable political settlement.

DINESH SHARMA,
MUMBAI

You can also send your comments to The Editor, *Millennium Post*, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

World Wants Sides. India Wants Space

As the world fragments into rival camps, India is finding out that autonomy is never about eschewing choices. It is about having the strength to make them

TALKING SHOP



RAJEEV NARAYAN

THE WRITER IS A JOURNALIST & COMMUNICATIONS SPECIALIST

"I am entitled to have my own side."
– S Jaishankar

There was a time when foreign policy came with simple instructions. Pick a side. Stay there. Know who your friends are, preferably your enemies too. That world is disappearing. Today, the United States wants countries to take a harder line against Russia. Europe is worrying about its own security and economic future. China is challenging the established order. Russia remains important to India for energy, defence and diplomacy. The Global South wants a greater voice. And trade itself is being shaped by geopolitics.

India, meanwhile, would rather keep the doors open. That is not necessarily indecision. It is just a reflection of India's interests. New Delhi wants a strong relationship with Washington, a functioning one with Moscow, stable ties with the Gulf, deep engagement with Europe, a way to manage competition with China and a larger role in the Global South.

At the United Nations this week, India's position has continued to emphasise reform of an international system that it says is struggling to deal with contemporary conflicts. The problem is that the world is becoming less comfortable with such flexibility.

No Easy Choices

The latest pressure point is Russia. External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar has raised India's concerns with US Secretary of State Marco Rubio over the new US sanctions law targeting major buyers of Russian energy.

India's imports of Russian crude have already begun falling: imports dropped 16.5 per cent in August to about 2.1 million barrels a day, with preliminary September data pointing to another decline.

But this is not simply about choosing Moscow or Washington. It is about energy security, prices, trade, strategic relationships and the consequences of decisions made thousands of kilometres away. India just cannot afford a foreign policy in which every relationship is viewed through somebody else's alliance map. That is the real test of strategic autonomy. It is not saying no to everyone. It is being able to say yes to different countries for different reasons.

India may buy oil from one country, technology from another, defence equipment from a third, attract investment from a fourth and cooperate diplomatically with all of them. The world may find that untidy. India has to find it useful.



India is pushing reform in a global order that is preoccupied with contemporary conflicts

THE HARDER THE WORLD PUSHES COUNTRIES INTO CAMPS, THE MORE VALUABLE INDIA'S ROOM FOR MANOEUVRE BECOMES

Room Has Value

There is a second and more important part of this strategy as well: economics. India's expanding network of free trade agreements is no coincidence. Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said last week that recent FTAs have been designed to give long-term investors greater predictability and help diversify India's export supply chains. That is strategic autonomy in another form.

The more markets India can access, the less dependent it becomes on any single market. The more supply chains it can plug into, the harder it becomes to isolate. The more products it can make competitively, the greater its bargaining power. This is why strategic autonomy cannot survive on diplomacy alone.

A country that depends on somebody else for energy, technology, capital, critical components or markets will eventually discover that foreign policy has a price tag. India's answer cannot be to retreat from the world. It has to be the opposite: become more deeply connected to more parts of it. For diversification is not distance; it is insurance.

Strength Buys Space

This is where India's current foreign-policy experiment becomes interesting. Strategic autonomy sounds grand when discussed at diplomatic conferences. In practice, it is quite mundane. It means having enough economic strength to withstand pressure. Enough military capability to protect interests. Enough domestic capacity to reduce dangerous dependencies. Enough diplomatic credibility to maintain relationships that may not like each other. And enough confidence not to confuse friendship with obedience.

India's room to manoeuvre will not remain automatically available, or in perpetuity. The more the world divides into competing camps, the more pressure there will be to choose one. That pressure may increase because India is becoming more important.

There is an important distinction between being neutral and being independent. Neutrality can mean staying out. Strategic autonomy means staying engaged without surrendering the right to decide. That is a much harder game.

Stakes are Higher

India has played versions of it for decades. The difference now is that the stakes are higher. Much higher. India is no longer a small developing economy trying to keep its head above the geopolitical water. It is a major market, a growing economic power, a nuclear state, a technology and services hub and a consequential player in global supply chains.

That gives India something valuable. Space. The world may demand sides. Washington will have its expectations. Moscow its interests. Beijing its ambitions. Europe its priorities. India will have its own. And perhaps that is the point of strategic autonomy in 2026... Not refusing to choose, but making sure that when the moment comes, the choice is India's to make.

Views expressed are personal

Rekindling the 'Nalanda' Spirit

Nalanda's resurrection had represented more than rebuilding a university, seeking instead to recover an enduring tradition of knowledge, dialogue and intellectual exchange

BHARAT REIMAGINED



ANIRBAN GANGULY

THE WRITER IS MEMBER NEC, BJP & CHAIRMAN, DR SYAMA PRASAD MOOKERJEE RESEARCH FOUNDATION



Under PM Modi, Nalanda is being reimagined as a bridge between heritage and modernity

Within 10 days of taking the oath as Prime Minister for the third time in the summer of 2024, Narendra Modi inaugurated the new campus of the resurrected Nalanda University. His commitment to rekindling institutions and symbols that had defined civilisational India in the past was undiminished and undiluted.

The resurrection of Nalanda University in a new form was also deeply symbolic. It was not the resurrection of a mere physical structure; it signified the reawakening of the Nalanda Spirit. It was one of the finest moments in Narendra Modi's 25-year-long tenure as an elected head of government.

The Nalanda Spirit was a worldview, a stream and tradition of wisdom, education, dialogue and dissemination that had defined civilisational India in the past. In the civilisational era, it was also the Nalanda Spirit that distinguished Bharat as a knowledge society.

Thinkers, philosophers, students and seekers of the ancient world converged upon Nalanda to replenish their stocks of wisdom and knowledge. A rekindled Nalanda today will eventually grow and stand as a radiant lighthouse for the Asian century.

Nalanda University is also an example of how Prime Minister Modi leads India towards emerging as a pre-eminent *Kalyana-Mitra* globally. It represents a force for good and creative effort, eventually becoming a centre of convergence of global ideas and positive aspirations. The Nalanda of the past was such a node of the ancient world; the new Nalanda aspires to regain that pre-eminence.

The "Nalanda Spirit" is central to the Nalanda effort today. That spirit is sought to be brought to the fore through the "*Nalanda Spirit* course" – a first-of-its-kind pan-university course on decolonisation. The objective is to enable students to absorb Nalanda's intellectual heritage and India's knowledge traditions through archaeology, inscriptions, classical texts and competing historiographical interpretations.

The intellectual and experiential rigour that had defined and shaped Nalanda, and had become "*brand Nalanda*" in the ancient world, is being nurtured and brought back to the surface. *Vāda, Samvāda,* intense intellectual debates and critical examination of positions were the Nalanda approach of the past. That habit and training are being reintroduced through the new Nalanda's "Nalanda Spirit" course.

THE NEW NALANDA AIMS TO COMBINE INDIA'S INTELLECTUAL HERITAGE WITH CONTEMPORARY ACADEMIC PROGRAMMES AND PERSPECTIVES

New and refreshing academic programmes extend the decolonisation approach into the curriculum. Interestingly, *Sāstrārtha*, the classical Indian method of vibrant debate, has been revived at the new Nalanda, emerging as a platform for cross-disciplinary dialogue. The *Nalanda Tradition and Languages series* aims to engage with India's textual, linguistic and intellectual traditions through various Indian languages.

Traditions and the traditional are being woven into, and are driving, the modern quest for addressing emerging challenges, while engendering new thought and perspectives shaped by Eastern thought.

Among the plethora of activities and projects that the revived Nalanda has initiated is also the "*Nalanda Development Dialogue*", which positions India in the global development discourse. It seeks to place a "Global South" vantage point in the development discourse, anchored by India, by diving deep into her civilisational wisdom and by making Nalanda the field for such a discourse to take root. Similarly, the *Kautilya Global Centre for State Capacity* is working to ground governance models and approaches in indigenous thought.

The Nalanda of today negates the naysayers who have argued that India is incapable of thinking in terms of civilisations and thinking long-term. Some who have tried to find fault, or have tried to pick holes in the Nalanda project and its imagination, have forgotten the dark days into which the project had fallen during the Congress-led UPA era.

An inflated Governing Board, presided over by the economist Amartya Sen, displayed a most callous attitude while claiming to incubate the project. The Congress's favourite mediocre academics, who were also favourites of Prof Sen, were selected to lead it, bypassing all norms.

Rajgir, where the Nalanda campus was designated to come up, was completely ignored. The Governing Board held its meetings all across the world, while discussion and action on the campus site, the proposed structures and courses remained stunted.

Prof Sen and his academic coterie on the Board never felt that they were accountable to the people of India, to India's civilisational commitment and, above all, to the Nalanda Spirit. Their flourishing talk, sweeping promises and tall claims of being the sole arbiters and repositories of what a revived Nalanda would mean and express came to nought. It was left to Modi to re-energise this crucial civilisational project and to see it through.

While looking back at Narendra Modi's 12 years at the national helm, among the many dimensions that are striking is the revival of Nalanda University. It stands and grows as a civilisational knowledge lighthouse of the modern world. It is also growing as a defining pillar of the emerging Asian century.

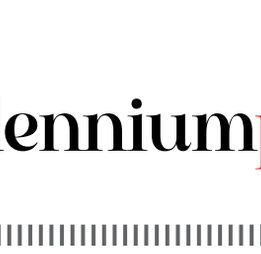
In the growth and radiance of the Nalanda Spirit also lies India's national and global good.

Views expressed are personal

Kunti and the Cost of Silence

Kunti's life showed how courage and resilience could coexist with consequences created by fear, silence and truths revealed too late

BHARAT KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS CHAIRPERSON, BHARAT KI SOCH

Kunti survived almost every crisis life placed before her. But one decision, made in fear when she was young, survived too. Across the Mahabharata, she shows remarkable courage in adversity, assumes responsibilities she did not choose and becomes a source of stability for the Pandavas. Yet the son she relinquished before marriage, and the truth she kept hidden about him, remained an unresolved part of her life until the eve of war. That tension between courage and silence is what makes Kunti so compelling. Her story asks whether strength in one part of life can absolve us from consequences left unattended in another.

Born as Pritha and raised by Kuntibhoja, Kunti receives from Sage Durvasa a mantra that allows her to invoke a deity. Still young, she invokes Surya and gives birth to Karna before marriage. Faced with fear, social pressure and the vulnerability of an unmarried young woman in her circumstances, she sends the infant away. That context matters. It helps us understand the decision without pretending that its consequences disappeared with the moment that produced it. A difficult choice may be understandable and still create an obligation that survives long after the original crisis has passed.

Marriage to Pandu brings Kunti into the Kuru household, but stability is brief. Pandu's death leaves her responsible for five young princes whose future is uncertain. She returns to Hastinapura without formal authority, yet becomes the figure around whom the Pandavas find continuity. Later, the house of lac forces the family into escape and concealment. Kunti adapts repeatedly without allowing the larger purpose of protecting the family to collapse. Leadership often reveals itself most clearly when formal structures weaken and someone must preserve direction without waiting for authority to be granted. Resilience, in this sense, is not simply enduring hardship. It is knowing what must remain constant while being willing to change everything else around it.

Her stewardship also extends beyond her biological sons. After Madri's death, Kunti raises Nakula and Sahadeva alongside Yudhishthira, Bhima and Arjuna. Their different parentage does not become the basis for a divided household. The lesson has clear institutional relevance. Leaders frequently inherit teams, decisions and commitments created by others. Once responsibility has been accepted, fairness demands that people are not treated according to whether they were personally chosen, but according to the duty now owed to them. Yet the contrast with Karna quietly remains. Kunti becomes capable of embracing responsibilities she inherits, even as the responsibility she once relinquished continues outside the family she is holding together.



The son Kunti relinquished before marriage remained an unresolved part of her life

LEADERSHIP REQUIRES KNOWING WHEN TO STEP FORWARD AND WHEN TO STEP AWAY

That complexity becomes sharper during the episode of Bakasura. While the Pandavas are living in disguise, the Brahmin family sheltering them faces the terrible obligation of sending one member of the household, along with food, to the rakshasa. Kunti offers Bhima in their place because she knows his extraordinary strength and believes he can destroy the threat. Her decision shows courage and gratitude towards those who had given the Pandavas shelter, but it also places her son at serious risk. This is precisely what gives the episode its moral weight. A leader may sometimes ask the person best equipped for a difficult task to bear greater risk, but capability does not remove the obligation to justify why that risk should be borne. Sound judgement requires confidence in ability, but also accountability for the consequences of assigning danger to someone else.

Kunti's influence over her sons also demonstrates why authority must be exercised carefully. When the Pandavas return after Arjuna wins Draupadi at her swayamvara, they tell Kunti that they have brought something home. Without seeing what they mean, she tells them to share it. Once she understands the situation, she recognises the implications of her words. Draupadi's eventual marriage to the five brothers involves wider deliberation and cannot be reduced to Kunti's statement alone. Nor should Draupadi be treated merely as the object of a decision made around her. Her position and agency matter within any serious reading of the episode. What Kunti's words nevertheless illustrate is the asymmetry of authority. A remark made casually by someone with influence may be received as an instruction by those who do not feel equally free to disregard it. Leadership therefore requires precision not only because words can be misunderstood, but because hierarchy changes the weight they carry.

Kunti's life also complicates the idea that patience is always virtuous. As conflict with the Kauravas approaches its decisive stage, she sends a forceful message through Krishna, invoking the example of Vidula and reminding her sons of their responsibilities. This is not a simple rejection of reconciliation. It is a recognition that accommodation has limits. Patience serves leadership only while it leaves open the possibility of correction. When delay merely allows a problem to deepen, restraint can become passivity. Organisations face the same danger when damaging conduct or unresolved governance failures are tolerated in the hope that time alone will improve them.

Yet the hardest test of Kunti's own principle of timely action lies in Karna. Before the war, she finally approaches him and reveals that he is her son. By then, however, Karna is not a man waiting to discover where he belongs. He has been raised by Radha and Adhiratha, and his identity has been shaped by the people who cared for him and by those who recognised and supported him when others did not. His loyalty to Duryodhana cannot therefore be dismissed simply as an obstacle to Kunti's wish that he join the Pandavas. It is also rooted in gratitude, friendship and a sense of obligation.

Karna refuses to abandon Duryodhana, although he promises Kunti that she will still have five sons, agreeing not to kill four of the Pandavas while leaving his conflict with Arjuna unresolved. His response exposes the limits of delayed truth. The truth of birth cannot automatically erase the truth of lived relationships. Kunti's disclosure matters, but by the time it comes, years of identity, loyalty and grievance stand between revelation and repair.

Institutions encounter a similar problem when difficult information is postponed because disclosure appears costly. A conflict of interest, succession concern or governance weakness may remain hidden in the hope that the immediate difficulty will pass. But silence does not freeze a problem. Decisions continue to be made around it and relationships harden around incomplete information. A truth postponed does not necessarily become easier to reveal. It may simply become more expensive to confront.

After Karna's death, the cost of silence widens again when Kunti reveals his identity to the Pandavas. The truth does not merely alter how they remember Karna. It forces them to reinterpret a conflict in which they had acted without knowledge that could have changed the moral meaning of their choices. Yudhishthira's anguish gives the episode its final ethical force. Information withheld from those who are directly affected does not remain private simply because the motive for withholding it was personal. When others are making consequential decisions, silence can become part of the decision itself.

This is also where transparency must be distinguished from accountability. Kunti ultimately speaks, first to Karna and later to the Pandavas, but eventual disclosure cannot restore every choice that earlier knowledge might have made possible. Accountability therefore requires more than telling the truth at some point. It requires recognising when others need that truth while they can still act upon it.

After the war, Kunti does not remain indefinitely at the centre of the world she helped preserve. When Dhritarashtra and Gandhari withdraw to the forest, she chooses to accompany them rather than remain within the comforts of the kingdom ruled by her sons. The decision has two dimensions. It reflects dignity towards those who have suffered on the opposing side, and it also shows an ability to relinquish influence once the next generation is capable of carrying responsibility itself. Leadership is not complete merely when we know when to step forward. It also requires knowing when to step away. Mentorship should prepare others to exercise judgement independently rather than make them permanently dependent on the person who guided them through crisis.

Kunti's life therefore cannot be reduced either to admiration or blame. She shows courage, adaptability, stewardship and moral strength. She protects people beyond her immediate self-interest, understands capability and recognises that patience cannot continue indefinitely. Yet her story also shows that understandable fear can produce lasting harm, and that silence acquires its own moral weight when others begin to live within the consequences of what has been withheld.

That is why Kunti remains relevant not only as a figure of endurance, but as a study in responsibility. Leadership rarely operates under perfect conditions. Decisions are made amid fear, competing loyalties and incomplete information. Context matters, but so do consequences. Courage deserves recognition, but courage in one part of life does not cancel the need for accountability in another.

Can we honour Kunti's courage while still holding her accountable for what her silence cost others?

Views expressed are personal

Warnings from a Warming Himalayas

***Climate change had weakened the Himalayas while reckless construction and ecological disruption had magnified the consequences of extreme weather events; writes* Sunita Narain**

As I write this, over 1,300 lives are confirmed lost and many thousands are still missing in the floods in Nepal, as the mighty Himalayas came down as rubble. This is an enormous and painful human tragedy, but it is also about wilful actions and inactions of humans. It is about our mindset, the belief that we can re-engineer everything; that we are in control of the universe and all things in it. This is on us.

Let me break this down. What happened in Nepal on August 26? The images are of the mountain coming down as the flash flood and massive quantity of debris buried everything in its path. We know now that this flash flood was not caused by an extreme cloudburst. It was triggered by the collapse of a high-altitude glacier near the Langtang Lirung peak. An estimated 142 million cubic metres of ice and rocks were dislodged, creating a 5.2 magnitude seismic event. This led to the formation of natural dams, behind which water and moraine accumulated. When the dams broke, they unleashed devastating floods downstream.

Why? There is no single headline reason, but two events have greatly contributed to this and other such tragedies. One is the well-documented warming caused by climate change. It is literally weakening the Himalayas—the temperature rise melts glaciers; this, in turn, corrodes the moraine slopes. It is a ticking bomb. In addition, climate change is leading to increased frequency and intensity of extreme weather events, bringing flood and landslide catastrophes.

NEPAL'S TRAGEDY REVEALS THE DANGEROUS CONSEQUENCES OF TREATING NATURE AS ENDLESSLY MANAGEABLE

We are complicit in this, particularly the countries that have contributed the most to the stock of greenhouse gases in the atmosphere, which is driving up temperatures. There is no getting away from the historical responsibility of the richest and most developed countries. UNEP estimates that the world will overshoot the 1.5°C threshold within a few years. Scientists know that beyond 1.5°C, the impacts would be cascading and even more devastating—from the collapse of ice sheets to disruptions in ocean currents. Yet, we seem sanguine about this breakdown in our Earth's system.

Let's get back to the Himalayas. We know that the climate change ticking bomb is exacerbated by the "nature" of development in these ecological hotspots. We talk ad nauseam about adaptation and taking the changing climate into account, but we never do. In the Indian Himalayas, hydroelectric project after project is coming up, literally back-to-back, so that the Ganga is re-engineered. Then we are tunnelling into mountains and building roads, often without provision for slope management.

But the fact is we are not hearing the message that nature is giving us, loud and clear: change your mindset. Your thinking that you can dominate me, bring me to my knees, will not work. Change or perish is the message. The question is whether we can hear it amid the cacophony of our distractions.

Congress demands PM's resignation for 'match-fixing' polls through CEC

Continued from Page 1

The CWC resolution cited reports that the Election Commission had been reduced to a "one-man show", and that two Election Commissioners had raised 14 objections over 10 months regarding changes to Form 6 used in the SIR.

It questioned the exercise's constitutional validity, arguing that placing the burden of proving eligibility on citizens could violate Articles 14 and 326.

"An exercise of doubtful constitutional validity cannot be allowed to decide who may vote in the world's largest democracy," the resolution said.

"Today, the protector has become the predator," Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said, accusing the CEC of acting under the government's influence.

He demanded that data on major changes to electoral rolls be made public, deleted voters be given an opportunity to appeal, and a time-bound inquiry be held wherever serious discrepancies emerged.

Briefing reporters, general secretary KC Venugopal along with Jairam Ramesh said 68 members attended the meeting, and that INDIA bloc leaders would meet on Wednesday to chart further action.

"Rahul Gandhi himself has been raising these issues related to polls in Haryana, Karnataka, Maharashtra and some did not believe him but now he has been proven right," Ramesh said.

"The elections in our country are not fair and transparent. They are match-fixing elections - match fixing between the Election Commission and PM-HM duo," he alleged.

A resolution passed by the CWC said it recognises that what was once Rahul Gandhi's solitary conviction has become a nationwide demand for accountability, transparency, and the restoration of the sanctity of India's electoral system.

"In line with the mood of the nation, the CWC, therefore, resolves to: Demand the immediate resignation of the CEC, who has forfeited all moral and institutional authority. Demand the immediate suspension of the SIR in view of serious concerns regarding the integrity and transparency of the electoral rolls being prepared through the SIR, as well as the constitutional validity of the SIR process itself," the resolution said.

The BJP and its handpicked officials must understand that this "brazen theft" of the people's franchise will not go unanswered, it said.

The Congress party will resist it in Parliament, in the courts and on the streets, until the guilty are punished, every citizen's vote is secure and the ECI is restored as an independent constitutional authority, the resolution said.

"Gyanesh Kumar is only a tool. When dictators lose the confidence of the people they seek extraordinary tools to stay in power. His actions on SIR cannot be without the concurrence of his masters - PM and HM," Venugopal said.

"There is a moral responsibility for the PM on this issue. We are demanding resignation from the PM on moral grounds," he said.

The meeting comes days after The Indian Express claimed that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi had objected on record at least 14 times over the past 10 months to decisions and orders on SIR that they said were issued without their knowledge or recommendation.

Meanwhile, top leaders of the INDIA bloc will meet here today to finalise an action plan for a joint agitation over alleged irregularities in the SIR exercise and to press for CEC Kumar's resignation.

Sources said the draft notice for a fresh bid to move a motion in the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha for the removal of CEC Kumar was ready and would be deliberated upon for approval at the meeting.

Congress chief Kharge, former party chief Rahul Gandhi, AICC general secretaries Jairam Ramesh and K C Venugopal, the TMC's Mamata Banerjee and Abhishek Banerjee, and leaders from parties such as the SP, CPI, CPI(M), NCP(SP) and Shiv Sena (UBT), among others, will participate in the meeting.

While the DMK and the AAP have made it clear that they will not be part of the meeting, SP chief Akhilesh Yadav will also not attend on account of nominations for Rajya Sabha polls in UP and will send his representatives.

Speaking about the meeting, Venugopal said, "The Congress wants to hold a massive agitation to save democracy in the country with the help of all political parties. There will be valuable suggestions from leaders of the INDIA bloc tomorrow; after that we will sit and formalise the clear action plan for the future agitation."

"We will coordinate between the INDIA bloc agitation programme and that of the Congress," he told reporters.

Asked whether attempts would be made to get parties like the DMK and AAP on board, Venugopal said those types of issues would be discussed.

On the INDIA bloc meeting, DMK spokesperson TKS Elangovan said, "Ideologically, we all stand together. Maybe we are not part of the INDIA alliance. That is different. But in Parliament, we will support whoever brings a removal motion against Gyanesh Kumar... our leader had issued a statement. On many of the issues where other opposition parties oppose the BJP, we will also stand by them. That doesn't mean that we are together. We are not in the INDIA bloc."

The issue of alleged irregularities in the SIR is being seen by the opposition INDIA bloc as an opportunity to close ranks and corner the government.

CPI(M) general secretary M A Baby met AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal on Sunday, while TMC's Derek O'Brien met AAP Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh on Tuesday as opposition leaders worked on securing wider support for the fresh notice. Earlier, DMK leader Kanimozhi also met TMC supremo Mamata Banerjee in Kolkata on September 17.

Both AAP and DMK have agreed to back the opposition's proposed notice in Parliament to move a motion seeking CEC Kumar's removal, according to sources.

AAP formally walked out of the INDIA bloc in July 2025, after its ties with the Congress had deteriorated over electoral contests in Delhi and Punjab.

The DMK's ties with the Congress broke down after the 2026 Tamil Nadu Assembly elections, when the Congress extended support to actor-politician Vijay's Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) after the election.

Meanwhile, Maharashtra's Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) has written to the poll panel seeking four changes in the ECINet software in the notice phase of the SIR.

The CEO has echoed the demands earlier made by the two Election Commissioners regarding ECINet and the role of EROs, as reported by The Indian Express last week.

Maharashtra is currently in the notice phase of the SIR.

CEO S Chockalingam has written to the EC seeking greater discretion for Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) in handling cases in the notice phase.

The CEO has demanded that EROs be allowed to decide cases involving "logical discrepancies" after conducting a hearing.

The same demand for greater discretion for EROs had earlier been flagged by the two Election Commissioners - Vivek Joshi and Sukhbir Singh Sandhu.

Spring census maps 14,468 water sources across 10 states

15% population relies on spring water

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 29

THE REPORT WAS RELEASED AT THE VALEDICTORY CEREMONY OF THE NINTH INDIA INTERNATIONAL WATER WEEK (IIWW) 2026 AT BHARAT MANDAPAM ON SEPTEMBER 25

The second part of the country's first-ever spring census has enumerated 14,468 springs across 10 states, with Manipur and Maharashtra accounting for the largest number of such water sources, according to a report of the Jal Shakti Ministry.

The report was released at the valedictory ceremony of the ninth India International Water Week (IIWW) 2026 at Bharat Mandapam on September 25.

The census identified 3,941 springs in Manipur, 3,652 in Maharashtra, 1,957 in Odisha, 1,686 in West Bengal, 1,196 in Goa, 1,049 in Tripura, 792 in Assam, 148 in Telangana, 34 in Andhra Pradesh and 13 in Rajasthan.

The report, titled 'First Census of Springs (Volume II, Part-II)', covers Andhra Pradesh, Assam, Goa, Maharashtra, Manipur, Odisha, Rajasthan, Telangana, Tripura and West Bengal.

The report calls for systematic mapping to identify vulnerable and critical springs, ensure their protection during infrastructure development and facilitate preparation of detailed project reports for springshed management programmes.

An earlier Volume II report covering Bihar, Karnataka, Kerala, Ladakh, Sikkim and Tamil Nadu was published on India Water Day 2026.

According to the report, Maharashtra has 2,629 perennial, 909 seasonal and 114 dried springs. Of its 3,652 springs, 3,612 are located in rural areas and 40 in urban areas.

About 86.5 per cent are publicly owned and 13.5 per cent privately owned. Of 3,508 springs assessed for resource threats, 265, or 7.6 per cent, face threats.

Manipur has 3,419 perennial, 457 seasonal and 65 dried springs among its 3,941 inventoried springs. In the northeastern state, 91.4 per cent springs are publicly owned. Of the springs assessed for resource threats, 1,336, or 34.5 per cent, face threats. In the state, residents use 3,127 springs, while 634 are used by non-residents and 113 by wild animals.

From page 1

Top Court

"The way the Election Commission is functioning, there is serious doubt over whether the decisions are unanimous," he submitted.

"We will list this next week", the CJI said.

The PIL, filed by Patna resident Rakesh Kumar Singh, has urged the Supreme Court to examine whether Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar has been exercising powers vested in the Election Commission as a whole and, if so, declare such actions unauthorised. It also seeks an interim direction barring Kumar from functioning as CEC and asks that the Commission's business be conducted through unanimous decisions of the two Election Commissioners.

The plea centres on Article 324, arguing that electoral powers are vested in the multi-member Election Commission and cannot be exercised independently by its chairperson. It cites at least 14 objections recorded by Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi between October 2025 and August 2026 over communications allegedly issued without the Commission's approval, missing meeting agendas and minutes, changes to Form-6, electoral-roll database access, IT work allocation and appeals filed before West Bengal appellate tribunals.

The petitioner has sought preservation and production of the Commission's primary records, including minutes, agendas, approval sheets, file notings, IT-access records, server logs and database-change histories.

It has also asked the court to examine the legality of changes to Form-6, which Joshi reportedly objected to in May 2026, saying additional SIR-related disclosures could not be introduced without amending the electoral rules. Sandhu subsequently concurred with the objection.

The plea further raises concerns over centralisation of the electoral-roll database, access by field-level officers to ECINet and the authorisation of appeals filed in the Commission's name in West Bengal. It asks the court to examine these issues against the original records, while cautioning that the allegations should not be treated as conclusively established merely on the basis of media reports.

15-minute ride

was approved in 2014 and construction began in 2015. It was originally scheduled for completion in 2017 but faced repeated delays linked to land acquisition, tree-related clearances, construction around the Yamuna and the Covid-19 pandemic. The revised project cost rose from the initial estimate of around Rs.1,260 crore to Rs.1,635 crore. The project had also missed the June 30 deadline set earlier this year.

The new elevated stretch connects Mayur Vihar Phase-I with Sarai Kale Khan and merges with the existing Barapullah corridor.

Together, the elevated route will provide a signal-free stretch of around 9 km towards South Delhi and AIIMS. Both ramps have been completed, with one connecting the Mayur Vihar side and the other linking the new corridor to the existing stretch near Sarai Kale Khan.

A key engineering component is the bridge across the Yamuna floodplain. Its pillars have spans of nearly 125 metres, designed to reduce interference with the active river zone and minimise disruption to the river's natural flow. The corridor also includes a dedicated cycle track and pedestrian-friendly infrastructure, expanding the project beyond motor-vehicle connectivity.

Officials have estimated that the corridor could reduce the travel time between Noida/East Delhi and AIIMS from around 35-40 minutes to approximately 15 minutes, although the actual time saving will depend on traffic conditions.

Gupta said the opening reflected cooperation between the Centre and Delhi government. "Only with a double-engine government can Delhi's stalled projects be opened to the public. The Centre and the Delhi government are working together," she said.

She added that her government was planning several projects to tackle congestion, which she said had been neglected over the past 50 years.

Verma said the project had finally crossed the long wait. "Last year, we committed that the Barapullah flyover would be over in a year and we have done it. For the last 18 months, there has been no politics of allegations or excuses, but only work done by the government for the public," he said.

At the event, Shah also highlighted the connectivity benefits of the project, saying, "This will provide signal-free connectivity between East and South Delhi, making commuting smoother, providing relief from traffic jams, and saving travel time."

The other projects include the Mukarba Chowk underpass, which was also opened, and foundation stones for the Modi Mill-Savitri Cinema flyover and Loni underpass. The wider package is aimed at easing congestion at key locations across Delhi.

The Barapullah project has also faced scrutiny over its delays and cost escalation.

The Delhi Anti-Corruption Branch had registered a case concerning alleged irregularities linked to the project; the allegations remain under investigation.

China route

Another person said a Hotan route could reduce costs on services to Georgia, Baku, Central Asia and northern Europe.

The prolonged restrictions have weighed particularly heavily on Air India's long-haul operations. Former Air India CEO Campbell Wilson estimated in 2025 that the airline could lose about Rs 4,000 crore because of the closure, while the carrier had separately estimated a potential 12-month impact of around $600 million.

The discussions come as India-China air connectivity gradually resumes. China Southern Airlines restarted Guangzhou-New Delhi flights this month, while IndiGo and Air India have also restored direct services to China.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said on Monday that India-China ties were in a better position than in 2025, describing the change as a recovery from a relationship that had gone "so much off-track".

In a separate incident, Pakistan has blocked its airspace to a Russian flight carrying nuclear fuel for Bangladesh's Rooppur nuclear power plant.

At a time when Bangladesh has sought to rebuild ties with Pakistan, it has faced a reality check. The first batch of nuclear fuel for Unit-2 of Bangladesh's first nuclear power plant was scheduled to arrive on September 24.

The timing is significant as Bangladesh is looking to begin commercial operations at its first nuclear power plant at the earliest, as it faces its worst energy crises in decades. Against this backdrop, Pakistan's denial of airspace clearance is likely to delay the delivery of nuclear fuel and, potentially, affect the plant's operational timeline.

Sambhal

while Afroz was already in custody. The state government later confirmed the order and directed that he remain detained until October 12, 2026. His representations to the state and Centre were rejected, and the Allahabad High Court dismissed his habeas corpus petition on June 8 this year.

Afroz's lawyer, Divyesh Pratap Singh, argued that the police confession had been obtained under threats and torture.

He also questioned the alleged recovery of a .32 bore pistol, pointing to a forensic report that attributed the victim's fatal injuries to a .315-bore firearm. The Supreme Court noted that Afroz had already secured bail in all cases related to the incident. "In such circumstances, the process was made the punishment," the bench said, finding no sufficient link between the material relied upon and the detention authority's satisfaction.

The NSA permits preventive detention for up to 12 months, subject to statutory safeguards.

CISF jawan

NHPC hospital, the officials said, adding the deceased were identified as Assistant Commandant Ankit Kumar Pandey, Sub-Inspector Lakshman Singh and constables Rafiq Ahmed and Sandeep Kumar.

Following the firing, the accused was overpowered by his colleagues and subsequently arrested. The service weapon used in the incident was also seized as part of the investigation, they said.

The officials said senior CISF and police officers rushed to the scene and the exact circumstances that led to the argument and the subsequent firing are being ascertained.

'This is carnage'

The Solicitor General said the government would examine the matter and sought two weeks to discuss the issue with officials. He also said a balance would have to be found while acknowledging the need to address the concerns raised before the court.

The bench questioned where the large difference between the retailer price and MRP goes and who ultimately benefits from it. It also noted that pharmaceutical companies may not necessarily be the main beneficiaries, with private hospitals appearing to gain from the pricing structure.

Justice Mehta cited another example, saying a plain statin costs about Rs 40 while a version combined with aspirin costs around Rs 70. He questioned the impact of such pricing practices on ordinary patients, asking, "Why should the common man suffer all this?"

The petitions also raise concerns over the pricing of non-scheduled medicines. According to one plea, scheduled medicines are subject to ceiling prices, while non-scheduled formulations, which account for around 80 per cent or more of medicines by number and value, have greater freedom in fixing MRPs, subject to annual price increases of up to 10 per cent.

The court will hear the matter next on October 12 after considering the Centre's response.

CISF withdraws

The security cover was provided following a violent clash at the food park in 2015 between company security personnel and supporters of a local truck union.

The clash, which erupted after the company allegedly stopped hiring trucks from the local union, left more than a dozen people injured and one person dead in firing.

Villagers were accused of attacking the food park and setting fire to several trucks. Police subsequently arrested Ramdev's younger brother, Ram Bharat, in connection with the violence.

The CISF withdrawal comes amid a series of remarks by Ramdev in recent months targeting the government and its functionaries. In August, he alleged corruption and malpractices in government job interviews and said another agitation would follow if the government failed to act.

On September 23, while addressing a press conference, Ramdev defended Patanjali products against allegations of adulteration involving ghee and medicines, calling the claims baseless.

No official reason has been given for the MHA's decision to withdraw the CISF from the food park. According to police, security arrangements at the Patanjali facility will now have to be made through other means.

US exempts

The US Commerce Department has listed the eligible countries in the Federal Register. The duty-free categories include medicines for rare diseases, fertility treatments, cell and gene therapies, antibody-drug conjugates and veterinary drugs, along with their key manufacturing components.

The other beneficiaries are Argentina, Bangladesh, Cambodia, Ecuador, El Salvador, the European Union, Guatemala, Indonesia, Japan, Jordan, Malaysia, North Macedonia, South Korea, Switzerland, Liechtenstein, Taiwan, Thailand, Britain and Vietnam.

The exemption follows President Donald Trump's April directive under Section 232 of the Trade Expansion Act.

The 100 per cent duty on specified patented drugs and related ingredients took effect on July 31 for companies listed initially and expands to additional firms from September 29.

Generic medicines and their ingredients remain exempt from the tariffs.

MHA officials

Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA).

According to the MHA, the officials, a senior accountant and an accountant, had allegedly approached an association and demanded payment to facilitate its FCRA registration. One is currently posted in the MHA's Foreigners Division, while the other works at a Pay & Accounts Office and had earlier served in the Foreigners Division.

Preliminary questioning revealed that the officials were allegedly in touch with associations and offering to facilitate FCRA registration and renewal in exchange for illegal gratification, the ministry said.

Further investigation is underway to determine the extent of the alleged activities and identify others involved.

The MHA said it follows a zero-tolerance policy towards corruption and that legal and departmental action is being initiated against the officials.

It also warned FCRA applicants that registration and renewal services are available online through the FCRA portal and that no intermediary, agent or individual is authorised to facilitate them.

Assam Rifles

Havildar Jangkhokai Kuki, 42, was killed, while four personnel were injured and were being evacuated for medical treatment. Their condition was not immediately known.

Security forces launched intensified operations in the area following the incident. Changlang SP Kirli Padu said police had received information about the attack and directed the officer-in-charge of Changlang police station to collect details.

No insurgent group has claimed responsibility. A police officer said NSCN (K-YA) and ULFA are active in the region.

Assam Rifles paid tribute to Kuki and expressed condolences to his family.

'EXPOSE RSS' 'DIVISIVE, POISONOUS' AGENDA'

Congress asks its CMs to come up with education reforms

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

The Congress on Tuesday asked its chief ministers to come up with reforms in the education sector and expose the RSS on how its "poisonous" agenda is polluting the young minds.

Top Congress leadership, including party chief Mallikarjun Kharge and Rahul Gandhi, convened a meeting of the chief ministers of Karnataka, Kerala, Telangana and Himachal Pradesh and asked them to come up with an action plan that can showcase them as model states in the field of education.

Congress general secretary, organisation, K C Venugopal said party chief Mallikarjun Kharge and Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi convened the meeting with chief ministers and education ministers of Congress-ruled states. Priyanka Gandhi Vadra was also present in the meeting, along with general secretaries/in-charges of the respective states.

"Our discussions were on how to push back against the RSS' efforts to drive their divisive agenda through the education sector, and on how INC-ruled states can emerge as model states in the field of education.

"Specifically, we decided that: State-level education seminars will be held with guidance from reputed education experts and stakeholders. Within a month, CMs will prepare a thorough action-plan based on inputs from these seminars, to ensure reforms in education sectors and to become model states for education," he said in a post on X after the meeting.

Venugopal said a national-level seminar with experts will be held to chalk out the mechanism to roll out these plans.

"CMs will hold presentations on how RSS' poisonous agenda is polluting our young minds through the education system, and how RSS-backed Vice Chancellors are being appointed to further this dangerous agenda," the Congress leader, who was part of the deliberations, said.

Chief Minister of Karnataka D K Shivakumar, Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy, Kerala Chief Minister V D Satheesan and Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu were present at the meeting, along with senior leaders Randeep Surjewala, Deepa Dansmunshi, Rajani Patil, among others.



Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge interacts with LoP in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi during the CWC meeting, in New Delhi, Tuesday PTI

KEY POINTS

- Venugopal said a national-level seminar with experts will be held to chalk out the mechanism to roll out these plans
- CMs will hold presentations on how RSS' poisonous agenda is polluting our young minds through the education system, said Venugopal

Nitin Nabin chairs first meeting of newly appointed in-charges of BJP state units

According to sources, the meeting discussed organisational issues

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

BJP national president Nitin Nabin chaired the first meeting of the newly appointed party in-charges and co-in-charges of the states and Union Territories here on Tuesday.

After the meeting, Nabin said in a post on X, "At the BJP headquarters today, I held a meeting with the state in-charges and co-in-charges, and had a detailed discussion regarding organisational matters and upcoming programmes."

The BJP chief also posted on X a few pictures from the meeting.

According to sources, the meeting at the BJP headquarters discussed organisational issues and deliberated on the ways to address them to further strengthen the party's toehold across all states and UTs.

The newly appointed in-charges and co-in-charges of the party's units in the states were advised to spend adequate time in the states assigned to them and hold regular meetings with the party leaders and workers to address the issues and strengthen the party from the grassroots level, the sources added.

"All of them were asked to work in their respective states in an organised manner, meet the party workers and leaders, listen to them, guide them and waste no time in addressing issues and concerns, if any arise," a source in the party told news agency.

"They were also advised to meet and engage with all sections of society, including youth, in their respective states and strengthen the party's toehold from the grassroots level," the source added.

Sources said the party leadership at the meeting also asked the state in-charges to hold a meeting with their co-in-charges and chart a roadmap of their work plan with distribution of responsibilities among them so that work is done in an orderly manner.

"All of them were asked to work while keeping in mind that the party is above individual," another source told news agency.



BJP president Nitin Nabin with party MP Tarun Chugh during a meeting with state in-charge PTI

FCRA BILL

Home, Law ministries brief JPC

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

The ministries of Home Affairs and Law and Justice on Tuesday gave a clause-by-clause briefing to a Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC) examining the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, which has invited criticism from Opposition parties and Christian groups over its contentious provisions.

A 31-member committee, headed by BJP MP Sanjay Jaiswal, was constituted to examine the provisions of the legislation in details before coming out with a report.

Sources said the officials of the two ministries gave detailed presentations, explaining the reasons behind bringing the amendments to the 2010 law and its future actions.

All organisations and NGOs receiving foreign funding have to mandatorily register under the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA) and their activities are closely monitored by the Ministry of Home Affairs acting as nodal authority.

During the day, domain experts like Chairman of the State Bank of India Challa Sreenivasulu Setty, top law officers of the government and senior lawyers are expected convey their views to the JPC, the sources said.

The Bill was introduced in the Lok Sabha on March 25 this year and referred to the JPC on August 12 following consistent demand of the Opposition parties.

UP: BJP names candidates for all 11 MLC seats

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, September 29

The BJP on Tuesday announced six more candidates for the upcoming Uttar Pradesh Legislative Council elections, completing its list for all 11 graduate and teacher constituency seats.

The party has fielded Kedar Nath Singh from the Varanasi Graduate constituency, Dinesh Goyal from the Meerut Graduate constituency, Ashok Kumar Rathore from the Allahabad-Jhansi Graduate constituency, Pramod Mishra from the Varanasi Teacher constituency, engineer Hari Kishore Tiwari from the Agra Teacher constituency and Dhruv Tripathi from the Gorakhpur-Faizabad Teacher constituency.

The BJP had earlier announced five candidates for the elections.

With Tuesday's announcement, it has now named candidates for all 11 seats.

The elections to the 11 graduate and teacher constituency seats of the Legislative Council and 10 Rajya Sabha seats in Uttar Pradesh will be set in motion with the notification to be issued on Tuesday.

The nomination process for the Legislative Council elections will begin on Tuesday, with candidates allowed to file their nomination papers until October 6.

The nomination papers will be scrutinised on October 7, while candidates can withdraw their nominations until October 9.

Briefs

J&K: 2 Bills withdrawn

SRINAGAR: Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Tuesday said he was "not in favour of increasing salaries" as the Legislative Assembly withdrew two bills to amend salaries of ministers and legislators.

Odisha bandh on Oct 8: Oppn

BHUBANESWAR: INDIA Bloc on Tuesday announced an Odisha bandh on October 8 to demand the repeal of the new mining law and two other issues, as members of the alliance staged a demonstration near CM Majhi's residence here.

Hundreds of workers and leaders of Bloc partners such as the Congress, CPI(M), NCP, Samajwadi Party took part in the rally.

HC rejects Kejriwal's appeal

AHMEDABAD: The Gujarat High Court on Tuesday rejected Aam Aadmi Party convenor Arvind Kejriwal's appeal against an order that set aside a directive asking Gujarat University to disclose PM Modi's academic degree.

While quashing the CIC order, the single-judge bench of the high court had on March 31, 2023 also imposed a fine of Rs 25,000 on Kejriwal.

Left leaders detained outside ECI office

Protest seeking CEC's resignation

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

A protest by Left parties outside the Election Commission of India (ECI) office in New Delhi on Tuesday ended with several leaders and activists being detained by the Delhi Police as they demanded the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar amid the ongoing row over the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Among those detained were CPI(M) general secretary M A Baby and CPI(ML) Liberation leaders Sucheta De and Shweta Raj, besides activists associated with various Left organisations, including the All India Central Council of Trade Unions and the All India Lawyers' Association for Justice.

The protesters had gathered outside the poll panel's headquarters, raising concerns over the conduct of the SIR exercise and seeking Kumar's removal. Police detained the demonstrators and shifted them in vehicles, with reports at the time saying their destinations were not immediately disclosed.

The protest comes against the backdrop of reports about disagreements within the three-member poll panel over aspects of the electoral-roll revision process.

The Election Commission's official directory lists Kumar as CEC, with Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi serving as Election Commissioners.

A recent report cited by protesters said Sandhu and Joshi had raised objections on multiple occasions regarding issues linked to voter registration, deletion and restoration of names and aspects of the poll panel's functioning.

Shah to chair meeting with Odisha, Chh'garh CMs on Oct 1

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Bhubaneswar, September 29

Union Home and Cooperation minister Amit Shah has convened a meeting of the chief ministers of Odisha and Chhattisgarh on October 1 to resolve the vexed Mahanadi water dispute between the two states, the coastal state's Advocate General Pitambar Acharya said on Tuesday.

This came barely 10 days after Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai met his Odisha counterpart Mohan Charan Majhi during his two-day visit here and expressed confidence that the long-standing issue would be resolved soon.

On Tuesday, Acharya said, "Chief Ministers of both states along with their chief secretaries and technical committee members will join a meeting to be chaired by Union Home minister Amit Shah in New Delhi on October 1."

Rahul urges youth to protest

Says government only responds under pressure

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Tuesday called for an overhaul of a system that "blames the victim and shields the criminal", urging the youth to protest against women's harassment and rape as the government only responds under pressure.

"Stop punishing women for the crimes committed against them. Across our country, women are afraid to walk the streets, afraid of being harassed, afraid of being raped. And the government's answer: stay at home. This is patriarchy at work: a system that blames the victim and shields the criminal. It is time to smash it," he said in a post on X.

Noting that the solution is not to lock women inside, he said, "It is to make our streets safe, to confront the mindset of men who mistreat women, and to punish those who attack them, swiftly and without exception."

> **PEACEFUL PROTEST IS YOUR DEMOCRATIC RIGHT, AND I STAND WITH YOU WHOLEHEARTEDLY**

"Thousands of students and young people are on the streets demanding safety for women. I urge even more young women, especially Gen Z across India, to come out in stronger numbers. This government is deaf to your pain and will only listen when it's under pressure," the leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha said.

"Peaceful protest is your democratic right, and I stand with you wholeheartedly," he said.

Gandhi also posted a video along with his post that said, "Stop harassing women!"

In the video, he said a woman has nothing to do with an attack on her, and a woman has nothing to do with rape. The perpetrator is the criminal; please punish the criminal and leave women alone, he asserted.

Gandhi claimed that women are scared to walk the streets of our country. Citing the rape of a 16-year-old girl near a park in South Delhi, he said a woman goes for a walk in a park near LSR (Lady Shri Ram College), and she is raped.

"What is the reaction? The reaction is to stop women from going to parks at night. This is completely insane. Get this out of your mind that women are to be punished, penalised, because someone is attacking them and raping them," he said.

Every day, he said, one opens the newspapers and looks at social media to see that a girl has been raped in Bihar, another in UP, another in Punjab.

"What is the reaction? The reaction is punishment, hampering their lifestyle, completely the wrong reaction.

Tackling student suicides: Ceiling fans or not, counselling must

The survey findings are expected to be part of the final report of the National Task Force (NTF)

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

Back to back suicides in two elite engineering colleges led to grief, searching questions all around on student pressures - and the move by IIT Bombay and BIT Mesra to move towards removing ceiling fans in hostel rooms as a possible preventive.

This follows the Kota playbook of three years ago when 25 students preparing for competitive exams ended their lives, prompting administration in the coaching hub mandating hostels across the city to install "anti-suicide spring-loaded ceiling fans" and fit "anti-suicide net" in balconies and lobbies.

Then, as now, the concern was that managements and administrations could be missing the wood for the trees, going in for cosmetic measures rather than delving into root causes.

Removing ceiling fans could only do so much to prevent students from harming themselves, said experts, stressing on the need for sustained counselling and overhauling the competitive nature of the Indian education system.

A nationwide survey conducted by a Supreme Court-appointed panel underscores the magnitude of the problem. According to the findings, accessed by news agency, about 15 per cent students in higher education institutions have experienced a period in the previous six months when they felt overwhelmed or distressed, while nine per cent reported experiencing suicidal thoughts.

The survey findings are expected to be part of the final report of the National Task Force (NTF), which is expected to be submitted by October 31.

The environment of institutions such as the Indian Institutes of Technology does not allow for emotional expression, said clinical psychologist Shweta Sharma.

Some 60 to 70 per cent of her patients are those from the IITs and Indian Institutes of Management. They are very good with their high IQ and high performance but "they are also the ones struggling the most with relationship and social things".

"There is a special need to focus on mental wellness. Having this fan or that fan is not the issue, you are actually working on the physical aspect of the problem, mental health support is still missing in higher educational institutions," Sharma told news agency.

The students to counsellor ratio is never adequate, Sharma said.

Discussion on what leads a young man or woman -- caught in a competitive trap of first studying for years to enter an IIT and then struggling to cope once inside - took on added urgency after IIT Bombay student Sahil Wakode was found hanging from the ceiling fan in his room on September 18.

The process of replacing ceiling fans with wall-mounted ones had started in July after a student took the extreme step, sources said. According to official data, 45 student suicides have been reported across 23 IITs between 2020-21 and 2024-25, 28 of them involved students from SC, ST and OBC communities.

HIGHLIGHTS

- A nationwide survey conducted by a Supreme Court-appointed panel underscores the magnitude of the problem
- The survey findings are expected to be part of the final report of the National Task Force (NTF), which is expected to be submitted by October 31

LINKS INVASIONS TO TERRITORIAL, RELIGIOUS MOTIVES

New NCERT Class 9 book traces invasions, resistance & lesser-known women rulers

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 29

The new Class 9 Social Science textbook prepared by the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT) traces successive invasions of the Indian subcontinent, accounts of resistance by Indian rulers and communities, and the role of women leaders in confronting external forces.

Titled Understanding Society: India and Beyond-Part 2, the textbook was released on Tuesday, six months after the new academic session began. Its first part was released in June this year.

The chapter titled Resistance and Resilience says the Indian subcontinent witnessed successive invasions from the seventh century, driven by territorial expansion and religious motives. It also notes that the surplus agrarian produce of fertile plains fed by perennial river systems contributed to economic well-being and became a major reason for invasions.

The chapter documents resistance against Arab, Turkish, Mughal and European forces. It says Arab forces launched invasions by sea and land from the mid-seventh century but were confronted by Indian rulers in the Deccan, Malwa, Kashmir and Rajasthan.

It records that Mahmud, the Sultan of Ghazni, launched his first invasion in 1001 against Jayapala of the Hindu Shahi dynasty. During the 11th and 12th centuries, northern and western India faced Turkish invasions, while peninsular India remained outside Turkish control. The textbook also discusses resistance by the Hindu Shahis, Chandellas, Solankis and Chauhans.

Several women rulers are highlighted in the chapter. Queen Naiki Devi of the Chaulukya kingdom is credited with defeating Muhammad Ghori at Kasahrada near Mount Abu in 1178. Rani Abbakka Chowta, who ruled Ullal in present-day Karnataka from 1525 to 1570, is described as having successfully resisted Portuguese naval forces. Queen Rudrama Devi of the Kakatiya dynasty is also mentioned for her resistance to the Delhi Sultanate.

The textbook also records lesser-known resistance stories, including that of Muthu Virappa Nayak of Madurai, who is believed to have refused to bow to a ceremonial slipper sent by the Mughal court and instead placed his own foot inside it.

The chapter discusses the Jat resistance against the Mughal Empire, saying the community in the Ganga-Yamuna Doab faced heavy taxation and exploitation and rebelled under Gokul Jat in 1669. According to the textbook, economic hardships, along with Aurangzeb's religious policies, contributed to resentment among the Jats. It says Mughal forces struggled for months to suppress the uprising and the Jats continued their resistance.

A substantial section deals with Sikh history and the martyrdom of Guru Arjan Dev and Guru Tegh Bahadur. The textbook describes Mughal intervention in Sikh affairs from the early 17th century in the context of the community's growing socio-cultural influence. It characterises the treatment of Sikh Gurus, particularly Guru Arjan Dev, Guru Tegh Bahadur and Guru Gobind Singh, in strong terms and links their sacrifices to the evolution of Sikh resistance.

It states that Mughal emperor Jahangir ordered the execution of Guru Arjan Dev on the pretext of alleged support for his rebellious son Khusrau Mirza, calling the episode a significant turning point in Sikh history. It also records Guru Hargobind's detention at Gwalior Fort and the visits of Sikhs who gathered outside the fort to pay their respects. Regarding Guru Tegh Bahadur, the book says Aurangzeb ordered his execution in 1675 and describes his martyrdom as a turning point. It links the persecution and political pressure faced by the Sikh community with the emergence of organised resistance, collective mobilisation and, when required, armed resistance. Guru Hargobind's establishment of the Akal Takht and the concept of miri-piri, representing spiritual and worldly authority, are also discussed.

Other episodes covered include the Battle of Dewair near Udaipur in 1582 and Ahom resistance in Assam, including the Battle of Saraighat in 1671. The textbook also highlights Gingee (Senji) Fort in Tamil Nadu, which passed through the control of the Vijayanagara Nayakas, Bijapuri Sultans, Mughals, Marathas, French and English, and was declared a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2025.

Concluding the chapter, NCERT says resistance and resilience are closely linked, with resilience providing the ability to endure and sustain resistance. It adds that the period should not be viewed merely as a history of invasion and resistance, but as one marked by both conflict and cooperation.

NCERT has also expanded the presence of women leaders in its Social Science textbooks. Earlier this year, the Class 8 textbook Exploring Society: India and Beyond, Part 1 featured figures including Rani Durgavati, Tarabai and Ahilyabai Holkar in discussions on leadership, governance and resistance.



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

HIGHLIGHTS

- Titled Understanding Society: India and Beyond-Part 2, the textbook was released on Tuesday, six months after the new academic session began. Its first part was released in June
- The chapter titled "Resistance and Resilience" says the subcontinent witnessed successive phases of invasions driven by territorial expansion and religious motives
- The textbook describes resistance by several communities and rulers, including the Jats, Sikhs and Ahoms
- Describing the treatment of the Sikh Gurus, the textbook says the 'brutality of the Mughal state' had few comparisons in history

Foreign Secy conveyed concerns over 'SRIA' to US delegation: MEA

'Various issues of bilateral nature discussed at Sunday meeting'

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 29

Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri, during his meeting with a bipartisan US Congressional delegation, conveyed India's "concerns" over the implications of the recently enacted Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act (SRIA) on bilateral ties and the international energy market, the Ministry of External Affairs said on Tuesday.

The meeting took place in Delhi on Sunday, and the US delegation was led by Brian Mast, Chairman of the House Foreign Affairs Committee, MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said in response to a query at his bi-weekly media briefing.

"Various issues of bilateral nature were discussed at the meeting. Also, the foreign secretary conveyed our concerns about the SRIA legislation, as to the kind of implications it would have for bilateral relationships, as well as for the international energy market," Jaiswal said.

US President Donald Trump recently signed into law the 'Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026', which authorises him to impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries buying Russian oil and gas, including China and India.

In response to a query on the next India-Russia summit, and if there was any timeline for Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Russia to attend it, Jaiswal said, "The last annual summit with Russia was held in India, and we were delighted to host President (Vladimir) Putin. The next meeting will be held in Russia, and we are still some distance away from it. We'll keep you updated with the details in that regard."

INSIGHT

- US President Donald Trump recently signed into law the 'Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026'
- The legislation authorises him to impose tariffs of up to 100% on countries buying Russian oil and gas, including China and India



UP to e-challan helmetless pillion riders

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, September 29

Pillion riders on motorcycles will also face e-challans for not wearing helmets once the upgraded traffic challan system becomes operational in Uttar Pradesh, officials said.

Although helmets are mandatory for both motorcycle riders and pillion passengers, enforcement has largely focused on the rider. The upgraded system will now include a provision to record helmet violations by pillion riders as well.

The traffic department is updating its challan system to incorporate the provision. Officials said a prescribed fine would be imposed for the violation, with the vehicle owner responsible for its payment.

The violation can be detected through the traffic department's app and cameras installed under the Integrated Traffic Management System (ITMS). Traffic personnel can also issue challans after photographing the violation. The move is aimed at strengthening enforcement of helmet rules for pillion riders and improving road safety for two-wheeler passengers.

Meanwhile, the e-challan system has remained suspended since the night of September 21 as the traffic department transfers data to a new server and upgrades the system. Officials said the data transfer is still underway and e-challans would resume after the process is completed.

Briefs

HP: Ex-Min Mankotia dies at 88

SHIMLA: Five-time Himachal Pradesh MLA and former minister Major (retd) Vijai Singh Mankotia died on Tuesday at his native Tiara village in Kangra district following a brief illness. He was 88. A decorated Army officer, Mankotia served in politics for over four decades.

WorldSkills: NIFT bags 3 medals

NEW DELHI: NIFT students won two Silver Medals and a Medal for Excellence at the WorldSkills Competition in Shanghai, held from September 23-26, the Textiles Ministry said. Kovid Ajay Gangrade and Saniya Joshi won Silver in Digital Interactive Media Design and Retail Sales, while Vidhi Suthar received a Medal for Excellence in Fashion Technology.

Hooda accuses BJP of 'vote theft'

CHANDIGARH: Congress leader Bhupinder Singh Hooda on Tuesday alleged that the BJP formed the government in Haryana through "vote theft". Addressing a workers' conference in Satnali, he alleged collusion between the Election Commission and BJP during the last Assembly polls.

Ladakh-grown Liliums take flight to national markets


L-G VK Saxena flags off a consignment of 'A-grade' Lilium stems at Leh Airport

MPOST BUREAU
Leh, September 29

The first air consignment of 15,000 'A-grade' Liliums grown in Ladakh was flown from Leh to national markets on Tuesday, marking a push towards commercial floriculture and new livelihood opportunities in the Union Territory. Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena flagged off the consignment.

L-G Saxena said the initiative, completed in 60 days, was inspired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision of empowering farmers and youth through agricultural diversification.

He said commercial floriculture would promote rural entrepreneurship and provide local growers access to national flower markets.

The LG said flower cultivation could also add to Ladakh's tourism potential, with flower fields emerging as destinations for visitors and film shoots.

He described the initiative as an opportunity to combine profitable agriculture with sustainable tourism and create new economic avenues for local communities.

ED searches 14 premises in Rs 645-cr govt fund 'scam'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

The Enforcement Directorate on Tuesday searched 14 premises in Chandigarh, Mohali and Panchkula as part of its money laundering probe into the alleged Rs 645-crore public funds embezzlement case involving Haryana government and Chandigarh Municipal Corporation accounts.

The searches covered several jewellers, including Malik Jewellers, KLG Jewels, M.B. Gold Traders, Sham Jewellers and Sunder Jewellers, besides premises linked to Gourav Kansal, who allegedly facilitated routing of the proceeds of crime. The ED launched its probe after a Haryana Police FIR in February over discrepancies in accounts of the Haryana Development and Panchayat Department.

Saini approves 'Navachar' scheme to link academic ideas with governance

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 29

The Haryana government has formulated the 'Haryana Network for Academic Vision, Applied Creativity and Holistic Administrative Research (Navachar) Yojana' to connect academic research and innovation with administrative requirements and real-world challenges.

The scheme received in-principle approval at the first General Body meeting of the Haryana State Innovation Society, chaired by Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Tuesday.

Under the initiative, universities and higher educational institutions in Haryana will be encouraged to undertake research in priority areas including Viksit Haryana@2047, sustainable development, digital governance, high-tech manufacturing, sustainable agriculture, urban management and socio-economic inclusion.

Selected proposals may receive seed funding of up to Rs 1 lakh for preparing a Detailed Project Report. The DPR, prepared in coordination with the concerned department, will subsequently be submitted for final financial approval.

Saini said research should follow the principle of "Lab to Field and Field to Policy" and should lead to practical solutions for ground-level problems rather than remain confined to academic activities.

He directed officials to explore a pilot project in one district focusing on groundwater quality and technologies to make unusable or non-potable water suitable for use or drinking.

Hry govt hospitals to get incentives for higher footfall

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 29

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Tuesday announced special incentives for doctors, support staff and Ayushman Mitras at government hospitals witnessing higher patient footfall under the Ayushman Bharat and Chirayu schemes.

Chairing a review meeting with Health Department officials, Saini said funds received by government hospitals for treating beneficiaries would also be used for hospital upgrades and sanitation.

He directed officials to increase Ayushman packages in government hospitals and include free treatment for diabetic retinopathy. He also ordered immediate filling of vacant posts of doctors, radiologists and cardiologists.

CBI brings back fugitive in Nirav Modi PNB fraud case from UAE

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, September 29

Fugitive Sandeep Mistry, wanted in the Nirav Modi Punjab National Bank (PNB) fraud case, has been brought back to India from the United Arab Emirates, nearly two months after an INTERPOL Red Notice was issued against him, the CBI said.

Mistry was wanted in a case registered by the CBI's Bank Securities and Fraud Branch in Mumbai for allegedly facilitating fictitious international trade transactions and siphoning off funds through dummy companies.

According to the agency, Mistry was among the main conspirators and allegedly directed entities involved in the fraud through self-deleting platforms to conceal evidence. He also allegedly provided forged documents of import-export firms to project fictitious trade in diamonds, gold and pearl jewellery.

The CBI alleged that Mistry and others coerced dummy directors of foreign companies by threatening them with arrest, taking away their phones and forcing them to sign documents to establish false ownership.

He also allegedly helped siphon funds from UAE bank accounts of the dummy companies. The CBI has filed a charge sheet.

An INTERPOL Red Notice was issued against Mistry at the agency's request in July 2026. UAE authorities located and arrested him before initiating deportation proceedings.

Mistry arrived in Mumbai at 11.55 pm on Monday and was arrested by CBI officials. He will be produced before a court and sent to judicial custody.

Centre picks 50 cities to set new cleanliness standards

Centre's PRAGATI-50 initiative will operate under Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban 2.0 framework

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

Fifty cities across 24 states have been selected under the government's PRAGATI-50 initiative to achieve higher cleanliness standards through targeted interventions, technology-based monitoring and regular outcome assessments, the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) said on Tuesday.

The initiative, launched in pursuance of directions given by Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the 51st PRAGATI meeting, will operate under the Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban 2.0 framework.



Union Housing and Urban Affairs minister Manohar Lal chairs a meeting

Union minister Manohar Lal said the selected cities include major urban centres, cultural and tourism destinations and economic hubs. The initiative will focus on visible cleanliness, solid and used-water management, sanitation and increased citizen participation.

The minister said the progress of the cities would be monitored continuously through technology-enabled systems and outcome-based assessments. He will chair review meetings every two months to assess implementation.

A PRAGATI-like digital review mechanism has been established on the Swachhatam Portal, with ministry officers assigned to the selected cities for regular supervision and handholding. States and urban local bodies have been asked to prepare micro-level action plans.

Minister of State Tokhan Sahu said the initiative would help cities move towards the Garbage Free Cities goal and serve as models for other urban centres.

During the programme, guidelines for source segregation of municipal solid waste and a standard operating procedure for secondary collection centres for construction and demolition waste were released.

The ministry also launched the Swachh Bharat Test Bed and Innovation Centre at Durgapur in collaboration with CSIR-CMERI and the third cohort of 13 startups with IIT Kanpur.

KEY POINTS

- The initiative, launched in pursuance of directions given by Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the 51st PRAGATI meeting
- Union minister Manohar Lal said the selected cities include major urban centres, cultural and tourism destinations and economic hubs
- The initiative will focus on visible cleanliness, solid and used-water management, sanitation and increased citizen participation

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Vikram Pratap Singh S/o Hari Har Singh R/o H. No. D-74, Kaptan Chowk, Siraspur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 134/2025 U/S 137(2)/64(1) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita & 06 POCSO Act, PS Samaipur Badli, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Vikram Pratap Singh** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Vikram Pratap Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Vikram Pratap Singh** of **FIR No. 134/2025 U/S 137(2)/64(1) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita & 06 POCSO Act, PS Samaipur Badli, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the complaint on or before the day of **31.10.2026 at 10:00 am.**

By Order,
Sh. Manu Goel Kharb
Additional Sessions Judge (North)
FTSC POCSO (North), Room No. 308, 3rd Floor
DP/13856/ON/2026(Court Matter) **District Courts, Rohini, Delhi**

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर।
लापताः आवश्यक सूचना



अपहृता लड़की अंजली लोहार, उम्र–21 वर्ष।

सर्व साधारण को सूचित करना है कि अपहृता अंजली लोहार, उम्र–21 वर्ष, पिता–सुभाष लोहार, पता–बिरसानगर जोन नं0–07, थाना–गोलमुरी, जिला–पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर जो दिनांक–23.09.2026 को सुबह समय करीब 05:30 बजे घर से बिना बताये निकली है अभीतक वापस नहीं लौटी है। आवेदक एवं इनके परिवार वालों ने अपने स्तर से काफी खोजबीन किया परन्तु अपहृता का पता नहीं चल सका है। अपहृता लडकी का हुलिया निम्न प्रकार है :–कद–05 फीट 02 इंच, रंग–गोरी, बाल–सामान्य, पहनावा–गुलाबी सुट, भाषा–हिन्दी, अंग्रेजी एवं बंगाली।

अतः आप सभी जन साधारण से अनुरोध है कि उपरोक्त अपहृता के संबंध में किसी प्रकार की जानकारी प्राप्त होती है तो इसकी सूचना वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर के कार्यालय में निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर सूचित करें।

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर	: 0657–2431006
पुलिस अधीक्षक (नगर), पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर	: 9471190203
पुलिस उपाधीक्षक, (नगर)	: 9431706483
थाना प्रभारी, गोलमुरी	: 9431706494

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर।

PR 390750 Police(26-27)D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Furkan S/o** Sattar **R/o** H. No E-1781, Jahangirpuri, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 157/2020 U/s 356/379/511/174A/34 IPC**., has been registered at **PS: Timarpur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Furkan** namely cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Furkan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Furkan** of under **FIR No. 157/2020 U/s 356/379/511/174A/34 IPC**., Registered at **PS: Timarpur, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Karanbir Singh
DP/13462/N/2026 **JMFC-02 (Central), Room No. 26**
(Court Notice) **Tis Hazari Court, Delhi**

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to **India SME Asset Reconstruction Company Limited [CIN:U67190MH2008PLC181062] ("Secured Creditor")**, the **physical possession** of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on **"as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is"** basis on **16.10.2026** from **05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M.**, for recovery of **Rs. 28,60,057/- (Rupees Twenty Eight Lakh Sixty Thousand Fifty Seven only)** pending towards **Loan Account No. HHLVAS00387234**, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till **08.09.2026** with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. **09.09.2026** along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from **VINOD TIWARI and RICHA TIWARI.**

The Loan Account bearing No. **HHLVAS00387234**, along with all right(s), title(s), interest(s), underlying security(ies), pledge(s) and / or guarantee(s), including the Immovable Property, has been assigned by Sammaan Capital Limited **("SCL")** (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) to and in favour of the Secured Creditor acting as a **Trustee of ISARC - 2025-2026-5 Trust** vide Assignment Agreement dated **26.12.2025.** The Secured Creditor has duly taken over the financial facility from SCL and is thus, vested with all powers and entitled to recover its outstanding dues in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) and / or enforcement of security interest in relation to the Immovable Property.

The Reserve Price for the Immovable Property will be **Rs. 16,20,000/- (Rupees Sixteen Lakh Twenty Thousand only)** and the Earnest Money Deposit **("EMD")** will be **Rs. 1,62,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Sixty Two Thousand only)** i. e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

FLAT NO. UG - 3, UPPER GROUND FLOOR, M. I. G., REAR LEFT HAND SIDE (WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS), AREA ADMEASURING 55.74 SQ. MTR. I. E. 600 SQ. FT. COVERED AREA, CONSTRUCTED ON PLOT NO. B - 1/153, IN THE COLONY KNOWN AS "DLF DISHAAD EXT. - 2", SITUATED AT VILLAGE BHOPURA, TEH. & DIST. GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH. BOUNDED AS :-

EAST : PLOT NO. B - 1/152
WEST : FLAT NO. UG - 4
NORTH : COMMON PASSAGE & FLAT NO. UG - 2
SOUTH : OTHER PLOT

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i. e. www.isarc.in; Helpline No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E - mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

sd/-
AUTHORISED OFFICER
Date : 29.09.2026 **INDIA SME ASSET RECONSTRUCTION COMPANY LIMITED**
Place : GHAZIABAD **Trustee of ISARC - 2025-2026-5 Trust**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mahesh, S/o:** Padam Singh, **R/o:** F-741 F Block Mangol Puri Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 84/2011 U/s 174 A IPC P.S.: Paschim Vihar East, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mahesh,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mahesh,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mahesh,** accused of **FIR No.: 84/2011 U/s 174 A IPC P.S.: Paschim Vihar East, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.11.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Moksha Bains
DP/13786/OD/2026 **Ld. Judicial Magistrate First Class-11,**
(Court Matter) **Room No. 206 Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Neeraj S/o Sunil R/o Gali No. 11, Multani Dhanda, Paharganj, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case FIR No. 640/2021 U/S 356/379/411 IPC PS: Sadar Bazar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Neeraj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Neeraj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Neeraj** accused of **FIR No. 640/2021 U/S 356/379/411 IPC PS: Sadar Bazar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.12.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Kartik Taparia
DP/ 13758/N/2026 **JMFC-06, Room No. 247**
(Court Matter) **Tis Hazari Court, Delhi**

Office of The Executive Engineer P.W.D DIVISION RAISEN (M.P.)
Tender Notice

NIT No. 09/SAC/2026-27 /Raison **Raisen, Date-18.09.2026**

Online Tender for mentioned below are being invited. The Tender have been uploaded on the e-Procurement system of Public Works Department on the Portal www.mptenders.gov.in Tender details are as below:-

S. No.	Tender ID	District	Nature of work	BARRICADING WORK FOR VIP PROGRAMME UNDER PWD SUB DIVISION BARELI.	Call No.	Cost of Project (PAC) (Rs. In lack)	Remark
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	2026_PWDRB 537428_1	Raisen	Patch repair	PATCH REPAIR WORK OF AR ROADS UNDER RAISEN PWD DIVISION RAISEN.	IInd	202.86	
2	2026_PWDRB 537433_1	Raisen	BT Renewal work	BT RENEWAL WORK OF PMGSY AT PANJRA KASHIRAM TO KHERI PRATAPGARH SEMRI KHUBCHAND ROAD	IInd	52.02	
3	2026_PWDRB 537434_1	Raisen	Patch repair	B.T. PATCH REPAIR IN VARIOUS ROAD UNDER PWD SUB DIVISION BARELI.	Ist	40.00	
4	2026_PWDRB_5 37442_1	Raisen	Patch repair	B.T. PATCH REPAIR IN VARIOUS ROAD UNDER PWD SUB DIVISION OBEDULLAGANJ	Ist	40.00	
5	2026_PWDRB 537449_1	Raisen	Barricading work	BARRICADING WORK FOR VIP PROGRAMME UNDER PWD SUB DIVISION BARELI.	Ist	25.00	
6	2026_PWDRB 537457_1	Raisen	Barricading work	BARRICADING WORK FOR VIP PROGRAMME UNDER PWD SUB DIVISION OBEDULLAGANJ.	Ist	25.00	
				Total		384.88	

The document can only be purchased online from the above website after making online payment. The last date & time for purchase of Document on line is Dated 09-10-2026 up to (17:30.) Detailed NIT and other details can be viewed on the above mentioned portal. Amendments to NIT, if any, would be published on website only, and not in newspaper.

G19198/26 "स्वभाव स्वच्छता, संस्कार स्वच्छता" Executive Engineer PWD Division Raisen

UJVN Limited

UJVNL
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone : 0135-2763508, Fax No : 0135-2763507
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 891 **Tender Notice** **Dated : 29/09/2026**

Office of the Executive Engineer (E&M), Vyasi Dam, Juddo, Dakpathar UJVN Ltd , invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Summary of tenders is given below:

Tender No -12/EE(E&M)/Vyasi Dam/2026-27 & 13/EE(E&M)/ Vyasi Dam/2026-27

Name of work- 1-Services for Underwater diving work at Vyasi Dam, Juddo

2-Operation & Maintenance work of 05 KLD Sewage Treatment Plant (STP), MBBR Based Technology at Vyasi Dam, Juddo Dist- Dehradun

Estimated cost- Rs. 7,80,000.00 only + GST Extra & Rs. 6,86,217.00 only + GST Extra

Date of availability of bid document on website- 03.10.2026 at 16:00 Hrs

Last date for submission of tender- 24.10.2026 up to 16.00 Hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit www.ujvnl.com

Executive Engineer(E&M)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Sh. Virender Kumar S/o Sh. Om Parkash R/o Flat No. 120 Pocket B-5 Sector-3 Rohini Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 10679/18 U/S 138 NI Act PS: North Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sh. Virender Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sh. Virender Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sh. Virender Kumar** accused of **CC No. 10679/18 U/S 138 NI Act PS: North Rohini, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.11.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Aakanksha
DP/13647/RD/2026 **JMFC-03, Room No. 107**
(Court Matter) **Rohini Court, Delhi**

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

Name of Work	Scheduled Maintenance and repair Contract of RMPUs of EOG LHB RMPU AC coaches including their sick line attention for heavy repairs work & On-board electrical escorting duties on AC coaches in Primary based Trains of electrical coaching ACC/DLI & Elect/Chg./DEE depot over Delhi division for three years.	
Tender No.	30-Elect-7TR1-Chg-2025-26	
Approx cost of the work in (Rs.)	Rs.10,76,27,333.40/-	
Cost of tender form	Rs. 0.00	
Address of the Office	Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/Chg/Northern Railway, New Delhi	
Earnest Money		Rs. 21,52,600.00/-
Period of completion of work		36 Months
Last date & time of submission of tender		21.10.2026 up to 15.00 hrs.
And opening of tender		21.10.2026 at 15.01 hrs.
Website & notice board	www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. DEE/Chg/DLI	

3377/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sweta @ Priti W/o** Tarun Kumar **R/o** E-1880, Jahangirpuri, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 108/17, U/S 324/341/ 506/34 IPC, PS Jahangirpuri, North-West Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sweta @ Priti** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sweta @ Priti** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Sweta @ Priti** the said accused of **FIR No. 108/17, U/S 324/341/506/34 IPC, PS Jahangirpuri, North-West Distt., Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.11.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07,
DP/13820/NW/2026 **North, Court No.-6, Ground Floor,**
(Court Matter) **Rohini Courts, Delhi**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Ashok S/o** Kishori Mehto **R/o** H.No.-94, 1st Floor, Rajendra Market, Tis Hazari, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 42/2020, U/S 12/9/55 Gambling Act, PS Subzi Mandi, North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ashok** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ashok** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Ashok** the said accused of **CC No. 42/2020, U/S 12/9/55 Gambling Act, PS Subzi Mandi, North Distt., Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.11.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Preeti Rajoria
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07,
DP/13637/N/2026 **(Central), Court No.-32,**
(Court Matter) **Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi**

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to **Sammaan Capital Limited (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor")**, the **constructive possession** of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on **"as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is"** basis on **31.10.2026** from **05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M.**, for recovery of **Rs. 33,73,399/- (Rupees Thirty Three Lakh Seventy Three Thousand Three Hundred Ninety Nine only)** pending towards **Loan Account No. HHLDMT00452892**, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till **23.09.2026** with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. **24.09.2026** along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from **DUSHYANT KUMAR and POONAM DEVI.**

The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be **Rs. 55,00,000/- (Rupees Fifty Five Lakh only)** and the Earnest Money Deposit **("EMD")** will be **Rs. 5,50,000/- (Rupees Five Lakh Fifty Thousand only)** i. e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

ENTIRE (UGF) UPPER GROUND FLOOR, HAVING AREA 32 + 32 SQ. MTRS., TOTAL AREA 64 SQ. MTRS., (WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS), CONSTRUCTED ON THE PLOT NO. 204-205, PKT A - 3, SECTOR 28, SITUATED IN THE LAYOUT PLAN OF ROHINI RESIDENTIAL SCHEME, ROHINI, NEW DELHI - 110085, ALONGWITH 25% UNDIVIDED SHARE IN STILT PARKING ON GROUND FLOOR OF THE AFORESAID PROPERTY.

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No: 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id: auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

Sd/-
Authorized officer
Date : 24.09.2026 **SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (Formerly known as**
Place : NEW DELHI **INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)**

UJVN LIMITED

UJVNL
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 888 **TENDER NOTICE** Date: 29/09/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Generation), Khodri Power Station, Dakpathar (Dehradun), invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No: 14/EE(Gen)/Khodri/2026-27: Replacement of 03 No's new HT bushings along with CT turret & Overhauling of 34 MVA Generator transformer of Unit No 4 at Khodri Power Station

Tender No: 15/EE(Gen)/Khodri/2026-27: Cleaning & painting of Old chequered plates and on structure at floor level -1 and -2 of Generators and Fabrication & fixing of new chequered cover plates, corners of cable trench and of Khodri Power Station, Khodri.

Tender No: 16/EE(Gen)/Khodri/2026-27: Work of Printing of various Logbooks & procurement of stationary items for Generation Section at Khodri Power Station.

Estimated cost: Rs. 24,82,000/-GST extra,Rs. 5,19,000/-GST extra & Rs. 3,03,449/- GST extra

Date of availability of bid document on website:30.09.2026, 10:00 hrs

Last date for submission of tender: 21.10.2026 up to 16:00 hrs..

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website **"www.ujvnl.com"**

Executive Engineer (Generation)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No.23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

PUBLIC NOTICE
Builder Cancellation

This is to bring to your notice that MOUSHUMI ROY / DHRUBAJYOTI ROY (borrower/s) has availed Home loan facility vide facility agreement number LBFDB00002869583 located at FLAT NO-B-608, 6TH FLOOR GROUP HOUSING SCHEME FLORIDAA TOWER B SEC 82 HARYANA FARIDABAD – 121001. The borrower/s has failed to pay the contractual amount to the builder as per the terms and conditions of the agreement. The Bank had informed the same to the borrower through letter dated Sep 24, 2026, informing that S3 BUILDWELL LLP. has cancelled the allotment of the above mentioned property. You are therefore requested to resolve this matter with the builder within 7 days from the date of this publication.

Please take further notice that post cancellation of the allotment of the said property ICICI Bank shall not be bound and/or responsible for any other allotment done by the builder.

Dated: September 30, 2026 For ICICI Bank Limited
Place : Delhi/ NCR Sd-

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No.23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

PUBLIC NOTICE
Builder Cancellation

This is to bring to your notice that BRIJESH MANI ALIAS MAN TRIPATHI / VAIDEHI TRIPATHI (borrower/s) has availed Home loan facility vide facility agreement number LBDEL00004640420 located at FLAT NO B-1406 14TH FLOOR, TOWER B FLORIDAA, SECTOR-82 FARIDABAD 121001. The borrower/s has failed to pay the contractual amount to the builder as per the terms and conditions of the agreement.

The Bank had informed the same to the borrower through letter dated Sep 24, 2026, informing that S3 BUILDWELL LLP. has cancelled the allotment of the above mentioned property. You are therefore requested to resolve this matter with the builder within 7 days from the date of this publication.

Please take further notice that post cancellation of the allotment of the said property ICICI Bank shall not be bound and/or responsible for any other allotment done by the builder.

Dated: September 30, 2026 For ICICI Bank Limited
Place : Delhi/ NCR Sd-

UJVN LIMITED

UJVNL
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 884 **e- TENDER NOTICE** Date: 28/09/2026

Office of Executive Engineer (Maint.), Khodri Power Station, Dakpathar (Dehradun), invites online tender for following work,

eTender No:16/EE(Maint.)/Khodri/2026-27.

Name of work: Wear and Abrasion coating on Spiral casing inner surface and stay rings of Unit No. 04 of Khodri Power Station.

Estimated cost: Rs. 74,65,515/- plus GST Extra.

Date of availability of tender on website: 30.09.2026 from 14:00 hrs.

Last date for submission of bid on website: 21.10.2026 up to 16.00 hrs.

For downloading tender documents and other details, please visit e- procurement portal **"https:/uktenders.gov.in"**

Executive Engineer (Maint), Khodri

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Letter No:- DRM/C/AGRA/NFR/E-AUCTION Dated : 28.09.2026

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway-Agra invites E-Auction as per category given as under:-

Category : Misc Static Services	**Catalogue No. : NFR-AGRA-26-13**
Asset Details : Contract for Operation & Maintenance of digital Locker at Platform area of Mathura Junction railway Station.	
E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date:- 07.10.2026 Time:- 11:00	
E-Auction End Date and Time : Date:- 07.10.2026 Time:- 11:30	
Asset Details : Contract for Operation & Maintenance of digital Locker at Platform area of Agra Cantt. railway Station.	
E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date:- 07.10.2026 Time:- 11:10	
E-Auction End Date and Time : Date:- 07.10.2026 Time:- 11:40	
Asset Details : Installation, Maintenance & Operation of Water Vending Machine (WVM) at FTS.	
E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date:- 07.10.2026 Time:- 11:20	
E-Auction End Date and Time : Date:- 07.10.2026 Time:- 11:50	
Asset Details : Installation, Maintenance & Operation of Water Vending Machine (WVM) at BTSR.	
E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date:- 07.10.2026 Time:- 11:30	
E-Auction End Date and Time : Date:- 07.10.2026 Time:- 12:00	
Asset Details : Installation, Maintenance & Operation of Water Vending Machine (WVM) at KLB.	
E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date:- 07.10.2026 Time:- 11:40	
E-Auction End Date and Time : Date:- 07.10.2026 Time:- 12:10	
Asset Details : Installation, Maintenance & Operation of Water Vending Machine (WVM) at RBS.	
E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date:- 07.10.2026 Time:- 11:50	
E-Auction End Date and Time : Date:- 07.10.2026 Time:- 12:20	

Note :- Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. **2208/26 (C)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONC

Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.

Muthoot Homefin
Corporate Office : Unit No. 19-NE, 19th Floor, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Near Ruparel College, Dadar (West), Mumbai, Maharashtra- 400 028

POSSESSION NOTICE (As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of **Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. (MHIL)** under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, Demand Notice(s) issued by the Authorised Officer of the company to the Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) mentioned herein below to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken Possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. for an amount as mentioned herein under with interest thereon.

The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Loan Account No./Branch	Brief details of secured assets	Date of Demand Notice & Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Possession Taken Date
1.	Dharmedra Singh/ Vitto/ MTH-HL-000011/ Mathura	All That Piece And Parcel of House No. 6 Area Measuring 80 Sq. Yards, Khasr No. 2158, Situated At Jaisbal Kuni Near Nagla Mohanlal, Mauza Naraich, Tehsi Etmadpur & District Agra. Bounded With East: 16 Feet Wide Road. West: Jyoti Kunj Colony. North: Part of House No. 6 of Neelam. South: House No. 7 of Radha Devi.	30-Jun-2026/ Rs. 26,63,787.26/- Rupees Twenty Six Lakh Sixty Three Thousand Seven Hundred Eighty Seven And Paise Twenty Six Only.	28-Sep-2026

Date: September 30, 2026
Place: Agra **Sd/- Authorized Officer, Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited**

PUBLIC NOTICE

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The following borrower(s) has/have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest towards the Loan facility(ies) availed from ICICI Bank. The Loan(s) has/have been classified as Non-Performing Asset(s) (NPA). A Notice was issued to them under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, at their last known addresses. However, it has not been served and are therefore being notified by way of this Public Notice.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ (Loan Account Number) & Address	Description of Secured Asset to be enforced	Date of Notice sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice	NPA Date
1.	Saiar Greens/ Ankit Shrivastava/ Sanjay Kumar Koul/ Vinay Raina/ Meenakshi Koul Acc No. 732405000507/ Plot No. 16 Gurgaon Sector 38 Haryana Gurgaon- 122018	House No. C-408, 2nd Floor Block-C, Sushant Lok-1 Gurgaon-121002 Haryana, Owned By Sanjay Kaumar Kaul, (Admeasuring An Area of 1480 Sq Feet North: Plot No. C-409 South: Plot No. C-407 East: Road West: Plot No. C-411-D	22-08-2026 Rs. 2,73,15,489.29/-	02-Jul-2026
2.	Prismiq Industries Private Limited/ Uday Choudhary/ Mukul Singh Kushwah/ Kunal Jain Acc No. 525351000006/ Represented By Director/s Kunal Jain & Uday Choudhary , Mukul Singh Kushwah G 30, Site B Upsida Industrial Area Suraj Pur Gautam Budha Nagar Uttar Pradesh- 201308	Property No. B-98/3, First Floor, Situated at Khasra No. 1090/596 Joshi Colony, Mandawali Ilaka Shahdra Fazalpur Delhi-110092, Owned by Kunal Jain,	22-08-2026 Rs. 2,32,27,389.59/-	19-Jul-2026

These steps are being taken for substituted service of Notice. The above borrower/s and/or guarantor/s (as applicable) is/are advised to make the outstanding payment within 60 days from the date of publishing this Notice. Else, further steps will be taken as per the provisions of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

Date: September 30, 2026
Place: Gurgaon & Delhi

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

HOLDS BILATERAL MEETINGS ON SIDELINES OF AIIB ANNUAL MEET

FM pushes investment, economic ties with Saudi, Switzerland, Jordan

Nirmala Sitharaman welcomed the successful conclusion of negotiations on India-Saudi Arabia Bilateral Investment Treaty

ANI NEWS
Doha, September 29

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman held a series of bilateral meetings on the sidelines of the AIIB (Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank) 2026 Annual Meeting in Doha, seeking to deepen India's investment and economic ties with Saudi Arabia, Switzerland and Jordan.

The finance minister also discussed post-flood reconstruction support and digital payments connectivity with Nepal, as per the Ministry of Finance.

The Ministry, in a series of announcements on its official X account, said that during her meeting with Saudi Arabia's Finance Minister Mohammed Al-Jadaan, Sitharaman welcomed the successful conclusion of negotiations on the India-Saudi Arabia Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT), which is expected to provide a stronger and more predictable framework for bilateral investments and bolster investor confidence.



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman

Also, "H.E. Mr. @MAAl-jadaan expressed keen interest in welcoming investments from India," the statement read.

In a separate meeting with Switzerland's AIIB Governor, Ambassador Pietro Lazzeri, Sitharaman highlighted the National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF) as a platform for foreign investors seeking exposure to India's infrastructure sector.

"Switzerland sees significant opportunities in India for portfolio diversification and investment," Lazzeri said adding "Swiss Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) growth in India is outpacing global FDI, and we sought support for finalisation of the Bilateral Investment Protection Agreement," as per the Ministry.

KEY POINTS

- In a meeting with Switzerland's AIIB Governor, Ambassador Pietro Lazzeri, she highlighted the NIIF as a platform for foreign investors seeking exposure to India's infra sector
- Lazzeri said 'Swiss FDI growth in India is outpacing global FDI, and we sought support for finalisation of the Bilateral Investment Protection Agreement,' as per the Ministry

FM Sitharaman also met Jordan's Minister of Planning and International Cooperation Zeina Zeid Toukan, with discussions focusing on food security, fertilisers, trade and investment. The Finance Minister noted that India is Jordan's fourth-largest trading partner and highlighted the target of increasing bilateral trade to $5 billion by 2030.

While, "H.E. Ms. Zeina Zeid Toukan said that India is a critical market for Jordan and that Jordan is keen to continue and strengthen cooperation in many sectors including fertilizers, energy, water and infrastructure projects, and looked forward to more investment opportunities in Jordan," the statement read.

Separately, Sitharaman held a pull-aside meeting with Nepal Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle, where discussions focused on Nepal's reconstruction and recovery priorities following the floods.

The two sides discussed continued engagement to work out the specifics of possible Indian support and reviewed progress on projects discussed during their earlier meeting in New Delhi.

"The early operationalisation and utilisation of the UPI-NPI linkage was also discussed as an initiative beneficial to both countries," the Ministry said.

Markets fall for 2nd day on elevated oil prices & foreign fund outflows

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, September 29

Equity benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended lower for the second day on Tuesday as elevated crude oil prices, uncertainty over the Iran war peace deal, higher US Treasury yields and foreign fund outflows weighed on investor sentiment.

The 30-share BSE Sensex dropped 242.65 points, or 0.33 per cent, to settle at 72,529.07.

The 50-share NSE Nifty declined 64.05 points, or 0.28 per cent, to end at 22,716.20. From the 30 Sensex firms, Titan, HCL Tech, Tata Consultancy Services, UltraTech Cement, Hindustan Unilever and Tech Mahindra were among the major laggards.

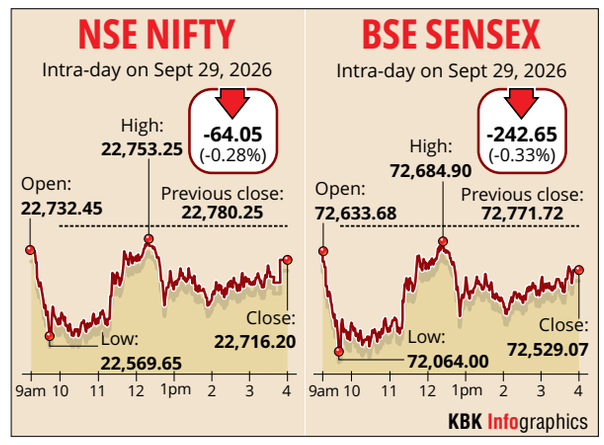
Adani Ports, Sun Pharma, Tata Steel and Kotak Mahindra Bank were among the winners.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, dipped 0.09 per cent to $105.1 per barrel. FIIs offloaded equities worth Rs 5,353.22 crore on Monday, according to exchange data.

The BSE MidCap Select index dropped 0.99 per cent, while the SmallCap Select index was up 0.25 per cent. Among the BSE sectoral indices, Consumer Durables tumbled 1.97 per cent, Focused IT dropped 1.77 per cent, Insurance 1.57 per cent, Realty 1.49 per cent, IT 1.28 per cent, Hospitals 1.24 per cent and Housing Finance 0.93 per cent. Healthcare, Industrials, Telecommunication, Metal and Services closed in the green.

In Asian markets, South Korea's Kospi, Japan's Nikkei 225 & Hong Kong's Hang Seng index ended lower, while Shanghai's SSE Composite index settled higher. Markets in Europe were trading in positive territory. US markets ended lower on Monday.

On Monday, the Sensex tanked 1,124.02 points, or 1.52 per cent, to settle at 72,771.72, the lowest closing level since March 30, 2026. The Nifty dropped 360.25 points, or 1.56 per cent, to end at 22,780.25.



CLOSER LOOK

- From the 30 Sensex firms, Titan, HCL Tech, Tata Consultancy Services, UltraTech Cement, Hindustan Unilever and Tech Mahindra were among the major laggards
- Among the BSE sectoral indices, Consumer Durables tumbled 1.97%, Focused IT dropped 1.77%, Insurance 1.57 %, Realty 1.49%, IT 1.28%, Hospitals 1.24% & Housing Finance 0.93%

Briefs

Rupee rises 3 paise to 95.94 against dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee appreciated by 3 paise to 95.94 per dollar level, driven by possible RBI intervention and a pull-back in oil prices following hopes of negotiations between the US and Iran.

At interbank forex market, the rupee traded in range of 96.03-96.15 against the dollar, before settling at 95.94, up 3 paise over its previous close.

Most Tata Group stocks ended lower

NEW DELHI: Tata stocks fell Tuesday after Tata Trusts proposed merging Tata Electronics Systems Solutions & Tata Consulting Engineers with Tata Sons, to avoid NBFC, core investment company status and listing.

Tata Chemicals fell 4.20 per cent, Tata Investment Corp 3.10 per cent, Titan 2.72 per cent, Tata Teleservices 2.63 per cent, TCS 1.72 per cent, Tata Elxsi 1.53 per cent, Tata Power 1.10 per cent & TMPV 0.72 per cent on BSE.

Sitharaman meets Qatar FM, discusses UPI expansion

Meeting her Qatari counterpart, Sitharaman also sought finalisation of Bilateral Investment Treaty

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Doha, September 29

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Tuesday met Qatar's Minister of Finance Ali bin Ahmed Al Kuwari and discussed expansion of Indian Unified Payments Interface (UPI) system in Qatar.

Meeting her Qatari counterpart on the sidelines of the AIIB annual meeting, Sitharaman also sought finalisation of the Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT).

"The leaders discussed expansion of Indian UPI payments across Qatar; implementation of $10 billion Qatari investment commitment in India; engagement with National Infrastructure and Investment Fund @NIIFIndia; and finalisation of the Bilateral Investment Treaty," the finance ministry said on X.

They also discussed the Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement as a strengthened framework for trade, investment and tax certainty, the ministry added.

Sitharaman also recalled India's recent engagements with Qatar's leadership which elevated India-Qatar bilateral relations to a "strategic partnership".

Qatar's Finance Minister thanked the Indian community for being part of the success story of Qatar.

He looked forward to bigger opportunities for strengthening trade, finance and investment relations between the two countries, the ministry added.

NCLAT issues notice to creditors on Subhash Chandra's Plea, sets next hearing for Oct 29–30

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 29

The National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) on Tuesday issued notices to creditors on a plea filed by Essel Group Chairman Subhash Chandra and scheduled the matter for hearing on October 29 and 30.

Chandra had challenged before the appellate tribunal an order passed on September 1 by a five-member larger bench of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT), which had stayed the order of a third tie-breaker judge in his personal insolvency matter and restrained him from alienating his assets.

NCLAT HAS DIRECTED CREDITORS, WHO OPPOSED THE MAINTAINABILITY OF CHANDRA'S PETITION, AMONG OTHERS, TO FILE THEIR REPLY WITHIN A WEEK

The NCLAT has directed the creditors, who opposed the maintainability of Chandra's petition, among others, to file their reply within a week.

A three-member bench of NCLAT also granted a week's time to Subhash Chandra to file a rejoinder to the creditors' reply.

"Let the notice be issued... will file the reply (over maintainability and stay) within a week," said the bench comprising Officiating Chairperson Justice (Retd.) Yogesh Khanna and Technical Members Barun Mitra and Ajai Das Mehrotra.

Meanwhile, at the request of Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for some creditors, the appellate tribunal clubbed a separate petition filed by creditors challenging the NCLT order that approved a settlement involving a payment of about Rs 6.5 crore against admitted claims of around Rs 22,006.57 crore with Chandra's appeal.

The NCLAT fixed October 29 and 30 for hearing Chandra's interim relief applications. The tribunal indicated that one day would be allotted for arguments on behalf of Chandra and the other for submissions from creditors.

During the proceedings, Solicitor General Mehta suggested waiting for the outcome of the next hearing of the five-member NCLT bench, scheduled on November 19.

However, this was opposed by advocate Dhruv Mehta, who was representing Subhash Chandra.

World is shifting from an anti-civilisational order towards a civilisational order, says Gurumurthy

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 29

Swaminathan Gurumurthy, Chairman, Vivekananda International Foundation (VIF), said India's civilisational wisdom could complement modern science, technology and institutions in its journey towards Viksit Bharat, at Mantranā, Bharat Ki Soch's flagship discussion series.



Delivering the keynote on "Ancient Indian Wisdom as a Guide for Viksit Bharat", Gurumurthy said, "Technology can develop a nation. Military can protect a nation. GDP can promote a nation. But all these added together do not constitute a nation." He added, "The world is shifting from an anti-civilisational world order towards a civilisational world order, and there is a rising civilisational awareness in India."

Anil Rajput, Chairman, Bharat Ki Soch, said India's progress by 2047 should encompass economic strength, education, healthcare, opportunities and sustainable development. "We must also ask what choices will take us there, and what kind of nation we will have built when we arrive," he said.

R K Pachnanda said the discussion reinforced ancient wisdom as a "living inheritance". "Let us carry forward the wisdom of our civilisation," he said.

Petronet LNG hosts Investors and Analysts Interactive Meet

MPOST BUREAU
Kochi, September 29



Petronet LNG Limited (PLL) hosted its Investors and Analysts Interactive Meet, "Samvaayah 2.0," in Kochi from September 23-25, 2026. Organised by UBS Securities India Pvt Ltd, the event discussed PLL's business, growth outlook and LNG sector developments.

Akshay Kumar Singh, Managing Director & CEO, PLL, said the platform strengthened transparency and stakeholder engagement. Saurav Mitra, Director (Finance) & CFO, PLL, said the interaction provided clarity on financial and business priorities.

PLL also conducted a tree plantation drive at its Kochi LNG Terminal to make the event carbon neutral. The company said no unpublished price-sensitive information was shared.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



A Rajbhasha Awards Distribution Ceremony was organised on September 28, 2026 at Rail Coach Factory, Kapurthala, to felicitate the winners of various Hindi competitions organised during Hindi Pakhwada. Ajay Nandan General Manager RCF, presented awards to the winning employees. Various senior and higher officers, Amit Saurashtri, Chief Rajbhasha Officer & Rajat, Rajbhasha Officer, were present at the event.

Trump announces Mesabi Metallics' $18 bn investment

The announcement was made in the presence of Ravi Ruia, Vice Chairman and Founder, Essar Group, and Rewant Ruia, Chairman, Mesabi Metallics

MPOST BUREAU
Washington DC, Sept 29

President Donald J Trump on Tuesday announced Essar-backed Mesabi Metallics' $18 billion investment to build a fully integrated American steel company, linking its Minnesota iron ore mine with a new steel complex in Iowa.

The investment includes a proposed $15 billion integrated steel complex in Iowa, in addition to the $3 billion already invested in the iron ore mine and pelletising facility in Minnesota.

The project is described as the largest single-location investment in an integrated steel complex in US history.

The announcement was made at the White House in the presence of Essar Group Vice Chairman and Founder Ravi Ruia and Mesabi Metallics Chairman Rewant Ruia.



United States Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick, Energy Secretary Chris Wright and US Export-Import Bank Chairman John Jovanovic also attended.

The Iowa project is expected to create more than 8,000 construction jobs and at least 1,750 full-time jobs once operational.

The company estimates its investment will generate $95 billion in economic output during construction and the first 10 years of operations.

Mesabi Metallics' mine at Nashwauk, Minnesota, is the first new US iron ore mine in 50 years.

Nearly $3 billion has been invested in the mine, which currently employs more than 200 people and has over 1,500 construction workers on site.

The Iowa complex will use direct-reduced iron and electric arc furnace technologies to produce steel from Minnesota-mined iron ore and scrap, reducing energy use and emissions.

News at a glance

CIL, HURL pact to explore syngas-based urea at Sindri

NEW DELHI: State-owned CIL on Tuesday said it has signed a pact with Hindustan Urvarak & Rasayan Ltd (HURL) to examine the feasibility of producing urea through coal gasification-based syngas at Sindri, Jharkhand.

The non-binding MoU was executed on 29.09.2026, CIL said in a BSE filing. The initial focus will be on examining technical, commercial and execution modalities and preparing a preliminary feasibility report. The move comes amid the Centre's push for coal gasification to reduce dependence on imported natural gas and feedstocks.

Aditya Birla Sun Life launches BSE Total Market fund & ETF

MUMBAI: Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC on Tuesday launched the Aditya Birla Sun Life BSE Total Market Index Fund and ETF. The new fund offering will open on September 30 and close on October 14, the asset management company said.

Both funds will track the BSE Total Market Index, offering exposure to approximately 93 per cent of India's total market capitalisation across large-, mid-, small- and micro-cap segments.

The index covers stocks representing 98 per cent of the BSE AllCap Index and has a minimum of 1,000 constituents.

IRB InvIT raises ₹2,351 crore via preferential allotment

NEW DELHI: IRB InvIT Fund has raised Rs 2,351 crore through institutional placement and preferential allotment of units, its sponsor IRB Infrastructure Developers Ltd said on Tuesday. This is the second fundraise by IRB InvIT since its launch and listing in 2017.

Last year, it raised Rs 4,253 crore to acquire three highway assets at an enterprise value of Rs 8,643 crore from IRB Infrastructure Trust. IRB Infrastructure Developers invested Rs 351 crore through preferential allotment to maintain its (approx.) 16 per cent stake.

Fitch revises OYO parent's outlook to '+ve' from 'stable'

NEW DELHI: Fitch Ratings revised the outlook on OYO parent PRISM's long-term foreign and local-currency issuer default ratings to 'positive' from 'stable', citing expected deleveraging driven by EBITDA growth.

PRISM, formerly Oravel Stays, reported a 49.7 per cent rise in consolidated revenue to Rs 9,358 crore and more than doubled EBITDA to Rs 2,594 crore in FY26.

Net profit rose over four-fold to Rs 994 crore, including a Rs 678 crore deferred-tax credit. Fitch affirmed the 'B' rating on its $830 million senior secured term loan.

Tata Sons IPO would change group's investment model, says Noel Tata

'Trusts' role as a philanthropic organisation is separate from its role as group's controlling shareholder, but both are connected via Tata Sons'

ANI NEWS
Mumbai, September 29

A public listing of Tata Sons would fundamentally change the Tata Group's long-term investment and social-development model, as the holding company would have to balance its existing purpose with the expectations of public investors seeking financial returns, Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata has said.

Speaking at the Republic Summit, Noel Tata talked of the relationship between Tata Sons and Tata Trusts, which holds around 66 per cent of Tata Sons.

He said the Trusts' role as a philanthropic organisation is separate from its role as the group's controlling shareholder, but the two are connected through Tata Sons.

"So the roles are separate. Tata Sons is the engine that continues to increase the value of the corpus of our trusts," Noel Tata said.

He said the corpus of the Trusts has grown at around 20 per cent annually over the last 30-35 years, with dividends from Tata Group companies providing the Trusts with the income needed for philanthropy.



Tata Trusts Chairman, Noel Tata — ANI

"And their role is really to keep making sure that our income stays ahead of inflation, so that our spending power keeps going up year by year by year, and we do that through the companies, through the dividends that finally end up coming to the Trusts, and which gives us the power to spend from the Trust," he said.

Noel Tata said the philanthropic side of the Trusts focuses predominantly on health and education, along with some skill development.

The comments come at a time when Tata Sons is facing questions and debate over its future structure, leadership and possible listing.

The issue around Tata Sons' listing and leadership intensified in September 2026 after the Reserve Bank of India rejected Tata Sons' application to remove its "Upper Layer" NBFC status, keeping the company's obligation to list unchanged.

Following this, the Tata Sons board voted 4-1 to reappoint N Chandrasekaran as Executive Chairman for a third five-year term and decided to initiate steps to comply with the listing requirement.

Noel Tata, representing Tata Trusts, voted against the decision, with Tata Trusts holding a 66 per cent stake in Tata Sons Private Limited (TSPL).

Tata Trusts has opposed the reappointment and public listing, calling the board's decision illegal.

The Trusts have also proposed a strategic reorganisation of TSPL that would result in the holding company ceasing to be classified as an NBFC or Core Investment Company (CIC), with the stated aim of changing its regulatory position and keeping Tata Sons private.

The Trusts have proposed a restructuring of Tata Sons that would bring operating businesses into the holding company.

In his remarks, Noel Tata said the proposal involves bringing "a couple of our operating businesses, part of Tata Electronics" into Tata Sons.

He said this would restore an earlier structure in which Tata Sons had both operating and investment businesses. Tata Consultancy Services was earlier a division of Tata Sons before it was demerged and listed in 2004, he noted.

Explaining why Tata Trusts wants to avoid a public listing, Noel Tata said the change could create a conflict between the group's long-term purpose and the expectations of public investors.

"We believe that it will fundamentally change the way the company, as a group, has been run over the last 150 years," Noel said.

He said Tata Sons has historically invested in projects based on what the country needs, while the Trusts also have a mandate to support social development.

Noel Tata referred to the philosophy associated with JRD Tata, saying: "What India needs."

He said this approach could become more difficult to maintain if public investors enter the holding company and expect their investments to grow on a quarter-by-quarter basis.

KEY POINTS

- 'So the roles are separate. Tata Sons is the engine that continues to increase the value of the corpus of our trusts,' Noel Tata said
- The Tata Tusts chairman said the corpus of the Trusts has grown at around 20 per cent annually over the last 30-35 years, with dividends from Tata Group companies providing the Trusts with the income needed for philanthropy

WILL SEEK STAKEHOLDER COMMENTS

'Govt aims 600 MT capacity under new National Steel Policy 2047'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

The government is formulating a new steel policy aimed at boosting capacity additions to achieve 600 million tonnes of capacity by 2047 and enhancing industry competitiveness while addressing key import challenges, Steel Secretary Sandeep Poundrik said on Tuesday.

The new National Steel Policy (NSP) will be put in the public domain for stakeholder feedback in about a week, the secretary said at an event here.

The NSP will set a roadmap through 2047 for the Indian steel industry to reach over 600 million tonnes of capacity by 2047, with a higher share of value-added and special steel.

The official also said an incentive scheme is being formulated with an outlay of Rs 5,000 crore for MSME steel units to encourage emissions reduction in the steel sector.

Speaking with reporters at the Manufacturing Confluence 2026 event organised by CII, Poundrik said the National Steel Policy will be made public in about a week for stakeholder comments.

As far as imports are concerned, the policy also includes measures to discourage cheap, substandard imports, including



Secretary, Ministry of Steel Sandeep Poundrik

safeguard measures like safeguard duty, anti-dumping duty, etc., as well as to make the Indian steel industry, especially small steel players, competitive in terms of technology and price.

The government had introduced a National Steel Policy in 2017, aimed at increasing India's steel manufacturing capability to 300 MT by 2030 along with other parameters such as consumption, ensuring raw material availability, among others.

However, according to the official, the 2017 policy "needed a relook" taking current challenges and requirements.

The Steel Secretary said that since 2017, emerging priorities like artificial intelligence, machine learning and technical upgrades require greater focus. Additionally, India's global standing in the steel sector has risen with increasing consumption and capacity.

India is the only country in the world growing in capacity and consumption at such speed, he said, adding that issues like decarbonization and sustainability remain.

"So, that is why we are bringing a new policy so that we have a road map for the next two decades up to 2047," Poundrik said.

According to a presentation by the official, the new policy aims at achieving 604 MT steel capacity by 2047.

"We are proposing a scheme which is called Viksit Bharat Ispat, which is only targeted at small steel producers, where they will be given an incentive linked to their production, which will be dependent on the reduction of carbon emissions. Now, reduction of carbon emissions can only be done by using better technology, by using better raw material and more use of renewable energy," he said in reply to a question on supporting MSMEs in the sector.

The scheme, having an outlay of Rs 5,000 crore, is likely to be approved by the competent authority in the near future, he said. For bigger steel producers, Poundrik said the CCTS (Carbon Credit Trading Scheme) is already going to be notified very soon which will ensure that they reduce their carbon emissions.

DGCA rolls out training plan for gyroplane pilots

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) has rolled out a training framework for aspirant gyroplane pilots. This marks India's first step towards enabling introduction of the aircraft.

The regulator has issued a new Civil Aviation Requirement (CAR) A 7, Series B, Part XXI, "Ground and Flying Training Syllabus for Issue of Pilot Licence for Gyroplanes".

The syllabus details out the ground and flying training requirements for issuance of DGCA pilot licence in the category of gyroplanes.



PROPOSED ECOSYSTEM WOULD FACILITATE TRAINING, MANUFACTURING & ENHANCED USAGE OF THESE AIRCRAFT IN INDIA

Gyroplanes, which have a rotating rotor-blade atop fuselage as a means of lift with a separate propeller as a means of thrust, have recreational and commercial applications such as joy-rides, air experience flights and aerial operations.

"The use of Gyroplanes for agricultural spraying, banner towing, aerial surveys and surveillance would open up possibilities for creating a new niche in the civil aviation sector," the DGCA said in the CAR.

It noted that while the issuance of a training syllabus is a first step in this direction, steps such as setting up training organisations and building indigenously assembled spares and components, too, would be needed to give a fillip to this sector.

"The formulation of this CAR 7, Series B Part XXI is a first step towards realising the vision of encouraging this unique aircraft for recreational and commercial operations in India. The proposed ecosystem would facilitate training, manufacturing and enhanced usage of these aircraft in India for various aerial activities," the DGCA said.

Ten out of 19 service sub-sectors recorded double-digit growth in July: Govt data

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 29

As many as 10 out of 19 service sub-sectors recorded double-digit growth in July, according to the Index of Services Production (ISP) data released on Tuesday.

The ISP data, published on a trial basis, showed that 17 sub-sectors recorded positive growth in July, according to a Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation (MoSPI) release.

Except for 'Repair services' and 'Air transport', all the categories recorded positive growth in July on an annual basis, the ministry said.

Air transport declined by 8.4 per cent while Repair services contracted by 5 per cent.

The MoSPI released the ISPs for July 2026 in respect of 19 sub-sectors, with a base year of 2024-25.

Top sub-sectors reporting strong growth in July, 2026 were Administrative and Support Services (20.9 per cent), Retail Trade (18.5 per cent), Real Estate (14.4 per cent), Accommodation and Food (12.6 per cent) and Banking (12.3 per cent).

"10 out of the 19 sub-sectors recorded double-digit growth in July, 2026 as compared to July, 2025. 17 out of the 19 sub-sectors recorded positive growth in July 2026," the Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation said.

The maiden sub-sectors trial ISP for April 2026 was released on July 14, 2026. The monthly ISPs are being published on an experimental basis, the ministry said.

The publication of the trial series would enable MoSPI to examine data quality, test its resilience and also receive feedback from stakeholders and users, it stated.

The Indices of Railways, Banking and Insurance sub-sectors are based on provisional monthly data and would undergo revision on an annual basis, it added.

Sebi drops shareholding case against Vinod Adani amid lack of evidence

AGENCIES
Mumbai, September 29

Markets regulator Sebi said it could not establish that Vinod Adani controlled two offshore funds that invested in four Adani Group companies, and dropped minimum public shareholding (MPS) and fraud allegations against him and 11 other noticees.

In its 81-page final order, Sebi Whole-Time Member Kamlesh Chandra Varshney said the investigation found no evidence that Vinod directed investment decisions of Emerging India Focus Funds (EIFF) and EM Resurgent Fund (EMR), or controlled Opal Investments' investment in Adani Power Ltd. The MPS requirement mandates at least 25 per cent public ownership. Sebi said de facto control must be established through evidence of positively directing management or policy decisions and cannot be inferred from business or financial relationships alone.

The regulator also found no evidence that Vinod controlled Nasser Ali Shaban Ahli or Chang Chung-Ling and, through them, investment decisions of underlying investors. An advisory agreement between Excel Investment Advisory Services Limited, allegedly controlled by Vinod, and Global Macro Asset Management Limited did not establish such control, Sebi said.

With the MPS allegation unproven, related allegations under the Prevention of Fraudulent and Unfair Trade Practices (PFUTP) Regulations also did not survive. Sebi imposed penalties of Rs 20 lakh each on Nasser Ali Shaban Ahli and Chang Chung-Ling for failing to furnish correct and complete information. The penalties are payable within 45 days.

India to host Routes Asia 2027 in March in Delhi

Routes Asia is set to be held from March 16-18, 2027 at Bharat Mandapam

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 29

Civil Aviation Minister Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu unveiled the curtain raiser for Routes Asia 2027 in New Delhi on Tuesday. Routes Asia is set to be held from March 16-18 next year at Bharat Mandapam.

The 24th edition of this global conference on aviation is expected to gather over 115 airlines, representatives from more than 55 countries, airports, tourism boards, and other aviation authorities. The event



attracted representatives from 28 embassies. The 2027 edition will be held under the theme "Bharat Aviation Rising: Inclusive Growth - Connecting Asia & Beyond", said the Minister.

India's growing aviation ecosystem offers an opportunity to expand, said minister, while adding that it is poised to witness more carriers and routes. India has over 166 airports at present and will see the emergence of another 100 in the next decade. The minister also emphasized the need to adopt a hub-and-spoke model to connect more cities with new emerging markets and create business opportunities for airlines, boosting tourism.

India took over the responsibility of hosting Routes Asia from China West Airport Group during the closing ceremony of Routes Asia 2026 in Xi'an in April.

Samir Kumar Sinha, Civil Aviation Secretary, spoke about the power of aviation to connect people, create trade, and business opportunities.

HIGHLIGHTS

- The 24th edition of this global conference is expected to gather over 115 airlines, representatives from over 55 countries
- India has over 166 airports at present and will see the emergence of another 100 in the next decade

Briefs

ODI: Justin Greaves ruled out

GUWAHATI: West Indies suffered a major blow ahead of their must-win second ODI against India here on Wednesday with in-form opener Justin Greaves ruled out of the match after sustaining a calf injury during his century in the series-opener.

Greaves, who struck his maiden ODI hundred in Thiruvananthapuram, sustained the injury during his 101 off 108 balls.

West Indies posted 295/7 before India chased down the target in 41.4 overs to take a 1-0 lead in the three-match series.

"Justin Greaves has been ruled out of the second game of the ODI series against India after sustaining a calf injury," Cricket West Indies said in a statement. "Greaves picked up the injury during his innings in the opening match of the series."

MP's Ranji Trophy team announced

INDORE: The Madhya Pradesh Cricket Association (MPCA) on Tuesday announced a 17-member squad for the 2026-27 Ranji Trophy season with middle-order batter Shubham Sharma as the captain.

The selectors have once again reposed their faith in Sharma, who occasionally bowls right- arm off-break, handing him the reins of the team as regular captain Rajat Patidar is currently unavailable.

Sharma has previously led Madhya Pradesh in the Ranji Trophy.

An MPCA official said Patidar, who captained Madhya Pradesh in the last Ranji season, and left-arm fast bowler Arshad Khan, are included in the India 'A' squad for the three-match one-day series against Australia A, starting October 6.

Therefore, both players are unavailable to represent the state in the opening matches of the Ranji Trophy, he said. The official said Venkatesh Iyer, known for his aggressive left-handed batting and right-arm medium-pace bowling, is recovering from surgery and will therefore be unable to play for MP in the top domestic cricket competition.

LEADS TEAM TO SILVER

Neeru Dhanda wins India's first-ever women's trap gold at Asian Games

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, September 29



Neeru Dhanda, (centre), after winning the gold medal in the women's trap shooting individual event during the ongoing 20th Asian Games, in Nagoya on Tuesday PTI

Neeru Dhanda on Tuesday scripted history by becoming India's first shooter to win an Asian Games individual gold medal in the women's trap competition with a record-shattering score after leading the country to a team silver in the same event here.

The 26-year-old from Haryana, who became the first Indian woman to win a World Cup trap gold medal in July this year, won the gold at Aichi Prefecture General Shooting Gallery with a score of 28, surpassing the previous Asian Record of 24.

China's Sun Yunong took the silver with a score of 26, while Kuwait's Abdulmalik Hajar settled for bronze after shooting 21.

"I dedicate this medal to the soldiers of the Indian Army who do a much bigger task defending the nation and to Late Raja Randhir Singh, who won India's first trap gold in the Asian Games back in 1978," Neeru said.

"My cousin Lakshay Sheoran, who is a trap silver-medallist from the 2018 Jakarta Asian Games motivated me to take up trap shooting. I eventually moved to the Madhya Pradesh Shooting Academy in Bhopal because I was getting the gun and ammunition for free," she added while talking about her journey so far.

No Indian woman trap shooter had won an individual medal at the Asian Games before this.

After Randhir Singh's historic gold in the men's individual trap event of the 1978 edition, Ronjan Sodhi claimed the top honours in the men's double trap event at the 2010 Asiad.

Neeru had qualified for the eight-shooter final after finishing as joint topper along with Qatar's Ray Bassil at 118, which is a qualification Games record.

The trio of Neeru (118), Aashima Ahlawat (106) and Manisha Keer (104) finished with a combined total of 328 to end second behind gold-medallists China (346) in the women's event.

The Chinese team comprised Liu Shanshan, Sun Yunong and Zhu Jingyu.

HIGHLIGHTS

- China's Sun Yunong took the silver with a score of 26, while Kuwait's Hajar settled for bronze after shooting 21
- Trio of Neeru (118), Aashima Ahlawat (106) and Manisha Keer (104) finished with a combined total of 328 to end second

Women's 4x400m relay: India wins first athletics gold

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, September 29



THE INDIAN TEAM WON THE TOP PRIZE WITH A TIME OF 3:29.69 MINUTES

The Indian quartet of Kiran Pahal, Poovamma Machettira, Prachi, and Vithya Ramraj produced an exceptional performance to claim the gold medal in women's 4x400m relay at the Asian Games here on Tuesday, finally breaking the yellow metal jinx in the ongoing edition.

The Indian team won the top prize with a time of 3:29.69 minutes, giving the country its first gold medal in track and field events at the ongoing games. Bahrain and China finished second and third respectively.

Earlier, Gurindervir Singh, Animesh Kujur, Sneha Sathyanarayana and Harita Bhadra won the bronze medal in the 4x100m mixed relay final after clocking a season best time of 41.06 seconds.

India's Pooja Singh fared well below her personal best with a leap of 1.84 metre but that was enough to clinch a bronze medal in women's high jump.

The 19-year-old was leading her event for a good part before squandering the advantage with a poor effort.

This was after India's Gulveer Singh continued his spectacular run of form at the ongoing games by winning a bronze medal in men's 5000m with a time of 13:32.75, completing a hat-trick of podium finishes in the Japanese city.

In the day's last track and field event, Dharamveer Choudhary, Manu Thekkinalil, Jay Kumar and Vishal Thennarasu clocked 3:01.61 to finish third behind Japan and Qatar in the men's 4x400m relay final.

Tuesday's triumph added a remarkable new chapter to the personal story of Poovamma, one of India's greatest track and field stars.

Dhakshineswar begins with 2 wins, Sumit reaches men's singles pre-QFs

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, September 29

Dhakshineswar Suresh recorded two wins in a productive day for India at the Asian Games, advancing to the men's singles pre-quarterfinals before combining with Yuki Bhambri to reach the doubles quarterfinals, while top-ranked Indian Sumit Nagal also progressed to the last 16 here Tuesday.

Dhakshineswar first overcame Indonesia's Gunawan Trismuwantara 7-5 7-6(2) in the singles second round before returning to the court with Yuki to beat Kazakhstan's Beibit Zhukayev and Denis Yevseyev 6-1 7-5 in the men's doubles.

Nagal, meanwhile, put behind his disappointing Davis Cup outing in Seoul by beating Korea's Seongchan Hong 6-4 6-0 in the second round to set up a pre-quarterfinal against Uzbekistan's Sergey Fomin.

N Sriram Balaji and Anirudh Chandrasekar also made a winning start in the men's doubles, defeating Nepal's Abhishek Bastola and Pradip Khadka 6-2 6-1 in their opening round.

It was not an entirely successful day for India, though, as Balaji and Ankita Raina suffered an early exit from the mixed doubles event.

Boxing: Ankush, Parveen punch their way to Asian Games finals

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nishio, September 29



Ankush Panghal ended India's eight-year wait for a male Asian Games boxing finalist while Parveen Hooda stormed into the 65kg gold medal bout with a commanding victory here on Tuesday as Narender Berwal signed off with a bronze after bowing out in the +90kg semifinals.

Parveen defeated China's Li Shu 5-0 before Ankush produced a stirring comeback to out-punch reigning 75kg world champion Uzbekistan's Fazliddin Erkinboev 4-1 and book his place in the 80kg summit clash.

Narender, however, went down 0-5 to reigning super-heavyweight world champion Aibek Oralbay of Kazakhstan in the last-four stage.

The bronze is Narender's second at the Asian Games after he also finished on the podium in Hangzhou in 2023. Ankush became the first Indian male boxer in eight years to reach an Asian Games final, with Amit Panghal, who won the 49kg title in 2018, the last to achieve the feat.

The Commonwealth Games gold medallist showed remarkable resilience against Erkinboev, recovering from a slow start to dominate the final round and secure a memorable victory.

RoKo craze grips Guwahati ahead of their 'final' India appearance

Kohli's last ODI appearance in Guwahati came against SL, when he scored his 45th ODI century

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Guwahati, September 29



Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma

The temperature may be soaring and the popularity of ODI cricket may have waned, but there is little chance of Guwahati's Barsapara Stadium being short on emotion when Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma walk out in India colours for what could be their final appearance here on Wednesday.

The 'RoKo' mania has gripped the north-eastern city ahead of India's second ODI against the West Indies, with fans lining up at the airport for a glimpse of their favourite stars and posters of Kohli and Rohit flying off the shelves.

Barsapara has hosted international cricket regularly, including their historic debut Test against South Africa in November last year, but the shorter T20 format has gradually drawn more attention from fans, leaving ODIs struggling to generate the same buzz. The last ODI here was played ahead of the 2023 World Cup.

Yet Wednesday's 2pm start, even with the Guwahati rising heat potentially testing the crowd, promises to be different.

Kohli's sparkling form has added another layer to the anticipation.

His last ODI appearance in Guwahati came against Sri Lanka, when he scored his 45th ODI century.

Now, after recently smashing his 55th ODI hundred and becoming only the second batter after Sachin Tendulkar to cross 15,000 ODI runs, the euphoria surrounding the former India captain has reached a crescendo.

And with Kohli and Rohit both expected to play their final ODI World Cup in 2027, their appearance in Guwahati carries the weight of a farewell, even if the actual goodbye is still some distance away.

"He is somebody who is just getting better and better with each series and each game. He is somebody who wants to improve in spite of achieving so much, which is fabulous,' spin bowling coach Sairaj Bahutule said on match eve.

"Rohit (Sharma) also being in the side, both of them just get that experience into the side, which I think all the youngsters rub upon and they thrive upon their experience, the conversations they have, it is definitely something which helps the youngsters by their presence.

KEY POINTS

- Barsapara has hosted international cricket regularly, including their historic debut Test against South Africa in Nov
- Kohli's sparkling form has added another layer to the anticipation

News at a glance

Al Fursan acquires Kerala Blasters from Magnum Group

KOCHI: UAE-based sports and sports-tech consortium Al Fursan, led by Sheikh Ahmad bin Faisal Al Qasimi, on Tuesday announced the acquisition of Indian Super League club Kerala Blasters FC from Magnum Group.

Al Fursan will acquire 100 per cent ownership of the club in phases over eight months, with the process expected to be completed towards the end of the 2026-27 season, subject to applicable regulatory and league requirements. Kerala Blasters CEO Abhik Chatterjee described the ownership transition as an important moment in the club's history.

India beat Qatar 3-2 to enter QFs of men's volleyball

NAGOYA: The Indian men's volleyball team continued its winning run, eking out a hard-fought 3-2 win over Qatar to register its third victory and qualify for the quarterfinals of the Asian Games here on Tuesday.

The Indian team bounced back from being two sets down to defeat Qatar 26-28, 25-27, 25-23, 25-20, 24-22 in a marathon Pool C match, which lasted two hours and 47 minutes. India had earlier defeated Vietnam 3-0 (25-23, 25-21, 25-20) and Hong Kong China 3-0 (25-22, 25-19, 25-21) in their opening two matches respectively.

India"s best set to fight for title in Women"s Indian Open

NEW DELHI: Three of the last four champions will return for the 2026 edition of the Hero Women's Indian Open, when it tees off at the DLF Golf & Country Club here with the tournament set to be played from October 22-25.

Defending champion Shannon Tan of Singapore, England's Liz Young (2024 winner), and Germany's Olivia Cowan (2022 winner) will be among those attempting to take back the coveted trophy, which signifies the champion of one of the elite Ladies European Tour tournaments in Asia.



Dhananjay Singh Khimsar, contesting for the Rajasthan Cricket Association (RCA) Presidency elections, interacts with media personnel after casting his vote, in Jaipur on Tuesday PTI

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Tender Particulars/Tender Number	Estimated Cost (Rs.) (including GST)	Tender Cost & EMD in Rs.	Last Date and Time for Closing of Online Submission
Supply, Erection and Commissioning of Energy Chain System for Side Arm Charger installed at CHP-II, 2x660 MW, SSTPP, MPPGCL, Dongalia. (T-2026_MPPGC_472475_1)	Rs. 54,41,629/- (including GST)	1,08,800/- & 2000/-	12.10.2026 Up to 15:30 hrs
Procurement of "Biplane Blade (Middle) of APH FG inlet damper" installed in Unit 1 and 2 at 2x600 MW, SSTPP, MPPGCL, Dongalia. (T-2026_MPPGC_529344_1)	Rs. 54,49,450/- (including GST)	1,09,000/- & 2000/-	15.10.2026 Up to 15:30 hrs
Procurement of spare parts of 32.5 VIMT 2000(72 PA) BHEL make Air Preheaters installed in PH-I, Unit1 and 2 at 2x600MW, SSTPP, MPPGCL, Dongalia, Distt. Khandwa, (M.P.). (T-2026_MPPGC_529343_1)	Rs. 61,33,509/- (including GST)	1,22,700/- & 2000/-	15.10.2026 Up to 15:30 hrs

For extension & other details, the bidders are requested to please visit e-portal of GoMP at **www.mptenders.gov.in**

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CHANGE OF NAME

I hitherto known as BHUTOO S/O MAHA ALI R/O Islampur Uttar Dinajpur West Bengal-733134 have changed my name and shall hereafater be known as ABUL KALAM AJAD. It is certified that I complied with other legal requirements in this connection.

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform public in general that Kotak Mahindra bank Ltd has organized an auction in below mention respect of Vehicles.

VEHICLES FOR SALE

1) TATA MOTORS TATA_INTRA REG. NO. DL1LAL3175-YOM- 2023

2) MAH VEERO15XXL REG. NO. DL1LAR0411- YOM- NA

UNDER HYPOTHECATION WITH M/S KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK IS UNDER SALE IN ITS "AS IS WHERE IS CONDITION" INTERESTED PARTIES CAN GIVE THEIR QUOTATIONS WITH IN 7 DAYS AT BRANCH ADDRESS: KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK 3RD FLOOR, PLOT NO 7, SECTOR 125, NOIDA-201313 OR CONTACT : RAMAN AHUJA KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK LTD. CONTACT NO. 8377988238 EMAIL-raman.ahuja@kotak.com

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, गोड्डा

ई–पुनर्निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना (तृतीय कॉल)

ई0–पुनर्निविदा संख्याः– 03/2026-27/R2/RWD/EE/GODDA दिनाकः–28-09-2026

कार्य का विवरणः– मुख्यमंत्री ग्राम सड़क योजना अन्तर्गत कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल, गोड्डा द्वारा निम्न विवरण के अनुसार e-procurement पद्धति से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

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				अंक में	अक्षर में	
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1. वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथिः– 03.10.2026
2. ई–निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समयः– 14.10.2026 अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक।
3. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समयः– 16.10.2026 पूर्वाह्न 03:30 बजे।
4. निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पताः– कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, गोड्डा।
5. ई– निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का मोबाईल नं0:– 7004195091
6. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट–बढ़ सकती है तद्नुसार अग्रधन की राशि देय होगी।
7. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि केवल **Online Mode** द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।
8. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि का ई–शुल्क भुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रधन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी।

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EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

The Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer (G) East Central Railway, Samastipur for and on behalf of the President of Union of India invites Tender from competent and experienced Contractors having valid Electrical Contractor's license, technical expertise, financial solvency through E-Tendering mode of IREPS web portal of Indian Railway for execution of the following works:- **Tender No. & Date EL-G-SPJ-08-ET-26-27-RT Dt. 25.09.2026**

1. Name of Work with Its Location: Provision of maintenance free earthing system and strengthening of power supply over SPJ Division. **2. Advertised value of the Work:** Rs. 83,23,214.20/- (Rupees Eighty three lakh twenty three thousand two hundred fourteen and twenty Paisa only) **3. Earnest money/Bid Security:** Rs 1,66,500/-Cost of tender document- Nill (0) **4. Validity of Offer (Days):** 90 days **5.Date & Time for Closing & Opening of Tender:** Date of Closing of E-Tender at 17:00 hours on 16.10 2026. Date of Opening of E-Tender from 17:30 hours on 16.10 2026. **6.Website particulars, Notice board location where complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office:** Website - www.ireps.gov.in. D.R.M (Elect.)Office/ Samastipur **NOTE:-** Any other modification/information related to the above said tender will be uploaded on the Website instead of publish in newspaper.

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (G)
E. C. Railway, Samastipur

PR/1018/SPJ/ELECT/T/26-27/40

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

(Construction Department)

Open e-Tender is invited on Behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work:-

1. Name of the work with its location: Design, Engineering, Supply, Erection Testing & Commissioning of 132 KV Double Circuit Transmission Line from 132/33KV GSS Saria to proposed Hazaribagh Road TSS including all associated works. **e-Tender No. EL-C-SMHX-ETEN-05-26-27 2. Approx. Cost of the work:** Rs.75156261.95/- **3. Availability of Tender:** On IREPS website: www.ireps.gov.in **4. Earnest money to be deposited and cost of tender form:** As Per NIT **5.Completion period of the work:** 12 Months **6.Date and time for closing of tender:** 16.10.2026 12:00 Hrs

Dy. CEE/CON/S/MHX
East Central Railway

PR/1017/CON/S/MHX/Patna/CONST/T/26-27/28

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!

IMPORTANT INFORMATION

RUN OF MORE POOJA FESTIVAL SPECIAL TRAINS-2026

In order to clear extra rush of passengers during this Festival Season, Railways have decided to run the following additional Pooja Festival Special Trains as per details given below:-

Train No. 05005/05006 Barhni - Jalandhar City - Barhni Unreserved Special Train — 16 Trips

Train No. 05005 Arr.	Train No. 05005 Dep.	STATIONS	Train No. 05006 Arr.	Train No. 05006 Dep.
--	15:10	Barhni	04:45	--
08:30	--	Jalandhar City	--	10:50

Days of Run: **05005 Ex Barhni** on every Wednesday from 07.10.2026 to 25.11.2026 and **05006 Ex Jalandhar City** on every Thursday from 08.10.2026 to 26.11.2026. **Accommodation:** Sleeper & General. **Stoppages:** Tulsipur, Balrampur, Gonda Jn., Burhwal, Sitapur Jn., Bareilly, Moradabad, Saharanpur Jn., Yamunanagar Jagadhri, Ambala Cantt. & Dhandari Kalan Stations.

Train No. 05101/05102 Gorakhpur Jn. - Shakur Basti - Gorakhpur Jn. Special Train — 16 Trips

Train No. 05101 Arr.	Train No. 05101 Dep.	STATIONS	Train No. 05102 Arr.	Train No. 05102 Dep.
--	16:00	Gorakhpur Jn.	08:30	--
11:05	--	Shakur Basti	--	13:15

Days of Run: **05101 Ex Gorakhpur Jn.** on every Sunday from 11.10.2026 to 29.11.2026 and **05102 Ex Shakur Basti** on every Monday from 12.10.2026 to 30.11.2026. **Accommodation:** 1st AC, AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General. **Stoppages:** Anand Nagar Jn., Siddharth Nagar, Barhni, Tulsipur, Balrampur, Gonda Jn., Sitapur Jn., Shahjahanpur, Bareilly Jn., Moradabad Jn., Ghaziabad Jn. & Delhi Jn. Stations.

Train No. 05048/05047 Banaras - Kolkata - Banaras Special Train — 16 Trips

Train No. 05048 Arr.	Train No. 05048 Dep.	STATIONS	Train No. 05047 Arr.	Train No. 05047 Dep.
--	10:45	Banaras	04:15	--
10:55	11:00	Varanasi Jn.	03:55	04:00
06:15	--	Kolkata	--	08:25

Days of Run: **05048 Ex Banaras** on every Tuesday from 06.10.2026 to 24.11.2026 and **05047 Ex Kolkata** on every Wednesday from 07.10.2026 to 25.11.2026. **Accommodation:** AC 3 Tier. **Stoppages:** Varanasi Jn., Aunrihar Jn, Ghazipur City, Ballia, Reoti, Suraimanpur, Chhapra Jn., Dighwara, Sonpur Jn., Hajipur Jn., Shahpur Patoree, Barauni Jn., Kiul Jn., Jhajha, Jasidih Jn., Madhupur Jn, Chittaranjan, Asansol Jn., Durgapur, Barddhaman Jn., Bandel Jn. & Naihati Jn. Stations.

Train No. 01123/01124 Lokmanya Tilak (T) - Mau Jn. - Lokmanya Tilak (T) Special Train (Bi-Weekly) — 24 Trips

Train No. 01123 Arr.	Train No. 01123 Dep.	STATIONS	Train No. 01124 Arr.	Train No. 01124 Dep.
--	12:15	Lokmanya Tilak (T)	16:45	--
15:50	16:00	Varanasi Jn.	09:50	10:00
21:30	--	Mau Jn.	--	04:15

Days of Run: **01123 Ex Lokmanya Tilak (T)** on every Friday & Sunday from 11.10.2026 to 20.11.2026 and **01124 Ex Mau Jn.** on every Sunday & Tuesday from 13.10.2026 to 22.11.2026. **Accommodation:** AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General. **Stoppages:** Thane, Kalyan Jn, Igatpuri, Nashik Road, Jalgaon Jn, Bhusaval Jn, Khandwa, Itarsi Jn, Pipariya, Narsinghpur, Madan Mahal, Katni, Maihar, Satna, Manikpur Jn, Prayagraj Chheoki, Varanasi Jn, Jaunpur Jn, Shahganj Jn, Khorason Road, Azamgarh & Muhammadabad Stations.

Train No. 01431/01432 Hadapsar - Ghazipur City - Hadapsar Special Train (Bi-Weekly) — 24 Trips

Train No. 01431 Arr.	Train No. 01431 Dep.	STATIONS	Train No. 01432 Arr.	Train No. 01432 Dep.
--	06:55	Hadapsar	16:20	--
15:10	15:20	Varanasi Jn.	08:20	08:30
20:15	--	Ghazipur City	--	04:00

Days of Run: **01431 Ex Hadapsar** on every Friday & Tuesday from 13.10.2026 to 20.11.2026 and **01432 Ex Ghazipur City** on every Sunday & Thursday from 15.10.2026 to 22.11.2026. **Accommodation:** AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General. **Stoppages:** Daund Chord Line, Ahmednagar, Belapur, Kopargaon, Ankai, Manmad Jn, Jalgaon Jn, Bhusaval Jn, Khandwa, Itarsi Jn, Pipariya, Narsinghpur, Madan Mahal, Katni, Maihar, Satna, Manikpur Jn, Prayagraj Chheoki, Varanasi Jn, Jaunpur Jn. & Aunrihar Jn. Stations.

Train No. 01079/01080 Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj (T) - Gorakhpur Jn. - Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj (T) Special Train (Daily) — 64 Trips

Train No. 01079 Arr.	Train No. 01079 Dep.	STATIONS	Train No. 01080 Arr.	Train No. 01080 Dep.
--	22:30	Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj (T)	00:40	--
04:05	04:15	Lucknow	19:45	19:55
10:00	--	Gorakhpur Jn.	--	14:30

Days of Run: **01079 Ex Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj (T)** from 16.10.2026 to 16.11.2026 (Daily) and **01080 Ex Gorakhpur Jn.** from 18.10.2026 to 18.11.2026. (Daily) **Accommodation:** AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General. **Stoppages:** Dadar, Thane, Kalyan Jn., Igatpuri, Nashik Road, Manmad Jn., Jalgaon Jn., Bhusaval Jn., Khandwa, Itarsi Jn., Bhopal Jn., Bina Jn., Virangana Lakshmibai Jhansi, Orai, Kanpur Central, Lucknow, Gonda Jn., Mankapur Jn., Basti & Khalilabad Stations.

Train No. 01415/01416 Hadapsar - Gorakhpur Jn. - Hadapsar Special Train (Daily) — 64 Trips

Train No. 01415 Arr.	Train No. 01415 Dep.	STATIONS	Train No. 01416 Arr.	Train No. 01416 Dep.
--	07:05	Hadapsar	03:30	--
09:55	10:05	Lucknow	22:25	22:35
16:00	--	Gorakhpur Jn.	--	17:30

Days of Run: **01415 Ex Hadapsar** from 16.10.2026 to 16.11.2026 (Daily) **01416 Ex Gorakhpur Jn.** from 17.10.2026 to 17.11.2026 (Daily). **Accommodation:** AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General. **Stoppages:** Daund Chord Line, Ahmednagar, Belapur, Kopargaon, Manmad Jn., Bhusaval Jn., Khandwa, Itarsi Jn., Bhopal Jn., Bina Jn., Virangana Lakshmibai Jhansi, Orai, Kanpur Central, Lucknow, Gonda Jn., Mankapur Jn. & Basti Stations.

Train No. 01051/01052 Lokmanya Tilak (T) - Banaras - Lokmanya Tilak (T) Special Train (Bi-Weekly) — 24 Trips

Train No. 01051 Arr.	Train No. 01051 Dep.	STATIONS	Train No. 01052 Arr.	Train No. 01052 Dep.
--	12:15	Lokmanya Tilak (T)	04:40	--
15:45	15:50	Varanasi Jn.	20:45	20:50
16:05	--	Banaras	--	20:30

Days of Run: **01051 Ex Lokmanya Tilak (T)** on every Wednesday & Thursday from 14.10.2026 to 19.11.2026 and **01052 Ex Banaras** on every Thursday & Friday from 15.10.2026 to 20.11.2026. **Accommodation:** AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General. **Stoppages:** Thane, Kalyan Jn., Igatpuri, Nashik Road, Jalgaon Jn., Bhusaval Jn., Khandwa, Itarsi Jn., Pipariya, Narsinghpur, Madan Mahal, Katni, Maihar, Satna, Manikpur Jn., Prayagraj Chheoki & Varanasi Jn. Stations.

Train No. 04829/04830 Jodhpur Jn. - Gorakhpur Jn. - Jodhpur Jn. Pooja Special Train — 18 Trips

Train No. 04829 Arr.	Train No. 04829 Dep.	STATIONS	Train No. 04830 Arr.	Train No. 04830 Dep.
--	16:15	Jodhpur Jn.	05:30	--
04:30	04:45	Delhi Jn.	14:00	14:10
20:30	--	Gorakhpur Jn.	--	23:25

Days of Run: **04829 Ex Jodhpur Jn.** on every Thursday from 01.10.2026 to 26.11.2026 and **04830 Ex Gorakhpur Jn.** on every Friday from 02.10.2026 to 27.11.2026. **Accommodation:** AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General. **Stoppages:** Merta Road Jn., Degana Jn., Chhoti Katu, Didwana, Ladnun, Sujangarh,Ratangrah Jn., Churu Jn., Sadulpur Jn., Loharu Jn., Mahendragarh, Rewari Jn., Gurgaon, Delhi Cantt., Delhi Jn., Ghaziabad Jn., Moradabad Jn., Bareilly Jn., Shahjehanpur, Sitapur City Jn., Gonda Jn. & Basti Stations.

Train No. 05167/05168 Banaras - Lokmanya Tilak (T) - Banaras Special Train — 14 Trips

Train No. 05167 Arr.	Train No. 05167 Dep.	STATIONS	Train No. 05168 Arr.	Train No. 05168 Dep.
--	09:50	Banaras	00:50	--
10:06	10:08	Varanasi Jn.	00:30	00:35
16:50	--	Lokmanya Tilak (T)	--	18:10

Days of Run: **05167 Ex Banaras** on every Saturday from 17.10.2026 to 28.11.2026 and **05168 Ex Lokmanya Tilak (T)** on every Sunday from 18.10.2026 to 29.11.2026. **Accommodation:** 1st AC, AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, AC 3 Tier Economy Sleeper & General. **Stoppages:** Varanasi Jn., Prayagraj Chheoki, Manikpur Jn., Satna, Maihar, Katni, Jabalpur, Itarsi Jn., Khandwa Jn., Burhanpur, Bhusaval Jn., Nasik Road, Igatpuri, Kalyan Jn. & Thane Stations.

Train No. 04731/04732 Sri Ganganagar Jn. - Samastipur Jn. - Sri Ganganagar Jn. Special Train — 14 Trips

Train No. 04731 Arr.	Train No. 04731 Dep.	STATIONS	Train No. 04732 Arr.	Train No. 04732 Dep.
--	13:25	Sri Ganganagar Jn.	12:20	--
00:25	00:35	Delhi Jn.	23:40	23:50
23:15	--	Samastipur Jn.	--	00:45

Days of Run: **04731 Ex Sri Ganganagar Jn.** on every Sunday from 18.10.2026 to 29.11.2026 and **04732 Ex Samastipur Jn.** on every Tuesday from 20.10.2026 to 01.12.2026. **Accommodation:** AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General. **Stoppages:** Sadulshahr, Hanumangarh Jn., Sangaria, Mandi Dabwali, Raman, Sirsa, Mandi Adampur, Hisar, Hansi, Rohtak Jn., Delhi Jn., Ghaziabad, Moradabad, Bareilly, Sitapur Jn., Gonda Jn., Gorakhpur Jn., Deoria Sadar, Siwan Jn., Chhapra, Sonpur, Hajipur Jn. & Muzaffarpur Jn. Stations.

Train No. 03107/03108 Kolkatta - Alamnagar - Kolkatta Special Train (Weekly) — 14 Trips

Train No. 03107 Arr.	Train No. 03107 Dep.	STATIONS	Train No. 03108 Arr.	Train No. 03108 Dep.
--	23:50	Kolkatta	22:30	--
14:05	14:15	Varanasi Jn.	07:20	07:25
19:45	--	Alamnagar	--	01:45

Days of Run: **03107 Ex Kolkata** on every Thursday from 15.10.2026 to 26.11.2026 and **03108 Ex Alamnagar** on every Saturday from 17.10.2026 to 28.11.2026. **Accommodation:** AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General. **Stoppages:** Naihati Jn., Bandel, Bardhaman, Durgapur, Asansol Jn., Dhanbad Jn., Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose Jn. Gomoh, Parasnath, Hazaribagh Road, Koderma, Gaya Jn., Anugrah Narayan Road, Dehri On Sone, Sasaram, Bhabua Road, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Jn., Varanasi Jn., Sultanpur & Utrahtia Stations.

Train No. 04076/04075 Delhi Jn. - Kamakhya Jn. - Delhi Jn. Reserved Festival Special Express Train (Weekly) — 18 Trips

Train No. 04076 Arr.	Train No. 04076 Dep.	STATIONS	Train No. 04075 Arr.	Train No. 04075 Dep.
--	00:30	Delhi Jn.	20:40	--
21:15	--	Kamakhya Jn.	--	05:00

Days of Run: **04076 Ex Delhi Jn.** on every Saturday from 03.10.2026 to 28.11.2026 and **04075 Ex Kamakhya Jn.** on every Monday from 05.10.2026 to 30.11.2026. **Accommodation:** AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General. **Stoppages:** Tundla Jn., Govindpuri, Prayagraj Jn., Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Jn., Buxar, Ara, Danapur, Patliputra, Sonpur, Hajipur Jn., Shahpur Patoree, Barauni Jn., Begusarai, Khagaria Jn., Mansi Jn., Naugachia, Katihar Jn., Barsoi Jn., Kishanganj, New Jalpaiguri, New Cooch Behar, New Alipurduar, Kokrajhar, New Bongaigaon, Barpeta Road & Rangiya Jn. Stations.

For any kind of information and detailed time-table etc., passengers are requested to contact RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or may visit Indian Railways website https://enquiry.indianrail.gov.in or NTES App.

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NORTHERN RAILWAY
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SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT, DURG CIRCLE DURG (C.G.)

Durg, Dated: 28.09.2026

e- Procurement Tender Amendment Notice

Amendment are made in N.I.T. No. 309, 310, 311, 312, 313, 314, 315, 316, 317, 318, 319, 320, 321, and 322 Dated 03.09.2026

Existing Description	To be Extended
Bid Submission due Date (Online) 23-09-2026 17.30	Bid Submission due Date (Online) 01-10-2026 17.30
End Date for Physical Doc submission (EMD, and Affidavit in Envelope D) (by Registered/ Speed Post) 25-09-2026 17.30	End Date for Physical Doc ubmission (EMD, and Affidavit in Envelope D) (by Registered/ Speed Post) 06-10-2026 17.30
Bid Opening Date (Scheduled) 28-09-2026 11.30	Bid Opening Date (Scheduled) 07-10-2026 11.30

Note :- 1- General Conditions, detailed NIT, Tender documents & other information of the above construction work downloaded from the Eprocurement web portal or departmental website http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in.

2- NIT No. & Name of the Work should be essentially mentioned on the envelope through the Registerd Post/Speed Post in this office.

Superintending Engineer
P.W.D., Durg Circle Durg (C.G.)

G 262703614/6

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office: PSEB, Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate Identity Number:U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in
(Phone No. 01881-275289) E-mail: se-hq-ggsstp-ropar@pspcl in
E-Tender Enquiry No. 756/P-2/EMP-13437 dated 24.09.26

Dy Chief Engineer/ Headquarter (Purchase Cell-2) GGSSTP Rupnagar invites E-Tender ID No. 2026_POWER_176168_1 for work Overhauling of HVR Transformers on site for ESPs of Stage-II & III of GGSSTP, Rupnagar lying at GGSSTP Rupnagar.

For detailed NIT & Tender Specification please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 25.09.2026 onwards.

Note: - Corrigendum & addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

RTP-92/26 PR-Advt. No :- :- 1079/12/2026-27/15696

OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF (CIVIL), ODISHA NIRMAN SOUDHA, UNIT-V, BHUBANESWAR

E-mail ID:cebuildings_orissa@yahoo.co.in
cebuildings@rediffmail.com
Tel. -(0674)- 2391523

INVITATIONS FOR BIDS (IFB)

File No-B-I-Home-54/2026 Lr. No.- 35943 Bhubaneswar, the 29th Sept., 2026

Invitation for Bids

Bid Identification No. CE-Bldg-II-40/2026-27

1.	The Chief Engineer, Buildings-II, Odisha, Bhubaneswar, on behalf of Governor of Odisha, invites percentage rate bids in double cover system in ONLINE MODE only, for the works, **(1)"Construction of Block Level Stadium in Saintala Block (with Indoor Hall) in Balangir District", (2)"Construction of Block Level Stadium in Deogaon Block (with Indoor Hall) in Balangir District", (3)"Construction of Block Level Stadium in M. Rampur Block (with Indoor Hall) in Kalahandi District", (4)"Construction of 40 Nos. of E-type Staff Qrs. (Block-I (S+3) and Block-II (S+2)) at Parlakhemundi, Gajapati" & (5)"Construction of the Office Building and Record Room of the Additional Sub-Collector (Settlement and Consolidation), Puri"** as detailed below.		
2.	Nature of work	:	Building Works
3.	No. of work	:	05 Nos.
4.	Bid Cost.	:	₹10,000/- (each)
5.	Class of Contractor	:	'A'/ Special
6.	Availability of Bid Documents in the website	:	From dt.12.10.2026 to 17.00 Hours of dt.27.10.2026.
7.	Date of Opening of Bid	:	Dt.28.10.2026 at 11:30 AM.
8.	The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website: https://tendersodisha.gov.in. Any addendum / corrigendum / cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website only.		

No.:34001/34117/1/26-27/0076 Chief Engineer, Buildings-II, Odisha

Office of the Executive Engineer Irrigation Division, Godda Camp-Mahagama

(e-Mail Id-eeirrgodda@gmail.com)

e-Procurement Notice

(Two Envelope System)

e-Tender Reference No.-**WRD/IRR/Mahagama/02F2/2026-27 dt.28.09.2026**

1.	Name of Work	Anti-Erosion work Over the Most Vulnerable Section of Right Bank of Geruwa River (Length: 190m) Near Village-Chhote Badae, Block-Basantrai, Dist.-Godda
2.	Estimated Cost	Rs. 1,17,28,879.96 (Rupees One Crore seventeen lakh twenty eight thousand eight hundred seventy nine and ninety six paise) only
3.	Time of Completion	180 Days
4.	Date of Publication of E-Tender on website	03.10.2026
5.	Last date/Time for submission of E-Tender BID'S	15.10.2026
6.	Last date for online submission of E-Tender fee and EMD	15.10.2026
7.	Date of Opening Tender	17.10.2026
8.	Name & Address of Office inviting tender	Executive Engineer, Irrigation Division, Godda Camp-Mahagama.
a.	Contact no of e-Procurement officer	9801343072
b.	Helpline number of e-Procurement Cell	06432-232477

Note:- (1) Only e-Tenders will be accepted.
(2) Published Estimated Cost may be Increase or Decrease.
Further Details can be seen on website http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in

PR 390716 Water Resource(26-27)D

Executive Engineer,
Irrigation Division, Godda Camp-Mahagama

noida New Okhla Industrial Development Authority

Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B. Nagar (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on NOIDA Authority's official website: **www.noidaauthorityonline.com** & **http://etender.up.nic.in.** Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

(A)

1. **22/GM/AO/Sr.M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET,** Renovation of Community Center in Sector-23, Noida. Cost Rs. 9.86 Lacs.
2. **36/GM/AO/Sr.M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET,** D/o Villages Providing Street light work & Renovation of Community Center Vill-Harola, Sec-5, Noida. Cost Rs. 19.37 Lacs.
3. **40/GM/AO/Sr.M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET,** Providing of lighting work in Sector-19,NOIDA. Cost Rs. 17.85 Lacs.
4. **41/GM/AO/Sr. M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET,** Repair & Renovation of Electrical works in ATS office and Fire Station Compound & Staff Quarter Sector-58, Noida. Cost Rs. 28.48Lacs.
5. **42/GM/AO/Sr.M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET,** Annual Maintenance of R.O. System Installed in Staff Quarter Sector-14A, Noida. Cost Rs. 25.28 Lacs.
6. **43/GM/AO/Sr. M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET,** Annual Maint. of Fountain Sector-23, Sector-54 (Wetland) & Sector -57 Crossing (06 Nos Fountain). Cost Rs. 19.03 Lacs.
7. **48/GM/AO/Sr. M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET,** Annual Maintenance contract for Air-Conditioner & 100 LPH, R.O. System at Authority Office, Sec-39, Noida. Cost Rs. 21.16Lacs.

Which can be uploaded by date: - 13.10.2026 Upto 5.00 PM. pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date: - 14.10.2026 at 11.00 AM.

(B)

1. **27/GM(E/M)/SM(E/M)-I/E.T./2026-27,** Internal Electrification of newly constructed Chopal in Vill-Yakubpur, Noida. Cost Rs. 14.53 Lacs.
2. **14/GM/AO/Sr.M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET,** Annual Repair & Maintenance of DG Set Installed in Noida Stadium at Sector-21A, Noida. Cost Rs. 18.58 Lacs.

Which can be uploaded by date: - 06.10.2026 Upto 5.00 PM. pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date: - 07.10.2026 at 11.00 AM.

General Manager (E&M)
NOIDA

Office: Sec - 5

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

SUMMONS FOR PUBLICATION

SUMMONS FOR SETTLEMENT OF ISSUES (O.5, rr. 1, 5)

BEFORE THE COMMERCIAL COURT, COURT NO.II, GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR

ORIGINAL SUIT NO.1447/2019

STATE BANK OF INDIA, a body corporate constituted under the **State Bank of India** Act - 1955 having one of its office AT "THE CORRENTHUM" SECTOR-62 NOIDA, Distt-Gautam Budh Nagar, through **Sanjeev Saxena Manager (SARC),** Mobile No.882668853, **Mail I.D. sanjeev.saxena@sbi.co.in Aadhar No: 400901195727.** .....PLAINTIFF

VERSUS

1. **MR. MAYANK MISHRA S/O SH. KRIPA SHANKAE MISHRA** R/O D-401, AZAD VIHAR, KHODA COLONY, GHAZIABAD.
2. **SH. KRIPA SHANKAE MISHRA S/O SH. SRI NIWAS MISHRA,** R/O D-401, AZAD VIHAR, KHODA COLONY, GHAZIABAD.

---------DEFENDANTS

Whereas State Bank of India instituted a suit against you for recovery of money. You are hereby summoned to appear in this Court in person, or by a pleader duly instructed, and able to answer all material questions relating to the suit, or who shall be accompanied by some person able to answer all such questions, on the **07.10.2026 at 10:00 O'clock in the Court,** to answer the claim; and further you are hereby directed to file on that day a written statement of your defence and to produce on the said day all documents in your possession or power upon which you base your defense or claim for set-off or counter-claim, and where you rely on any other document whether in your possession or power or not, as evidence in support of your defense or claim for set-off or counter-claim, you shall enter such documents in a list to be annexed to the written statement).

Take notice that, in default of your appearance on the day before mentioned, the suit will be heard and determined in your absence.

Given under my hand and the seal of the Court, this day of ..... 2026.

SEAL OF COURT

MUNSIRIM / READER
Commercial Court-1, Gautam Budh Nagar



'OTT saved us when theatres shut during COVID'

Parineeti said that 'the joke lies in the fact that we're calling OTT & TV lower than cinema'

Parineeti Chopra questioned the perception that actors working in television and OTT are somehow considered lesser than those associated with theatrical cinema. The actress, who recently made her series debut with Netflix's 'Shaque: Trust No One', said that audiences and the industry should not define an actor based on the platform they work on.

CHOPRA BELIEVES THE DISTINCTION BETWEEN ACTORS BASED ON THEIR CHOSEN MEDIUM IS UNNECESSARY

In an interview with 'Mid-Day', Parineeti also opened up about her search for the right web series and explained why she eventually chose Siddharth P Malhotra and Rensil D'Silva's mystery thriller.

Parineeti revealed that she had been looking for the right series for some time before signing 'Shaque: Trust No One'. Although she had already appeared in OTT films, including 'The Girl on the Train' (2021) and 'Amar Singh Chamkila' (2024), she hadn't found a series that felt right to her. "I had done a couple of OTT films like 'The Girl on the Train' (2021) and 'Amar Singh Chamkila' (2024) and was looking for a series. I had gone through a lot of different stories with 'Netflix', but none of them sounded right to me. Sid felt that I'd be interested in this," she told 'Mid-Day'.

Having worked across theatrical films and OTT projects, Parineeti believes the distinction between actors based on their chosen medium is unnecessary. "The joke lies in the fact that we are calling OTT and TV lower than cinema, when these two saved us during the COVID-19 pandemic when theatres were not even working. They didn't let entertainment die. We must remember both times - when cinema wasn't working and OTT took over and vice versa. Branding actors is a waste of time," she said.

AGENCIES

A celebration in the sublime craft of writing

'Godrej Literature Live! The Mumbai LitFest' returns from Oct 23 to 25

JAI TALWAR



THE FESTIVAL CONTINUES TO DEEPEN ITS COMMITMENT TO INCLUSION, FOREGROUNDING VOICES

Godrej Literature Live! The Mumbai LitFest' returns to the National Centre for the Performing Arts (NCPA) from October 23 to October 25 for its 17th edition, with Godrej Industries Group joining as title partner.

The Group, which has stood at the confluence of art and industry, poetry and progress for over a century, takes on the role as the festival opens a new chapter. Over 16 editions, the festival has enriched the city's cultural life and it remains an eagerly awaited space for meaningful conversation among writers, thinkers, performers and audiences of all ages, interests and dispositions.

Beyond literature, this year's programme spans cinema, journalism, economics, medicine, history, the arts, sport, technology, the environment, identity and the digital ecosystem.

The line-up includes Ayaz Memon, Boria Majumdar, Faye D'Souza, Gulzar, Jaspreet Bindra, Javed Akhtar, Jerry Pinto, Juhi Babbar, Kaushik Basu, Mazda Turel, Naman Ahuja, Pavan K Varma, Ramachandra Guha, Ratna Pathak Shah, Shanta Gokhale, Shashi Tharoor, Shefali Shah, Sonali Kulkarni and others.

"We are proud to bring our 17th edition, which continues the festival's legacy of presenting the voices and ideas most relevant to our rapidly transforming society, with a distinguished line-up spanning generations and disciplines," said Amy Fernandes, Festival Co-Director.

Highlights include the Godrej Literature Live! Literary Awards for 'Lifetime Achievement', 'Poet Laureate', 'Fiction', 'Non-Fiction' and 'Business' books. The programme also features the 'Great Debate', 'Book in Focus', international performances, workshops, book launches and the ever-popular book swap. Through the Godrej DEI Lab, the festival continues to deepen its commitment to inclusion, foregrounding voices from the LGBTQIA+ community and minority groups.

HUNKKAAR: THE ROAR

'Hope show makes people introspect on rising rape cases'

The purpose of 'Hunkkaar: The Roar' will be fulfilled if even one person watches and raises his or her voice against growing cases of sexual assault, said Raghubir Yadav, Fatima Sana Shaikh and Zoya Hussain, who play prominent roles in the series.

The 'JioHotstar' series revolves around a 17-year-old (Aneet Padda) who accuses a famous godman, Baapji (Yadav), of sexual assault, sparking a media storm and police investigation. She is slut-shamed for taking on a revered public figure.

Shaikh, who plays a cop investigating the case, said reading about stories of crime against women fills her with anger. "It's a story that has been in the news recently; actually, it has been there for years. There are many more such stories about girls as young as 15 and 17 facing such trauma."

As actors, she said, the least they can do is try to raise their voice through their work. Citing the case in Jamui (Bihar) where a young girl was molested while returning from coaching classes with her friend, Shaikh said the young boy who accompanied her stood up to the molesters. "So, if by watching our show, even one boy realises that this is wrong, then that will also be a big thing. It isn't just one girl's story; it cuts across all classes, all genders."

Yadav said his hope with shows like 'Hunkkaar' is that they knock on the collective conscience of society and not simply act as a mirror. Actually, even when we get angry, we want to know the result of that anger... What we show is that the anger is inside you and you have to correctly use this anger to make things right," he said.

Hussain, who plays a disciple to Yadav's character of Baapji, said unfortunately the subject of their show has become very common. "I hope that through our show, the people who want to speak out will get a little bit of strength somewhere... Anytime there is victim-shaming, it makes you angry. How to deal with it now? I think whether in society or individually, you also get frustrated: how do you change this? How do you support somebody when you hear it in the news? What do you do about it? Anger comes from this. We are all trying to figure out what to do about this," she said.

PTI

Aishwarya walks ramp at PARIS FASHION WEEK



Bollywood superstar Aishwarya Rai Bachchan walked the ramp at Paris Fashion Week in an ensemble from Syrian label Yara Shoemaker.

The actress wore a black velvet V-shaped fishtail gown with a pearl-embellished statement cape. She added a tiara to complement the look and opted for a bold red lip colour, sharp winged eyeliner and a dewy radiant base.

Bachchan, who is a brand ambassador of 'L'Oreal Paris', walked the 'L'Oreal Paris Le Defile' show on Monday, which took place at Place Joffre at the foot of the Eiffel Tower and École Militaire.

RAI WORE A BLACK VELVET V-SHAPED FISHTAIL GOWN WITH A PEARL-EMBELLISHED STATEMENT CAPE

The brand shared a picture of the actress on the official 'Instagram' handle, which featured her arriving at the venue. "A night to express your worth starts here. L'Oréal Paris Global Ambassador @aishwaryaraibachchan_arb @andiemacdowell and @evalongoria have arrived at Place Joffre in front of the Eiffel Tower for Le Defilé 2026," read the caption.

The actress has represented the brand on the red carpet at the Cannes Film Festival and at Paris Fashion Week for over two decades. She started walking the ramp at Paris Fashion Week in 2019. Other celebrities on the ramp included the 'Bridgerton' actress Simone Ashley, Hollywood star Eva Longoria, Celine Dion, Cara Delevingne, Kristen Bell and others.

PTI

'NO EQUALITY UNTIL YOU RESPECT OUR BODIES'

Actress Florence Pugh on the Cornell University sexual assault case



Black Widow' star Florence Pugh extended her support to the victim of an alleged campus assault at Cornell University, saying she felt sick and anxious to read that a young woman was gang-raped by her friends and the accused faced no consequences.

The incident, which took place in October 2024 during a frat party, came to light two weeks ago after the woman filed a lawsuit against the college and the fraternity group, accusing seven men of drugging and raping her at a party.

In the lawsuit, she has alleged that one of the main accused invited others to join in on the assault via the community's Snapchat account while she was unconscious. No one reported the assault. Two of the main accused were expelled, but the other five were asked to write essays and attend community service.

In a lengthy post on 'Instagram', Pugh said there cannot be equality unless women and their bodies are respected. "I know this has happened before and I hate the idea of it happening again. This is really the moment where we need our men to be as horrified and as sickened as us. You need to be leading conversations about how we change the allowance and complicity of this behaviour as much as we are. How can you expect us to trust that it's 'not all men' when in moments like this, many of you stay quiet?"

THE 'BLACK WIDOW' STAR SAID SHE FELT SICK AND ANXIOUS ABOUT THE CASE

The 'Midsommar' star said every single person who knew and heard about this happening and did nothing should be looked at. "The thing that makes me most heartbroken is it's a want to kill a soul. This is a killing of a soul. Destroying a body and killing a soul. And they've been let off? All it takes is to write a quick 'I'm so sorry I raped a girl while she was drugged with my friends; we thought it would be fine?' essay and you're good to go! This is unacceptable," she said.

The actress praised students who have exposed the accused, saying they shouldn't be 'allowed to walk freely' like the rest of us who treasure and care for souls. "Colleges/schools/universities repeatedly fail women around the world. You build men that get taught through time and time again that they can do extreme harm and that they won't be harmed in return. I'm no longer tired - I'm enraged by schools protecting boys, in fear of their future being wrecked. What about the life that those girls then have to endure, with the knowledge that his reputation is more precious than her truth? Or to feel that no one with the power to do something cares that you were abused. It's further soul-destroying."

PTI